

Sponsorship—Gratitude in Action

**THE FORTY-FIRST ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

***1991
Final Report***

Rye Town Hilton, Rye Brook, New York, April 14–20

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

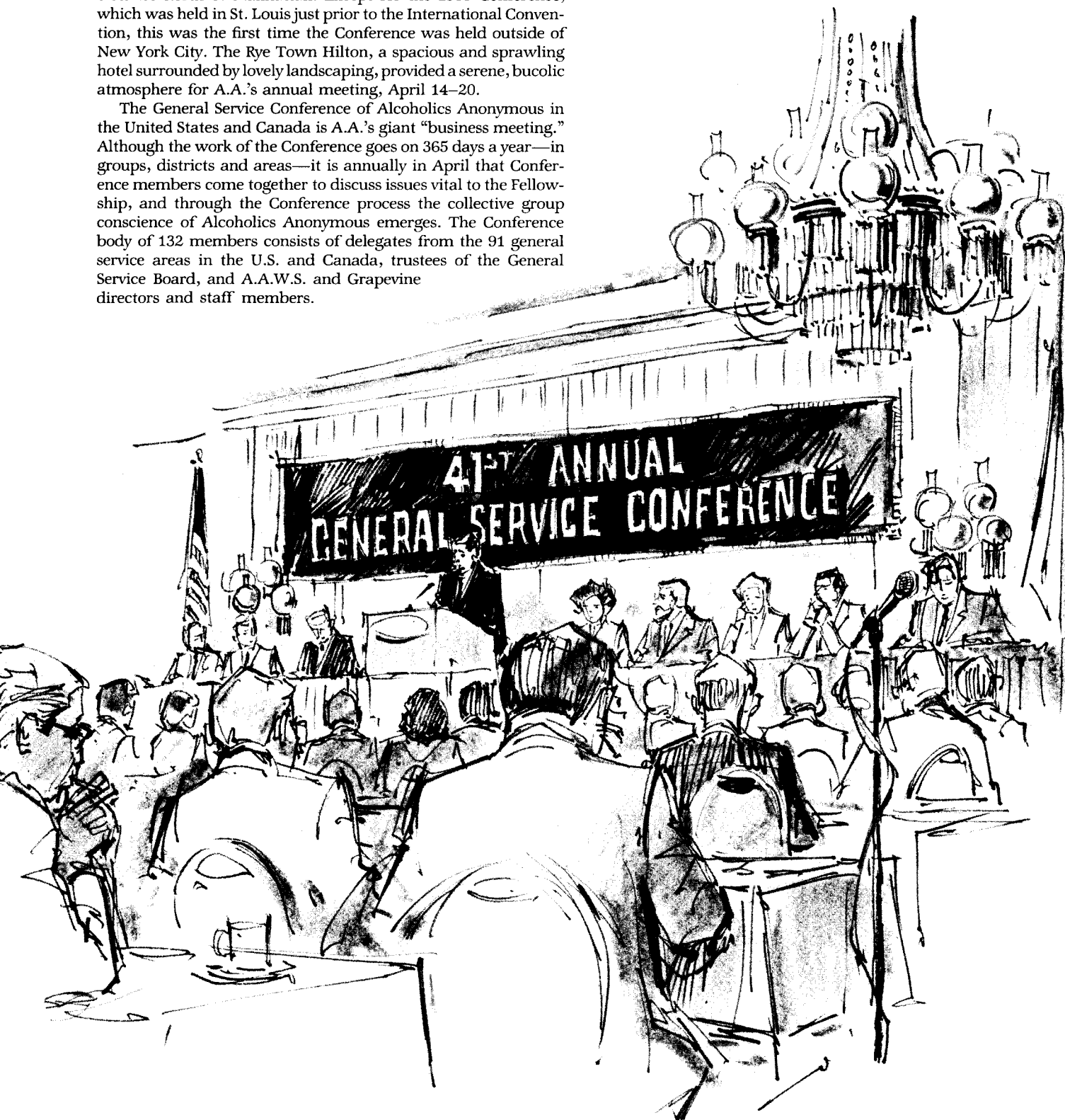
This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

41ST CONFERENCE

Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action

The 41st General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous was held in Rye Brook, New York, in Westchester county, a short distance north of Manhattan. Except for the 1955 Conference, which was held in St. Louis just prior to the International Convention, this was the first time the Conference was held outside of New York City. The Rye Town Hilton, a spacious and sprawling hotel surrounded by lovely landscaping, provided a serene, bucolic atmosphere for A.A.'s annual meeting, April 14-20.

The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada is A.A.'s giant "business meeting." Although the work of the Conference goes on 365 days a year—in groups, districts and areas—it is annually in April that Conference members come together to discuss issues vital to the Fellowship, and through the Conference process the collective group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous emerges. The Conference body of 132 members consists of delegates from the 91 general service areas in the U.S. and Canada, trustees of the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and staff members.



Conference week officially began Sunday afternoon with welcoming remarks by Michael Alexander, chairman of the General Service Board. Then roll was called by G.S.O.'s general manager Wayne Parks, followed by greetings from delegate chairperson Vera Martin, of Southwest Ohio. The keynote address was given by Webb Johnson, trustee-at-large/Canada (see p. 7). Eileen Gatz, G.S.O. staff member, served as Conference Coordinator, went over the general "housekeeping" items for the coming week. Throughout the week Mike and Wayne alternated chairing the general sessions.

Sunday evening, following the opening dinner, there was an A.A. meeting, chaired by delegate Dan Peterson, Western Ontario. Led by Marty Garry, New Hampshire, the speakers were Dan Gramke, delegate from Wyoming; Marc Pineau, Eastern Canada regional trustee; Sam Sibley, delegate from Georgia; Ann Warner, Grapevine executive editor; and Pat Rosenstiel, G.S.O. staff.

Throughout the week there were five more formal A.A. meetings. The Conference Serenity Meeting gathered each morning at 7:30. The open meeting usually had 40 or so in attendance and the topic each day centered around a daily reading in *Daily Reflections*. During the week a copy of *Daily Reflections* was passed around for everyone to sign on the page of their A.A. anniversary date; Friday the book was raffled off. In the spirit of the Seventh Tradition the Serenity Group contributed to the General Service Office at the end of the week. One may be sure that throughout the week there were also many "informal" A.A. meetings, along the wooded paths and running track surrounding the Rye Town, and a hearty group gathered each night around 11:00 in the hot tub at the end of the lobby swimming pool for more A.A. sharing.

The theme for the 41st Conference was "Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action." In 1992, at the 42nd Conference, the theme selected by the Conference Agenda Committee and approved by the Conference, will be "The A.A. Message in a Changing World."

In general sessions throughout this busy week, Conference members heard presentations based on the Conference theme, as well as a wide variety of topics (see p. 13). Reports were given on the year's activities of the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards, as well as the trustees' committees. New delegates (Panel 41) gave Service Highlights from their areas (see p. 50) and there was time to squeeze in one lunch-time workshop, based on the Conference theme (see p. 9). Three "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions afforded Conference members the opportunity to raise questions that were not already on standing committee agendas.

Other activities during the week included a Tuesday afternoon trip into New York City to visit the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices and view items in the A.A. Archives that are so much a part of our history. On the way to G.S.O. the buses drove past 475 Riverside Drive so delegates could see the new quarters that G.S.O. and Grapevine will be occupying in 1992.

Many delegates bring spouses, friends and children to Conference week. A hospitality suite is provided and A.A. and Al-Anon volunteers arranged trips into Manhattan for these guests. Some shopped, went to the theater, visited Ellis Island and other New York sites and landmarks.

Delegates are assigned by lot to the 11 standing Conference Committees. It is during these committee meetings that the lion's share of Conference work is done. Committees review the suggestions and recommendations of the corresponding trustees' committees and make their recommendations to the entire Conference. Many result in Conference Advisory Actions (see p. 10). For example, the Grapevine Committee discussed the need for a Spanish article in each issue; this recommendation was approved and Grapevine will begin including an article in Spanish beginning with the September issue. Treatment Facilities approved the

manuscript for a new pamphlet, "Bridging the Gap—Between Treatment and A.A. Through Temporary Contact Programs." Conference Literature approved the proposed Twelve Steps Illustrated pamphlet, in response to an expressed need for simplified literature. The Public Information Committee reviewed the Membership Survey and suggested some changes. Conference members also viewed pilot footage for a 15-minute video that the P.I. Committee is developing that targets younger people and minorities.

The Conference Committee on the International Convention, working late into the night, selected three potential sites for the International Convention in the year 2000. The cities recommended, in alphabetical order, were Atlanta, Minnesota and Toronto. Following a site-inspection tour of these cities the General Service Board will make a final decision late in 1991.

Trustees elections were held Wednesday afternoon. Ann Bruning of Ft. Smith, Arkansas will be the new Southwest regional trustee, replacing the late Jan Kelly Williamson. Northeast regional will be Jake Ham, of Winthrop, Maine, replacing the rotating John Sharkey. Elected trustee-at-large/Canada is David O'Leary, of St. John's, Newfoundland, who will assume the position formerly held by Webb Johnson.

The closing brunch on Sunday morning began with opening remarks by Michael Alexander and the reading of "How It Works" by Rod Brown, Iowa, who will be the delegate chairperson at next year's Conference.

The brunch is a bittersweet time of saying goodbye to the rotating trustees. A great sadness throughout this Conference was the loss of regional trustee Jan Kelly Williamson, who was killed in a tragic accident in November. Jan would have been one of the rotating trustees. John Sharkey said, "I'm sure she is in this room today," a sentiment felt by all who had the privilege of knowing this lovely lady.

Both rotating trustees—Webb Johnson, trustee-at-large/Canada, and John Sharkey, Northeast regional trustee—recalled their first A.A. meeting and the journey that brought them to this important moment in their service life. Webb said that now that he is rotating his mail carrier would wonder about the decline in mail from New York. Webb's journey as a trustee took him to the Third General Service Conference in Poland, to the Soviet Union and to Munich for the recent World Service Meeting. The "biggest blessing has been sobriety—but second to that is service," Webb told the audience.

Eighteen years ago, when John Sharkey received his 90-day pin at his home group in New Jersey, he doubted that anyone in the room said, "This guy will be a trustee someday." Although he did not use the word, John echoed the Conference theme of "sponsorship" when he spoke of the trustees who had helped him when he was a newcomer to the board; now he would call Jake Ham, who will replace him, and pass on his experience.

In closing, Michael Alexander told members of the 41st General Service Conference, "What we have done this week is simply add to the foundation upon which A.A. will continue to build and therefore to grow. We have one significant aid that most of our predecessors did not have. That is the ease of communication through which we can communicate with each other and the rest of the world. That gives us opportunities that our predecessors did not possess and therefore the vast opportunity to go forward in a way that they could not. We worked in harmony during the week. We worked in ways that are mysterious to people who do not know the A.A. process. We managed to get to the right destination by unpredictable means—but it happened!"

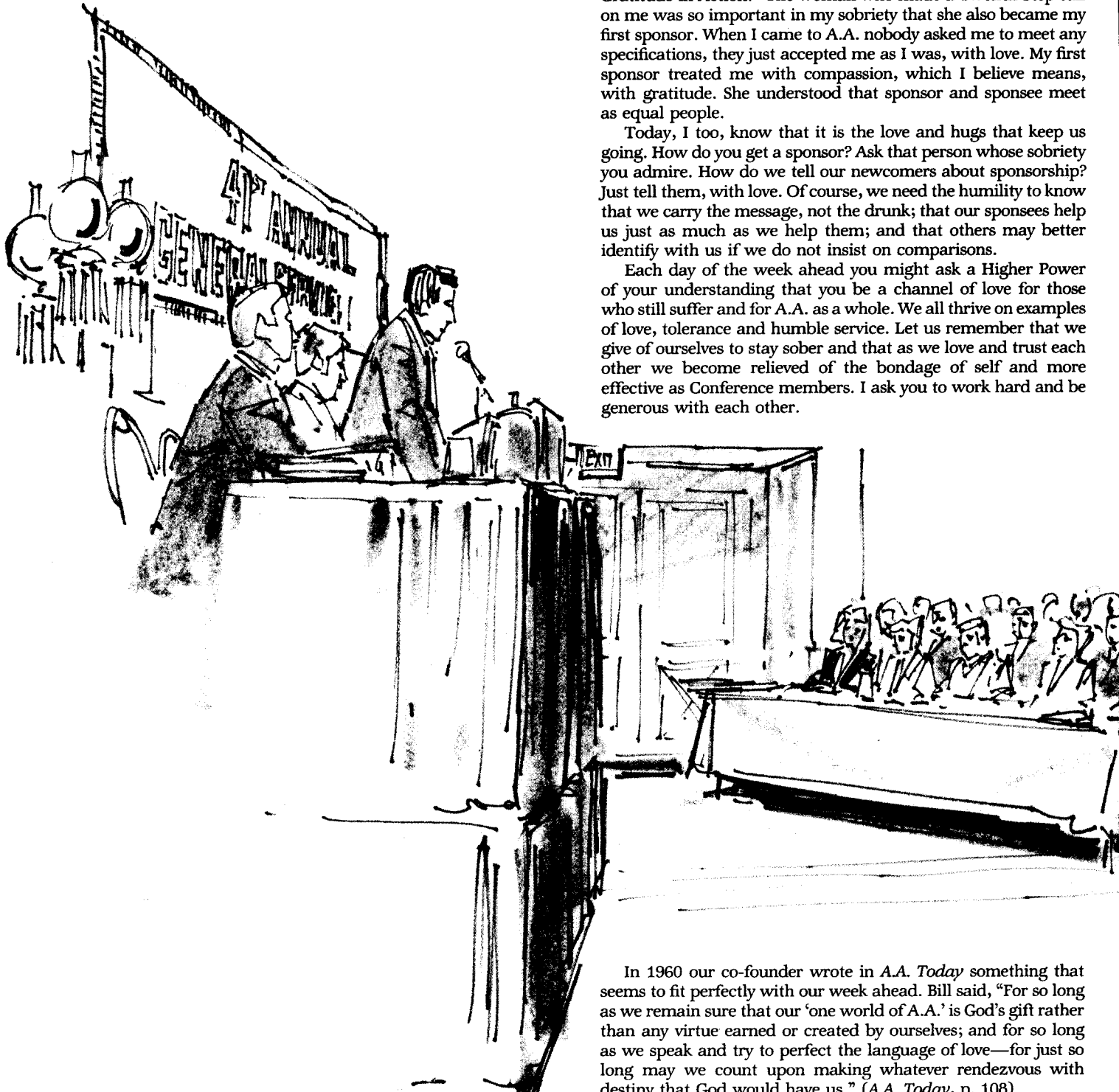
**Greetings from
Delegate Chairperson**

It is my great privilege to greet all of you today. In the coming week we will focus on better extending the hand of A.A. to those who suffer. Through our committee system we trusted servants have the responsibility to work creatively and with an open mind on gathering ideas for reaching out to those who seek us.

What a joy it is for me that our theme is "Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action." The woman who made a Twelfth-Step call on me was so important in my sobriety that she also became my first sponsor. When I came to A.A. nobody asked me to meet any specifications, they just accepted me as I was, with love. My first sponsor treated me with compassion, which I believe means, with gratitude. She understood that sponsor and sponsee meet as equal people.

Today, I too, know that it is the love and hugs that keep us going. How do you get a sponsor? Ask that person whose sobriety you admire. How do we tell our newcomers about sponsorship? Just tell them, with love. Of course, we need the humility to know that we carry the message, not the drunk; that our sponsees help us just as much as we help them; and that others may better identify with us if we do not insist on comparisons.

Each day of the week ahead you might ask a Higher Power of your understanding that you be a channel of love for those who still suffer and for A.A. as a whole. We all thrive on examples of love, tolerance and humble service. Let us remember that we give of ourselves to stay sober and that as we love and trust each other we become relieved of the bondage of self and more effective as Conference members. I ask you to work hard and be generous with each other.



In 1960 our co-founder wrote in *A.A. Today* something that seems to fit perfectly with our week ahead. Bill said, "For so long as we remain sure that our 'one world of A.A.' is God's gift rather than any virtue earned or created by ourselves; and for so long as we speak and try to perfect the language of love—for just so long may we count upon making whatever rendezvous with destiny that God would have us." (*A.A. Today*, p. 108)

Vera Martin (Southwest Ohio)
delegate chairperson

Keynote Address

I spent twelve glorious days in December 1968 in a high-class detox called Hastings Hospital—near the Don Jail in Toronto—which was an early experiment of the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario. The detox was the experiment—not the jail. The Toronto hospitals and institutions committee sponsored an abbreviated A.A. meeting on the two Tuesday evenings I was there and I was quite impressed with the moderator and the man and woman who shared at the meeting. They were not what I thought at the time to be alcoholics. Alcoholics were these guys from skid row and the downtown missions who were in the ward with me.

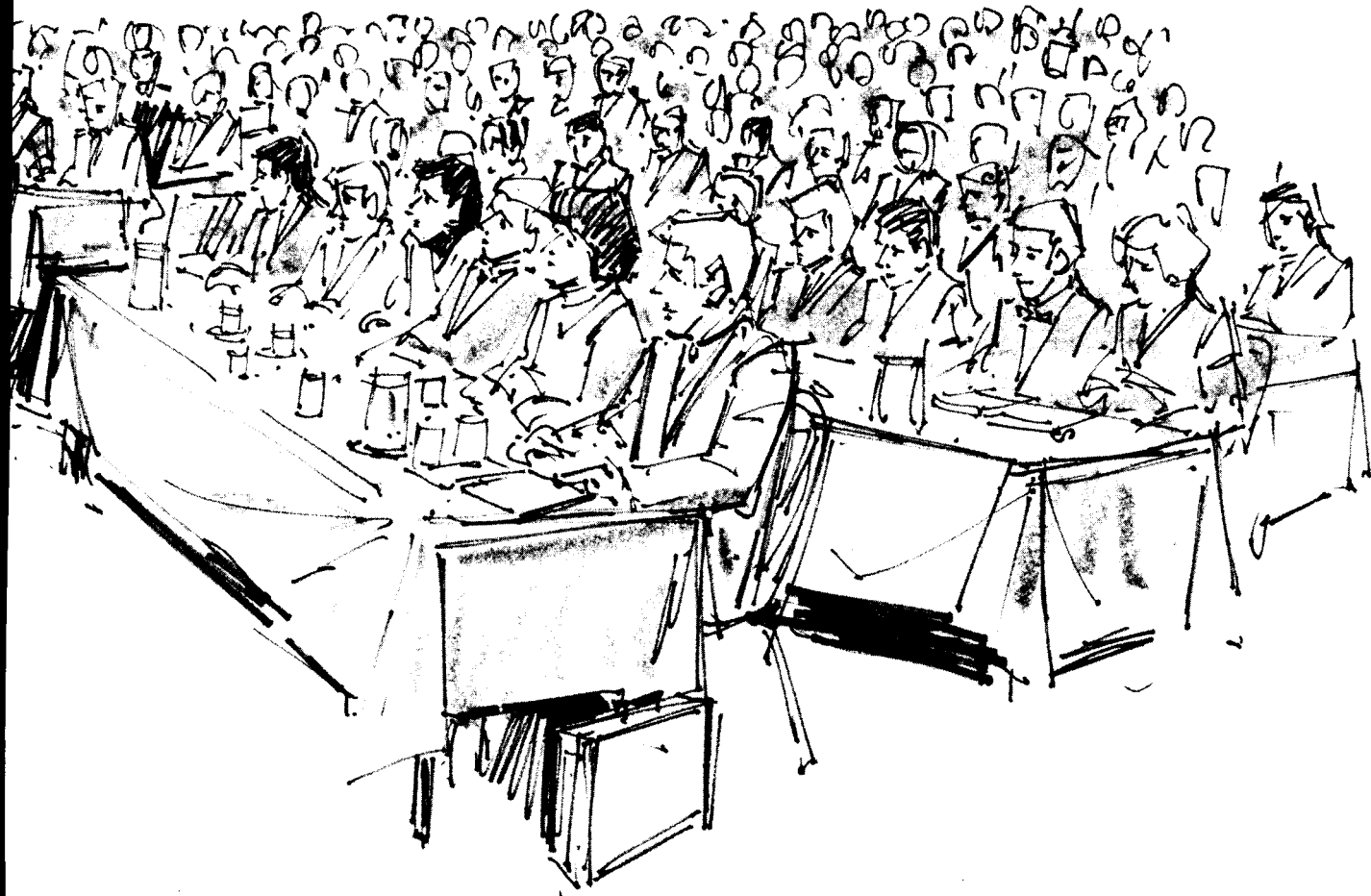
Anyway, I got out just before Christmas and refused the sleeping pills and antabuse they offered and stayed sober all the way up to New Year's Eve, when I got drunk. In a few days I was as bad or worse than when I checked into the hospital. Those two A.A. meetings had planted a seed and about mid-January I walked into a meeting in north Toronto and found a lot of people like us. I got a meeting directory and attended quite a few open meetings and wound up at the Don Mills Group where I was invited to attend something called a Step meeting. They happened to be on Step Five that night, and being rather gung-ho, I decided, why not? There was this guy I had noticed at the meetings. He didn't quiver and shake when they asked him to read something and he had long-term sobriety, having received his one-year cake a couple of weeks earlier. I invited him to my home to do a Fifth Step and when we had been sitting in my rec room for quite a while I suggested that we get at it. He responded that we could start as soon as my wife finished whatever she was doing upstairs

and joined us. I didn't know much, as you can surmise, but I did know that Step Five called for admission—to God, to ourselves and to another human being—the exact nature of our wrongs. My wife did not fit any of those categories and had we proceeded, my sponsor would have had to make room for me on his couch that night.

I relate that experience to illustrate an important point on sponsorship. You've got to give it away to keep it, but you can't give away what you haven't got. Instead of telling me that it might be better to tackle the first four Steps before trying Step Five, he may have gotten a "warm fuzzy" from being singled out by this newcomer. I wonder who his sponsor was? That night was the end of that sponsor and the beginning of the end of my first attempt at the program.

On June 5, 1970, after 15 months of you-know-what, I got back here and stayed. I got into service at my second meeting when they made me a greeter. They figured that if you're going to shake anyway, you could put it to some use at the front door. I did all the menial tasks around the group, like setting up chairs, making coffee, picking up chairs and ashtrays and washing up. The only job I didn't do was to sweep the floor. We had one guy there who was a former racketeer and if anybody tried to touch that broom after the meeting he would give you a look that made you think of cement overshoes. That was his job and he wasn't giving it up.

After some weeks I ran into a man who I had known most of my life—from public school onward. He and I used to get in some scrapes together and were both quite undisciplined. We had cracked our first bottle of wine together and continued when we could afford it. He had dropped out of sight many years



before and I found out why. He had 11 years of sobriety. Seeing him sober was probably the strongest statement A.A. could have made to me at that time. I told him that he was going to be my sponsor and he agreed, on the conditions that I didn't leave town for a year while I cleaned up my mess, that I joined a group and that I would do the Steps and get active. I followed that advice and as a result have enjoyed a varied, interesting, exciting and probably life-saving service career, the highlight being this very moment.

When I received the loving invitation to do the keynote address, I went to my favorite reference book, *The A.A. Way of Life*, now called *As Bill Sees It*, a reader by Bill. In the index under sponsorship it said to see twelfth-stepping. In its eleventh printing, twelfth-stepping is referred to on 22 pages. Twelfth-stepping for our own sobriety is mentioned on ten pages. Page 13 of this book quotes page S7 of *The A.A. Service Manual* as follows: "A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society for alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die."

The A.A. Way of Life was first published in 1967 when it was still a fact of life that we got to call on wet drunks. You could probably count the number of treatment centers without having to take off your shoes. Times change. At the risk of sounding like Tommy Hills, I will quote a few stats from our recently published 1989 Membership Survey. Factors most responsible for members coming to A.A. (two responses were permitted): through an A.A. member: 34 percent; treatment facility: 30 percent; self-motivated (on my own): 27 percent; family: 19 percent; counseling agency: 10 percent; doctor: 7 percent; employee or fellow worker: 6 percent; non-A.A. friend or neighbor: 4 percent; Al-Anon or Alateen member: 4 percent; media: 3 percent; A.A. literature: 3 percent. The survey also states that 68 percent of the members received some sort of treatment or counseling before coming to A.A. This indicates that sponsors are not necessarily twelfth-stepers any more but are grateful members willing to be available to newcomers coming out of treatment.

Some further statistics were revealed at the general sharing session at the February board weekend. The topic was "reaching the alcoholics in prison." More than 350,000 persons are incarcerated in local jails run by cities, towns and counties and 715,000 are in prisons run by federal, state and provincial authorities. More than one million persons are locked away from society. In addition, there are two other significant criminal justice populations: 407,000 parolees and more than 2.4 million people placed on probation supervision in lieu of incarceration. What an opportunity to express gratitude through sponsorship by sharing behind the walls or by being available to help bridge the gap for those being released.

We are all familiar with the one-on-one aspect of sponsorship as far as initial recovery is concerned. But do we get them into *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, "Pass it On," or *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers* to let them know what they belong to? To see the trials, errors and heartbreak that those early members had to suffer to give us what we have today?

I am going to quote a few paragraphs from a paper entitled "The World Service Meeting—A History."

Alcoholics Anonymous began spreading to other countries in the 1940s, not as the result of a decision of some faceless executive in a headquarters office, but rather by one concerned and caring alcoholic, sober in A.A., reaching out to help a still-suffering alcoholic elsewhere in the world. In that decade, the message was carried by A.A. members in the armed services, during World War II and in the occupation forces afterward. It was carried by travelers; it was carried by seamen, or "Internationalists" as they came to be called; and by

members employed in overseas countries—the early "Loners." It was carried by the media, especially by a 1946 *Reader's Digest* article on A.A. When it was printed in the foreign editions of the *Digest* it brought calls for help to the New York service office from as far away as South Africa and New Zealand.

This spread of A.A. around the world was exciting to the "headquarters" staff and deeply gratifying to co-founder Bill W. In May 1950, Bill and Lois went to Europe for the express purpose of visiting A.A. in Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Holland, France, England and Ireland. And by 1955, Bill was able to declare, at the St. Louis Convention, that "A.A. had established beachheads in seventy foreign lands." In ensuing years, those "beachheads" evolved into groups, the groups established their own service offices, their own publishing operations for A.A. literature and elected their own service boards.

The General Service Conference Charter, drafted in the late 1940s by Bill W. and Bernard Smith, Class A (nonalcoholic) chairperson of the General Service Board, and adopted in 1955, envisioned that the U.S./Canada Conference would eventually have "Sections" in foreign countries. Instead, however, each country has developed its own autonomous service structure. Most are patterned to a greater or lesser degree after the U.S./Canada model—but they are all independent.

It was against this background that Bill W. began thinking, in the mid-1960s, of a worldwide service meeting. From his personal observations during his 1950 trip to Europe and his subsequent correspondence with A.A. pioneers in many other lands, Bill was aware of how the fledgling service structures were floundering.

He realized their need for A.A. literature in their own languages, the obstacles to growth posed by the ignorance of professionals in their countries, the arguments and controversies that arose within their ranks, and their fears of all kinds of calamities. In these respects, he saw strong parallels (as he wrote Dr. Bob) with "our own pioneering time in Akron, Cleveland and New York."

Planning got underway in 1967, and as a result, the first World Service Meeting was held in New York in 1969, the second in New York in 1972 and it has been held every even-numbered year since then, alternating between New York and a foreign country. (See John Quinn's report on the Eleventh World Service Meeting in the Presentation section of this *Report*.)

As a result of recent historic events taking place in a number of Eastern European countries, we are witnessing and participating in the opportunity to carry the message to millions of previously unreachable people. We will be hearing discussions about who should be picking up the tab and how long this should be a free lunch for these people. It would be hard to expect people to understand the spiritual aspect of self-support until it is explained to them in their own language. We are getting help from other foreign service entities, but mainly in warehousing and distribution of the materials we provide.

At the risk of shocking some of our first-term Conference members, I feel that I should point out that our deliberations and discussions this week may not be conducted 100 percent harmoniously. In fact, by Tuesday or Wednesday, you might be wondering if you could get a cheap fare home because your sensitivities have been assaulted. I guarantee that by Kleenex time next Saturday morning we will all love and respect one another, knowing that we did our best to perpetuate this Fellowship by finding ways to more effectively carry the message to a wider range of sufferers.

W.F. (Webb) Johnson, trustee-at-large/Canada

Workshop

Thursday Conference members split up into groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme, "Sponsorship—Gratitude in Action." Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 What is Sponsorship?

An A.A. sponsor, the conferees generally agreed, is someone who takes on the role of guide to a newer member, sharing their experience, strength and hope, thus opening up for the newcomer the entire A.A. program. A sponsor offers concern, hope, care and love. Sponsorship is a way to "pass it on," in friendship, through the power of example.

a How does it differ from Twelfth Step work?

A Twelfth Step contact is not nearly as personal as the long-term, one-on-one commitment sponsorship usually entails. An individual getting a Twelfth Step visitor has not selected that A.A. member, but they can make their own choice of sponsors. In addition, while sponsorship can be considered a form of Twelfth Step work, it actually runs much deeper, producing in both sponsor and sponsee the experience of a shared journey, a two-way commitment.

b Ought you always to have a sponsor—and be a sponsor?

There's no getting around having a sponsor, if you want to achieve and maintain a meaningful sobriety, everyone seemed to agree—although this is not necessarily the case in *being* a sponsor. Still, it's a good idea to try to be a sponsor because this is yet another tool that helps our own growth. *Having* a sponsor, on the other hand, is a matter of survival and is, therefore, a must. In a nutshell: A.A. would not be A.A. without sponsorship.

2 How does your group explain and encourage sponsorship?

a To newcomers.

Generally, groups "keep talking about it," or they hold sponsorship topic meetings, or hand out the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" to every newcomer who passes through the door, or they urge new members to get involved in the group as quickly as possible. Specifically, many groups maintain temporary sponsorship programs, or they assign sponsors to newcomers who ask for one and keep available newcomer information packets. Quite a few conferees agreed, however, that this aspect of "carrying the message" needs more attention and discussion.

b To potential sponsors.

Awareness is the key here. Frequently the topic is talked about at business meetings. Sponsors are urged to read the pamphlet on sponsorship and group members are reminded of the importance of giving newcomers their phone numbers. Some areas hold a Sponsorship Month, and some groups have meetings with a Sponsor.

c To treatment and court-referred people.

In addition to signing court slips or attesting to the referred newcomers' physical presence at meetings, groups stress to these newcomers that "treatment is not A.A." Thereafter, they have a temporary sponsor assigned to them or they are urged to pick one themselves or, in some areas, they're part of the Bridge the Gap program. Again, the pamphlet on sponsorship is always available.

3 How can sponsors avoid becoming "gurus"?

First and foremost, by having a sponsor! It's also helpful to focus on the sponsees, stay "in touch with a Higher Power," and to remember that each one of us has to "walk the walk." Another

reminder: Don't take yourself too seriously—we're all drunks!

a Ought there be a limit on how long or how many people one member should sponsor?

As to both points, if someone agrees to be a sponsor he or she should make sure there's ample time to do the job. Otherwise, the sense of workshop participants was that these decisions were individual matters based on good judgment, with a necessary emphasis on the healthy sobriety of sponsor and sponsee. It's frequently a good idea for both to spend some time together before a long-term commitment is made.

b When a newcomer asks, should you always say "yes" to being a sponsor?

Yes, was the prevailing view. "When we came to A.A. we expected rejection, so it's very important to say 'yes' to newcomers," wrote one Conference member. Still, there should be conditions: use common sense; if it's not working out, help the newcomer find another sponsor or try it, by mutual agreement, on a temporary basis. Sponsorship carries with it definite responsibilities, therefore, take it on with care.

4 What emphasis do you give to service sponsorship?

This question triggered a lot of group area inventories and many agreed that a lot more emphasis could be placed on this area of service. While it's been in existence a long time, "very little has been addressed to formalize the work of service sponsorship—even in the pamphlet on sponsorship!" said one workshop representative.

a At your A.A. group.

Take an interest in G.S.R.s, or bring someone to service meetings. If you're a delegate, talk about service. Some districts keep a list of service sponsors. The group is a good place to encourage this type of service, though many fall short of doing enough. One way to improve it: encourage group inventories and share personal experiences on service.

b At your area assembly.

Show fellow A.A. members what things you did to help yourself be a better service sponsor and what areas you missed; invite others to bring someone to assemblies, discuss it at area roundups and conventions, wherever service people are represented; help guide newer persons through service. The overwhelming sense was that G.S.R.s are the most important link between groups and area assemblies and they have the responsibility of assisting at district *and* area assembly meetings, and of being well acquainted with the A.A. *Service Manual*.

Neither Rain nor Snow nor Dark of Night— nor Broken Bones . . .

On the way to the Conference, Charlie Oakes (Panel 40, Western Michigan) and his wife Karen were in an auto accident. They still made their plane and during the flight Charlie's arm began to swell and pain. He was treated temporarily in a New York City emergency room—then on to Rye and the Conference. During the week Charlie saw a local doctor several times for his broken arm—but was still present for all Conference sessions.

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference.

FLOOR ACTIONS

It was recommended that:

1 The 1992 General Service Conference annual meeting be held in the city of New York.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

2 The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1992 General Service Conference be as follows: the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.

3 The theme for the 1992 General Service Conference be: The A.A. Message in a Changing World.

4 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1992 General Service Conference:

- a) The A.A. Message in a Changing World
 - 1 Our Common Welfare
 - 2 Unity: Together We Can
 - 3 The Language of the Heart Worldwide
- b) The Joy of Living
 - 1 The Newcomer: A.A.'s Future
 - 2 Principles before Personalities
 - 3 Humility through Rotation
- c) Love and Service
- d) G.S.O. Finances

5 There be one workshop for the 1992 General Service Conference, with the topic to be on the Conference theme.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

6 The Preamble, the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions be added to the following pamphlets: "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs," "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" and "If You Are a Professional," when pamphlets are reprinted. Estimated cost: \$5,000.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

7 The trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee produce a 60-minute audiotape of selected stories from the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, including culturally varied voices and

some female stories, in response to an expressed need for audio-visual material. Estimated cost: \$2,475.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

8 The format of the Finances presentation of the financial information at the General Service Conference be reviewed and that any revisions or changes be considered and forwarded to Conference Finance Committee members prior to the end of the year.

9 The pamphlet "Self-Supporting Through Our Own Contributions" not be changed at this time, as there was insufficient input; and that there be further input from the areas prior to any action.

10 The adaptation of the "Self-Supporting Through Our Own Contributions" pamphlet tailored to reflect the Quebec areas self-support system not receive Conference approval, because there is already existing Conference-approved literature dealing with the subject.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

11 The Grapevine discontinue publishing the "About Alcoholism" section.

12 Because of an expressed need, the Grapevine commence as soon as possible to include at least one article in Spanish in each month's issue.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

It was recommended that:

13 The undernoted three (3) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be given equal consideration as a site for the International Convention in the year 2000: Atlanta; Minneapolis; Toronto.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

14 The A.A. History book project continue to completion, and that a manuscript be forwarded to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee for consideration and approval.

15 The eleven minor changes suggested by the trustees' Literature Committee and revised by this committee be included at the next printing of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, with the exception of insert #2 containing the six-point definition of an A.A. group, which will be deleted.

16 The "Circles of Love and Service" filmstrip, slides and video not be updated, and that these visual formats be discontinued once the present inventory is depleted. Thereafter, should there be requests for a copy of the video format, it will be provided at cost.

17 The proposed Twelve Steps Illustrated pamphlet be published, in response to an expressed need for simplified literature. Estimated cost: \$7,000.

18 a) A story of a young person who entered A.A. while in prison be added to the "Young People and A.A." pamphlet.

b) The trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee obtain appropriate stories of several young people who entered A.A. while in juvenile correctional facilities, and forward these to the trustees' Literature Committee for consideration.

- c) The trustees' Literature Committee forward one such story to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee for consideration and addition to the "Young People and A.A." pamphlet.
- 19 a) The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be added to *Daily Reflections* at the time of the next printing.
- b) The text of the proposed reflection titled "One A.A. Miracle" be substituted for the present February 29th entry in *Daily Reflections* at the next printing, because of the duplication of entries in the current printing.
- 20 The trustees' Literature Committee study the best possible ways to carry our message to minorities through illustrations and text in A.A. literature, including existing publications and audio and visual formats, and report their findings to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee.
- 21 At the next printing of "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" pamphlet, the line "It is significant that the 'Twelve Concepts for World Service' is the *only* piece of Conference-approved literature that carries a personal by-line: 'by Bill W.,' " be deleted, as that statement is no longer accurate.
- 22 *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* be published in large print, in response to an expressed need. Estimated cost of proof-reading: \$500.
- 23 The questionnaires in seven Conference-approved pamphlets not be standardized, as the questions in each are targeted to specific populations.
- 24 The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be included in all recovery literature, wherever possible.

POLICY / ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 25 The 44th General Service Conference be held April 17-23, 1994, with an alternative date of April 10-16, 1994, if needed for hotel availability, since these dates do not conflict with certain religious holidays.
- 26 The policy for establishing new delegate areas in place at this time, as described concisely in *The A.A. Service Manual*, is adequate to allow for the gradual growth of the Conference, and provides for a representative cross-section of A.A.
- 27 The trustees' Conference Committee consider a presentation/discussion topic on New Delegate Areas for the 1992 Conference, focusing on existing delegate areas, procedures for new delegate areas and future A.A. growth.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 28 a) The following ten changes on the 1992 Membership Survey Questionnaire in a report from the trustees' Membership Survey subcommittee be approved:
 - 1 Add the meeting name to the top of the form (on the same line as Town/City, State, Date).
 - 2 The statement of purpose at the top of the questionnaire conform to the one used in the final brochure. The current brochure copy (1989) is as follows: The purpose of the survey has been to keep A.A. members informed on current trends in membership characteristics, and to provide

information about Alcoholics Anonymous to the professional community and to the general public as part of the effort to reach those who still suffer from alcoholism.

3 Combine categories 1 and 2 in question #5 into one question which would read: 1. Newspaper, magazine, radio or TV.

4 Add a category to question #5 (just above the last one, 15. Other) which would read: 14. Court order.

5 It was suggested that the categories listed in question #8, ("What is the general nature of your employment now?") be changed to accepted and established standard categories.

6 That question #9, "What is the specific nature of your employment now?", be eliminated from the questionnaire.

7 To eliminate the question #10b on questionnaire. ("Is it at the group at which you are filling out this questionnaire?")

8 Regarding the counseling questions: eliminate numbers #12b and #13b which reads:

What was the most helpful (Check one)
 Medical Psychological Spiritual Other

9 Omit question #16 which reads: "Does your doctor present A.A. as a program of recovery to his patients?"

10 Omit question #17 which reads: "Has your doctor been to an A.A. meeting?"

- b) The trustees' Public Information Committee, in preparing the 1992 Membership Survey Questionnaire, reconsider Question #14 of the 1989 Membership Survey Questionnaire ("In addition to your alcoholism, were you addicted to drugs?"), and that the trustees' P.I. Committee forward their findings with an explanation of their decision to the Conference Public Information Committee at least one month prior to the start of the 1992 General Service Conference.

29 The pilot footage for a video targeting younger people and minorities be approved, and that the 15-minute video production be authorized at a total cost of \$82,000 and be presented to the 1992 Conference for final approval.

30 The trustees' Committee on Public Information be authorized to spend \$4,000 for storyboards or other visual aids that outline a proposed film or video on the Traditions with focus on anonymity, and bring their proposals for production to the 1992 Conference.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

31 The six-point description of an A.A. Group in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* be deleted, and be replaced by the following:

The Long Form of Tradition Three and a section of Warranty Six, Concept XII, aptly describe what an A.A. Group is:

Tradition Three:

"Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together

for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation.”

Warranty Six:

“... much attention has been drawn to the extraordinary liberties which the A.A. Traditions accord to the individual member and to his group: no penalties to be inflicted for nonconformity to A.A. principles; no fees or dues to be levied—voluntary contributions only; no member to be expelled from A.A.—membership always to be the choice of the individual; each A.A. group to conduct its internal affairs as it wishes—it being merely requested to abstain from acts that might injure A.A. as a whole; and finally that any group of alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group provided that, as a group, they have no other purpose or affiliation.”

32 The existing footnote 7, Concept XI in *The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service*, be deleted, as it pertains to merit pay, until the General Service Board seeks and obtains Conference approval of merit pay, being mindful that Bill notes in the introduction to the Concepts: “The future advocates of structural change need only make out a strong case for their recommendations—a case convincing to both the Trustees and to the Conference.”

33 The present system of distribution of the General Service Conference *Final Report* (1988 Advisory Action #73: “The Conference *Final Report* be sent to all G.S.R.s with the distribution method and quantity determined by the delegate.”) be continued.

34 The estimated cost of recommendations be included in the Conference *Final Report*.

35 The text describing How A.A. Chooses (nontrustee) Directors for A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, and How A.A. Chooses Appointed Committee Members be included in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

36 The manuscript prepared by the trustees’ Committee on Treatment Facilities for a pamphlet on bridging the gap be approved, because of the need to encourage A.A. members to serve as temporary contacts to help the alcoholic in treatment make the transition into A.A.

37 The *Treatment Facilities Newsletter* be distributed semi-annually for the purpose of sharing information among committees carrying the A.A. message into treatment facilities, and that it continue to be mailed to district committee members, delegates, alternate delegates and trustees in addition to members of treatment facilities committees. Estimated cost: \$5,500.

38 Once supplies are depleted, the pamphlet “A.A. in Treatment Facilities” be revised to include information about “Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous” and other Conference-approved videos/films relevant to treatment, by inserting the following text just preceding “A few plain suggestions . . .”:

The video “Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous” explains the principles of A.A. and is a wonderful tool for A.A.s making presentations to administrators and staff as well as carrying the message of recovery.

This is for the purpose of increasing the Fellowship’s awareness of our audiovisual materials.

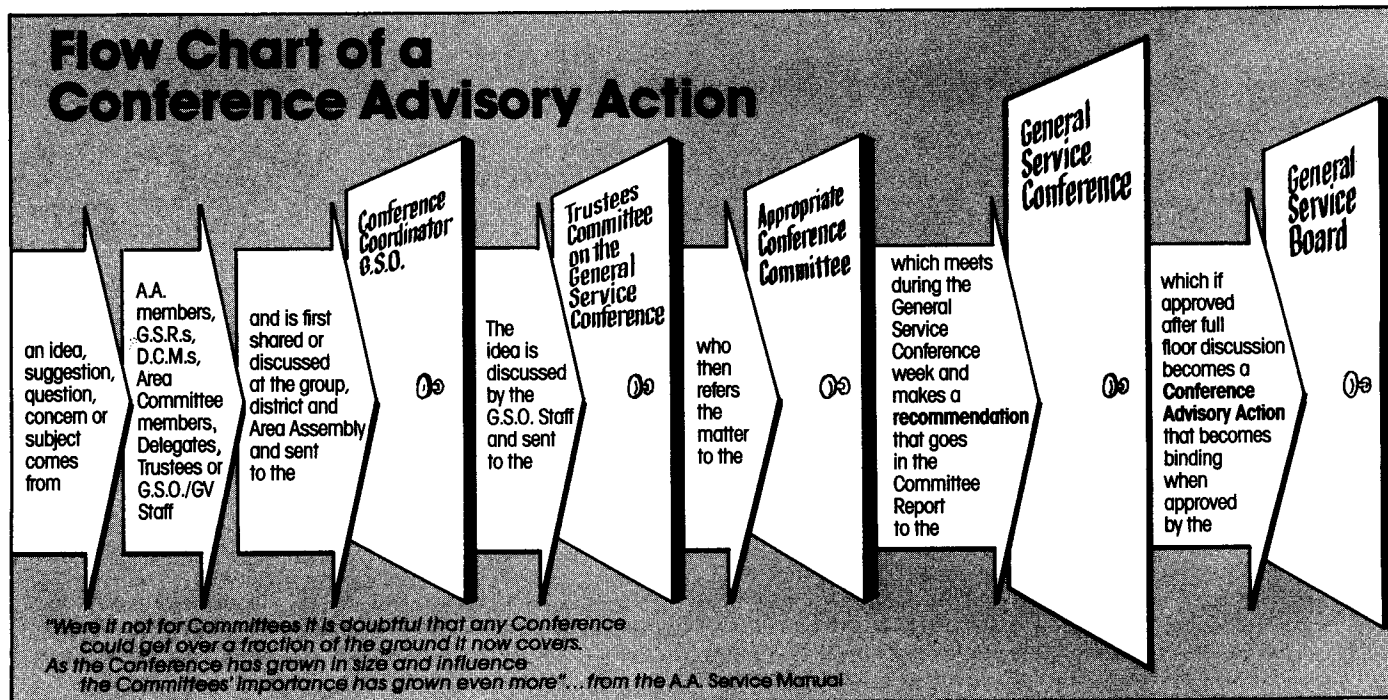
TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

39 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1991 (see page 00; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees’ Nominating Committee).

40 The following slate of directors be elected to the A.A. World Services Corporate Board be elected (see page 00; slate of directors approved).

41 The following slate of directors be elected to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 00; slate of directors approved).



Presentations Illuminate Noteworthy Topics

SPONSORSHIP: GRATITUDE IN ACTION

The first presentation session of the 1991 Conference began at 10:40 a.m. Monday. Richard Sarahman, delegate from N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan, moderated the session, which focused on the 1991 Conference theme, Sponsorship—Gratitude in Action.

Help and Hope

When I first came into A.A. I was helpless and I believed I was hopeless. By joining a group I began to feel like I belonged. They asked me to be a greeter and this made me feel a little more like a part of the group. It also allowed me to get into action and to meet many of the local members.

They later asked me to be the "bookie" for the group. This gave me positive feelings of self-worth. The group trusted me and I was able to see a light at the end of the tunnel. The job of bookie taught me to ask for help and to be responsible. It helped me to get out of myself. It was at this point that I began to speak in A.A. This is where I first felt the presence of the Creator in my life.

My presentation is on help and hope. The experiences that I have just related gave me the help and hope that I too would be able to stay sober and maybe, to get happy. The feeling that I could ask for help has stood me in good stead in all the areas of my life. These experiences were the result of sponsorship on the individual and group levels. If a group practices sponsorship and if it is a group that uses action with its new members, it is a group that "works" the meaning of gratitude in action. This group creates an atmosphere of help and hope. This group shows

and puts into action the principle of sponsorship and this helps the new member to have a foundation for using sponsorship in all areas of life.

I moved to New Brunswick, Canada, after one year of sobriety and the group I joined made me their G.S.R. I again received the gift of trust. This group responsibility taught me about humility. It taught me to be more responsible and to do for others. When I look at the principles of the Traditions and when I try to use these principles in all areas of my life, I become more happy, joyous and free. When I feel happy, joyous and free, I can transmit this feeling to the new members and show them that they also can have this gift.

Today I sponsor a few members. This is the way I have chosen to pass on what was given me. By sharing my experience I give help and hope to the other members.

Today as I look back, I see the wisdom of the oldtimer who told me I had to work for my sobriety. I see the wisdom of the group that got me to greet people at the door. I see the wisdom of the sponsor who had me do Twelfth Step work. Today I see the wisdom of the oldtimers who stayed active to show me the way.

The way to repay these people who gave the help and hope I needed is to pass it on, to continue to stay active and express gratitude. This to me is sponsorship.

In closing I would like to relate a story that to me explains the concepts of sponsorship, gratitude in action, help and hope. It is a story told to me by an old Native North American woman many years ago.

The eagle to us Indians is a very special bird. It represents freedom and courage, and the beauty of an eagle soaring with the air currents cannot be surpassed. In the old days they said that an eagle who soared skyward until out of sight was taking your prayers to the Creator. When the eagle came back into view he was returning with the answer to your prayer.

If you wound that eagle he will fall to the ground and flip over to his back. He does this for protection because his only way to defend himself is with his talons. Even if you try to help him he will try to fight you. He doesn't understand that you want to help and he is afraid.



This reminds me of the drunk lying face down in the gutter. If you try to get him out he will fight you, not because he is mean but because he is afraid and he doesn't understand that you want to help him.

In the case of the eagle, if you can wrap your shirt around him, you can take him to a vet. The vet will put some medicine on the wound and the Creator will heal him. The eagle will again become free to soar with the wind.

If you use your experience of your own life, you can help the man in the gutter to get out of the gutter. If you walk the Twelve Steps in your life, you can guide this man into a new way of life. This man will become free just like the eagle—free to love and to be as the Creator intended.

I love you people because you have given me this freedom and love. In the action of gratitude and sponsorship I will try to give a little help and hope by passing it on. Thank you for your attention and may the Great Creator hold you all in the hollow of His hands.

Guy Frigon, Maine

I Am Responsible

Our Declaration of Responsibility states, "I am responsible . . . When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible."

I must take responsibility for the future of A.A. I must help preserve and protect the program. My life and the lives of future generations depend upon me maintaining this God-given program. I am responsible.

One of the best ways to protect our program is through sponsorship. Sponsorship insures that the hand of an A.A. member will be there for the newcomer in their struggle for sobriety.

As it states on page 89 of the Big Book, "Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics. It works when other activities fail." It therefore seems that the hand of sponsorship is beneficial for both sponsor and sponsee.

When a newcomer reaches for help, I want the hand of a member who is willing to be a sponsor to be there. As it states later on page 89 of the Big Book, "Life will take on new meaning. To watch people recover, to see them help others, to watch loneliness vanish, to see a fellowship grow up about you, to have a host of friends—this is an experience you must not miss."

Sponsorship is important to insure that A.A. will continue. As A.A. members work with sponsors, they learn how the program works and how it will work for them. Once they begin to allow the program to work in their lives, they begin to understand that there is more to sobriety than just not taking a drink a day at a time. The sponsor helps the newcomer understand why they must be willing to be responsible to maintain the Traditions of the program.

Sponsorship doesn't seem to have the importance today that it had in the early days. Too many are allowing the new member to get lost in aftercare programs at treatment centers. Many members scream that the newcomer does not understand what the program is about, does not understand the Traditions, unity or anonymity. Who is there to teach him? It is the responsibility of the members of A.A. to sponsor the newcomer, to help him understand what A.A. is all about. We cannot allow treatment aftercare to keep our newcomers from A.A.

My sponsor was there to suggest the things I needed to do to stay sober. She was there to answer the questions I had about the program. She was there to explain the Steps and to help me

work through them. She was there when I had no mind to think with. She was there to think for me. She was there with the kind of quality sobriety that I wanted. She was there to show me how to achieve quality sobriety. She was responsible.

I, as a sponsor, must be responsible for those I sponsor, to help them achieve the same understanding of the program that was given to me. There is nothing more gratifying than helping others in their recovery from alcoholism.

Dorothy May, Indiana (Southern)

A Way of Life

With my sponsor, Walt, at the wheel, we head north out of Alamogordo under the brilliant blue of the New Mexico sky. Reflecting upon the spring area assembly that has just concluded, we chuckle over some of the issues raised and comments made, yet talk earnestly of others. Our conversation is frequently punctuated by long and comfortable silences. During one such moment of quiet, I glance to my right and notice that Sierra Blanca—White Mountain—has received a fresh dusting of snow. Far off to the left lie the glistening white sands of the missile range. Whiteness. Peace. Calm. Serenity. It suddenly occurs to me that after 12 years Walt is still driving me to meetings!

I think back to when Walt would arrive at my door at 6:30 on Wednesday evening, regular as clockwork. How much I just wanted to be left alone to wallow in my self-pity, to begin another night's bout with the vodka bottle! How I wished that just this once he would forget to come by or have car trouble, or at least more pressing business to attend to than to go to that damn meeting! But no, 6:30 came and there was Walt. And I, still enervated from the previous night's boozing, would drag my aching body out to his car for yet another interminable trip of twenty miles down the mountain to his favorite meeting.

Walt is now the G.S.R. of that group, the Espanola Valley Group, and we still attend those Wednesday night meetings. But we also travel farther and wider together these days, a symbol of our ever-deepening friendship. District meetings, assemblies, round-ups, conventions, the International Convention in Seattle—we've made them all and Walt still does most of the driving. These A.A. journeys have become a way of life for me and for us. I sneak a glance over at him and offer a silent prayer of thanks.

Our Big Book tells us on page 89 that ". . . to see a fellowship grow up about you, to have a host of friends—this is an experience you must not miss." How truly this comes home to me as Walt and I pull in to the aptly named Four Winds Cafe in Carrizozo, fifty miles to the north. For there are Ernie, Julia, Bob and Anna, who are also making the long trip home. Each, in their own way, has also been my "sponsor." Each has shown me a way that I might better work the program of Alcoholics Anonymous in my life.

Take Ernie, for example. While serving as delegate he suffered a severe illness. For a few weeks it didn't look like he was going to make it but his spirit and determination, and the prayers of many hundreds of A.A. members, carried him through with flying colors.

And Julia, whose grace, dedication and competence as central office coordinator, make her, in my mind, the personification of "trusted servant." She is always ready to help when asked and always dutiful to her A.A. work. And good old Bob, whose perseverance in carrying the message to the suffering Native American has become legend in New Mexico, and who, if he can't get 'em in through the front door of this "white man's program," manages to devise cunning ways to get 'em in through the back. And then there is Anna. Sincere, earnest, the chain-

smoking G.S.R. of a non-smoking group—no wonder outsiders have a hard time figuring us out!

These are good friends all, and I thank God for them and for all my friends in this life-giving program of Alcoholics Anonymous. The time we spend together in the Four Winds Cafe will be brief but there will be no sadness when it comes time to part, for "... our joy in escape from disaster does not subside as we go our individual ways." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 17) Why? Because our bonding stems not so much from having shared a common disaster as from our sharing in the common solution. Ordinary experiences, like meeting by chance at a cafe, take on a special aura when shared with such extraordinary people. We feel safe, we feel at home, we feel privileged to share in a special way of life.

Before I close, I would like to acknowledge one more individual who has touched me in a special way and whose being has illuminated my path and the paths of countless other fellow alcoholics. This little bundle of energy from West Texas truly was "gratitude in action." She walked the walk as well as she talked the talk. She gave everything she had to this society of ours and in the end she gave her life. I am speaking of course, of our late Southwest U.S. regional trustee, Jan Kelly Williamson, who was taken from us so suddenly a mere few months ago.

Recent delegates in the Southwest Region will always remember her with affection as our mother hen. How she would hustle and bustle us into action! "Let's go, let's go!" No slouching around Jan. This was to have been her last Conference as regional trustee. For me and for many others her spirit will be ever-present this week. I was privileged to share with Jan at many gatherings of our Fellowship but I will always remember her most at the Canyon de Chelly round-ups we attended in Arizona. For there, among the mystic, thousand-foot cliffs of the Anasazi people, Jan was in her element. I know now that she rests in the bosom of the ancient ones; a simple country girl who made good; a miracle we can all share in. Jan does not need our aggrandizements, indeed, she would have rejected them. This then, is a simple acknowledgment of gratitude. We thank you for your life, Jan.

And, dear friends, I thank you for your lives.

George Biggs, New Mexico

FINANCE

As the final presenter on Monday afternoon, G.S.O.'s director of finance and business administration, Ed Gordon, delivered a report and led a discussion on G.S.O. finances.

In the Financial section of this Report are several statements, including G.S.O.'s Income Statements for 1989 and 1990, our Budget for 1991, comparison of shortfall presentations for 1989, 1990, and budget, 1991, as well as Income Statements for the Grapevine for 1989, 1990, and 1991 Budget.

New this year is a Combined Income, Expense, and Changes in Fund Balances; Combined Office Expenses; Combined Other Expenses; Combined Balance Sheets, and the auditors opinion, and notes to the Combined Financial Statements. These combined statements represent the General Service Board of A.A. and its wholly-owned subsidiaries. It is felt that this information is also responsive to the presentation of financial data to the Fellowship.

Beginning with the 1990 Income Statement, our current formula for allocating income and expenses is to capture them in three major categories: (1) Publishing, (2) General Service Board—Office Expenses, and (3) General Service Board—Other Expenses of the Board.

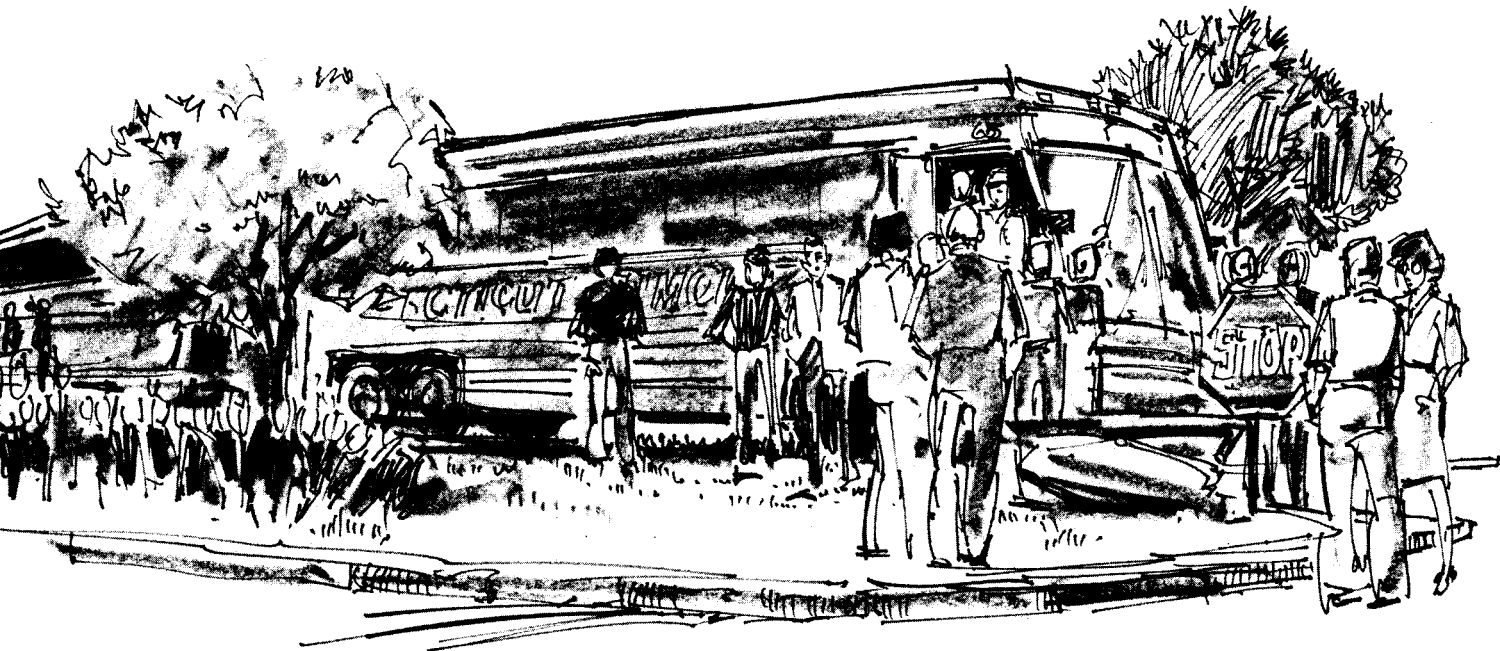
Income, by category:

A.A.W.S. Publishing reflects the income from literature sales, discounts taken by purchasers, the cost of production of the literature sold, royalties paid on literature sales, and interest earned. The net of all this is publishing income.

G.S.B. General Fund—Office reflects contributions received from A.A. groups and members and interest earned on bank accounts in which contributions are held before paying expenses.

G.S.B. General Fund—Other: In this category there is usually no income. In the year of an International Convention, such as 1990, the net income of the event appears here.

Expense: The expenses charged against Publishing and G.S.B.—General Fund are allocated, as shown, into three cost centers: publishing and two kinds of service expense, separated for historical reasons. This allocation was highly arbitrary in some cases, but the totals are reasonable. The note at the bottom of this income statement addresses this "allocation."



We have been addressing the issue of this "allocation" of expenses, and have tested it by applying two separate methods of broad-based allocations and have made progress in a third test by using a computerized general ledger application of functional costing. All three of these tests have supported the overall result of the current method. In fact, they all result in supporting the position that the publishing operation would run at a lesser cost and services would attract more expense.

Following is an explanation of each line item of expense under each category.

Salaries: These represent the salaries of all positions or departments as allocated to either Publishing or to General Service Board—Office.

Pension: This represents all the costs of our pension and retirement plan, including funding costs, as well as minor administrative expenses for all employees.

Rent and electricity: We currently occupy five floors at 468 and 470 Park Avenue South, representing 40,100 rentable square feet, and 35,090 usable square feet. The Grapevine occupies about 7,800 rentable square feet. The amounts in this report are exclusive of the Grapevine share.

Box 4-5-9: This includes the costs for writing, editing, printing, and mailing this bimonthly periodical. The income from paid subscriptions has been treated as a reduction of these expenses, as the cost of each subscription sold is greater than the income received.

A.A. Directories: This includes the cost of typesetting, printing, binding, and mailing of the directories given away to A.A. service entities other than groups. These include the Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian, and International Directories. Those sold are included in Publishing Sales, and production costs for those sold are charged to cost of products.

Other service material: This represents the cost of producing hundreds of thousands of service pamphlets and material that are distributed free of charge. Some of 1990's distribution included "A.A. at a Glance" (1,000,000 copies), "Message to Teenagers" (640,000 copies), "Where Do I Go From Here?" (800,000 copies) and "Information About A.A." (480,000 copies). See *Other Service Printing*.

Shipping and mailing: This represents two major areas at cost. The major portion, about 80%, are costs related to the shipping of A.A. literature from our New York office and the warehouses in the U.S. and Canada. This includes postage, UPS, warehousing charges, and packaging (material) costs. The balance of the costs are attributable to postage and UPS costs for correspondence, special mailings where the costs have not been charged to the function (such as Box 4-5-9 mailings), and free literature distribution.

Other office expenses: The expenses charged against Publishing represent furniture and office equipment, loss on bad debts, and selling expenses. The expenses charged against Office Expenses reflect the costs of stationery and office supplies, telephone, furniture and equipment, and office service and expenses (including maintenance contracts).

Insurance and payroll taxes: This represents the costs of office insurance including fire, liability, inventory, and employee benefit coverages (hospitalization, major medical, and life), and payroll taxes. Again, this covers all employees.

Professional services: This represents the cost of outside auditors and attorneys' fees only. The costs allocated against Publishing represent audit expenses; legal costs represent general corporate work, such as labor matters; trademark; copyright and royalty matters. The costs allocated to the General Service Board—Other Expenses mostly reflect audit expenses.

Board, committee and staff meetings: Under the Publishing

column, the amount primarily represents the expenses associated with the monthly A.A.W.S. board meetings (travel, hotel, meals) as well as the expenses for the fifth Central Office/Intergroup Seminar (about \$17,000, which includes a registration fee). The expenses under the Office column represent the cost of staff and committee meetings. The costs reflected under Other column represent the costs of the quarterly meetings of the board of trustees (travel, hotel, meals), as well as unreimbursed expenses related to the travel of trustees.

Writers' fees: These expenses are for projects undertaken each year. Some projects overlap years. Some of the projects reflected in 1990 were: A.A. History book; *Daily Reflections*; Spanish edition of the Big Book and other Spanish material, large-print material and other assorted projects that required writers. A major portion of time, though, was devoted to reprints and revisions.

P.I., C.P.C., and travel: The cost under the Publishing column represents travel expenses incurred by office personnel connected to office business such as trips by publishing personnel to printers to inspect major printings; to warehouses to inspect inventories and check out prospective warehouse locations; and to new or prospective printers or manufacturers to ensure quality standards. The costs under the Other column reflect the expenses associated with two functions: Cooperation With the Professional Community—most of the expenses are associated with the cost of exhibiting at about 25 health fairs, the maintenance of the professional exhibits, and attendance at non-A.A. functions. The costs for Public Information vary each year, with the bulk of the costs for 1990 relating to the Membership Survey.

General Service Conference: Most of the expense represents hotel (rooms, meals), with other key items such as delegate travel; the Box 4-5-9 Early Bird edition; and writer, production and distribution costs for the *Final Conference Report*, in English, Spanish and French. The balance includes items such as delegate portfolios, manuals, presentations, Advisory Actions and other miscellaneous costs. This is net of delegate area fees and contributions.

EDP systems development: The amount under Publishing represents the costs of maintenance, outside programmers, equipment and supplies.

Regional Forums and other: This represents the costs of Regional Forums, archives and sundry, with most of the cost being for Regional Forums.

Film projects: This represents the balance of the cost of producing the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous," as well as the Spanish edition.

Leasehold improvements: The cost of leasehold improvements for miscellaneous work of a permanent nature done to the premises.

World Service Meeting: This event occurs every two years, alternating between New York and a delegate country. The cost shown is for the 1990 meeting in Munich, Germany.

Self-support project: This amount represents the cost of meetings, distribution of revised D.C.M. kits, and a special mailing.

Foreign literature assistance: This is the cost of assistance to other countries to help them get started printing literature in their own country, in their own language. Although these are loans to be repaid, the accounting treatment is to expense the loans in the year advanced and to treat repayments as reductions to the expense. The amount shown is net of repayments. In 1989 the A.A.W.S. Board, as recommended by the General Service Board, undertook a policy of initiating translations of the Big Book on a systematic basis. In these cases, the entire cost of translating or checking translations, editing, typesetting, production and free distribution may be borne by A.A.W.S.

Net operating income (loss): This line reflects the net operating

income or loss by category before extraordinary expenses. Please note that the net loss for the year of Other Expenses of the Board has been reduced this year by the amount of the net income from the International Convention (which happens once every five years).

Extraordinary Expenses: This represents the 1990 portion for implementation of the computer project and appears under Other Expenses of the Board.

G.S.O. net income (loss): The amounts here reflect the net income or expense by category. The Total column summarizes the three categories and reflects the results of the entire General Service Office operation.

The last three lines in this report, under the Total column, indicate the earnings from G.S.O., added to the earnings of the Reserve Fund and Grapevine net income for the year to combine into the total Combined income for the year for all entities.

Highlights of the 1991 Budget in the financial section illustrates the shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions for 1989 and 1990, and those budgeted for 1991. The shortfall for 1989 was \$860,000, compared to the shortfall for 1990 of \$523,700 and a budgeted shortfall for 1991 of \$531,500.

I would like to point out a significant change in the reporting of acquisition and depreciation of fixed assets by G.S.O., as reflected on the Combined Balance Sheets, and Note 2 to the Financial Statements, under Fixed Assets.

This year I have been asked to highlight the Balance Sheet and Reserve Fund: A balance sheet is a representation of the financial condition of the company at a *point in time*, as opposed to an income and expense statement which represents a *period of time*, such as a year.

The Balance Sheet covers three main categories: assets; liabilities; and net worth (Fund Balance). *Assets* are what we own, such as cash, inventories and accounts receivable. *Liabilities* are what we owe, be they trade payables, or royalties on books sold. *Net Worth* is what is left, or is the difference between assets and liabilities. Assets minus Liabilities equals Net Worth (capital).

The Reserve Fund, at the end of 1990, including the anticipated contribution from G.S.O. and GV, equals approximately 9.2 months of coverage of one year's A.A.W.S., G.S.B. and Grapevine operating expenses.

The following are excerpts from prior auditor's comments:

By definition, the Reserve Fund is not intended to be used to subsidize operating deficits of the G.S.O. or the Grapevine; for that reason, only the board of trustees, on recommendation by the trustees' Finance Committee, can authorize withdrawals from it. Fortunately, over the years the Fellowship continued to grow, even through some periods of economic recession, and no severe adverse conditions have occurred which required substantial withdrawals from the Reserve Fund. The board did, however, authorize withdrawals from time to time to finance extraordinary or capital type expenditures such as: moving and/or refurbishing and renovating the office premises of the G.S.O., funding past service liabilities of the employees' retirement plan, and, more recently, acquisition of a new computer system. Even in those instances, the Reserve Fund was only used to finance the portion of the expenditures which could not be covered from normal operating income. It was deemed by the respective boards to be preferable to use the Reserve Fund for those projects, rather than to incur debt.

Even before the Reserve Fund was established in 1954 there were discussions and writings in which a prudent reserve was described as an amount equal to one year's operating expenses of the combined entities. . . . In practice, however, successive



boards of trustees of the G.S.B. usually set upper limits on the size of the Reserve Fund in specific amounts, which by 1976 had reached \$500,000. At that time, the combined annual operating expenses at G.S.O. were approximately \$2,000,000.

The fund balance of the Reserve Fund at the end of 1976 had just about reached its \$500,000 limit; at the same time, A.A. World Service, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (A.A.G.V.) had accumulated cash of \$1,250,000 and \$500,000, respectively. Those large cash balances in the operating entities caused an increasing amount of discussion and uneasiness among some members of the Fellowship. Terms such as "hidden reserves" and "excessive wealth" were heard more often. In response to that situation, Dr. John Norris, chairman of the G.S.B., appointed a special ad hoc committee to study the entire question of what a prudent reserve should be and how to achieve it.

The final report of that committee, which was approved by the General Service Board of A.A. and the 1977 General Service Conference, redefined a "prudent operating reserve" to be an amount equal to the preceding year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the G.S.B. In order to achieve that objective, financial policy was established requiring annual transfers by the operating entities to the Reserve Fund of any funds in excess of their working capital requirements. Also, under policy established at the same time, the A.A. Grapevine at the end of each year was to transfer to the Reserve Fund for investment any additional monies which it had received as advance payments from its subscribers. . . .

During 1987, a subcommittee of the trustee's Finance Committee was appointed to reexamine the definition of "a prudent operating reserve" and other matters relating to the Reserve Fund. The subcommittee recommended that the present reference to one year's operating expenses be retained, but as an upper limit, rather than as an "objective." The subcommittee also rejected the concept of setting a specific dollar amount limit. Those recommendations were approved by both the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, the Board of Trustees and the General Service Conference.

This has primarily been a review of the makeup or contents of each line item. Let us not ignore the dollars reflected in these financial statements and, in particular, in the 1991 budget. It received great scrutiny from the management of your General Service Office, the salary and budget committee of the A.A.W.S. Board, the A.A.W.S. Board, the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, and the General Service Board itself. Underlying the budgeting review process of expenses are ever-present questions: Is this the best way to spend the A.A. dollar—the one that comes into G.S.O. in trust? Will this expenditure improve the quality of sobriety?

Edward Gordon, G.S.O. director of finance

WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Immediately following dinner on Monday evening, John Quinn, trustee-at-large/U.S., gave a report on the Eleventh World Service Meeting.

As I sat on the airplane traveling across the Atlantic on the evening of October 12, many thoughts went through my mind about the meeting I was about to attend. It seemed only yesterday that I was a Panel 35 delegate listening to David Aronofsky's report on the Eighth World Service Meeting that had taken place in New York the preceding fall. I remembered particularly an emotional moment during his report when he told us of the reaction of some of the delegates from far-reaching countries as they stood in front of P.O. Box 459 with tears of gratitude in their eyes. I sensed the great enormity of our Fellowship as he told us these and other stories about that World Service Meeting. Little did I think that six years later I would be giving you a report on the Eleventh World Service Meeting.

I arrived in Munich on Saturday morning and was greeted at the airport by a member of the host committee. After spending a day of adjusting to jet lag and relaxing I went to a reception for the delegates and guests on Sunday afternoon. This was followed by a "red-ball" A.A. meeting that put me on another emotional high and set the tone for the week. Although I have been privileged to attend three A.A. International Conventions and was overwhelmed by all of them, the feeling I had in the

room during that meeting was different. As each delegate identified himself, told us where he was from and shared a little experience, strength and hope, the world of A.A. took on a completely different dimension. It seemed a lot larger to me than it did during that wonderfully powerful flag ceremony in Seattle.

We then broke for dinner and I made sure I sat with my "big brother" Webb Johnson (trustee-at-large/Canada). Like your "buddy" at this Conference, Webb had prepared me well, but I needed to hang onto his coattails a little longer. My friendship with other delegates was also off to a fast start and by the end of the week I had made life-long friends just as we do here.

After dinner, Inge Schwegmann, the chairperson of the General Service Board of Germany, welcomed us to her newly united country. She told us, "History has been made this past year in the heart of Europe. The wall across Germany has fallen. The Iron Curtain straight through Europe, which divided not only countries and worlds, but also different ideologies, has become passable. East and West are carefully moving close and the first thing we alcoholics notice is how very much A.A. is needed. The disease of alcoholism is widespread in the eastern part of Europe. Who can believe it is only a coincidence that the 1990 World Service Meeting has been transferred to Europe? Very close to the East European countries?"

After the roll call, John Sweetman, a second-term delegate from Australia, gave the keynote address and set the meeting in motion by bringing us in focus with our theme, "Twelve Concepts for World Service."

The agenda for the World Service Meeting was similar to that of this Conference. First-term delegates were asked to give their country highlights and it was my privilege to report on the events that had taken place at our Conference as well as in our General Service Office. The second-term delegates were asked to make presentations which are then discussed by all delegates. Webb made a presentation on the Tenth and Eleventh Concepts under the presentation/discussion entitled "How Do the Concepts Relate to Leadership and Management?"

The committee system is also used at the World Service Meeting. Each delegate is assigned to a committee and serves on it for two terms. Webb chaired the Agenda Committee and I was a member of the Literature/Publishing Committee. The two other standing committees are Policy/Admissions/Finance and Working With Others. Committees meet twice during the week and then make a report on Wednesday afternoon with recommendations that require a vote.

Many items in committee reports do not require a vote; they simply represent the shared experience of members of the committee. Some of the recommendations that require a vote are items that pertain solely to the World Service Meeting. Other recommendations pertain to the Fellowship at large. One that may have a familiar ring to it was a recommendation from the Literature/Publishing Committee that was passed and reads as follows. "The committee agreed that groups be discouraged from selling literature not approved by the General Service Conference or developed by other A.A. entities."

There were four workshops during the meeting: "What Are You Doing to Let the A.A. Community in Your Country Know the Twelve Concepts and How to Apply Them?"; "Are We Really Self-Supporting?"; "Unstructured" (similar to "What's on Your Mind?"); and "Communication Between Countries."

The same issues and concerns we share at our assemblies, Regional Forums and here, were discussed by the delegates during these workshops. Self-support is a global problem. Many of the delegates were amazed to hear that we must rely on the sale of literature to help pay for our services. They were under the impression that we had reservoirs of money that we didn't know

what to do with.

I would like to speak briefly about the last workshop, "Communication Between Countries," because it was in that workshop that I believe our Fellowship took another step toward the dream that Bill had for us. The delegates broke into three groups: European countries, Spanish-speaking countries and other English-speaking countries. This put Webb and me in the same room with Australia, New Zealand, South Africa and, of course, that other well-known English-speaking nation, Japan. After speaking briefly about the amount of hard work we were doing at our General Service Office in the area of foreign-literature assistance, Webb and I took a back seat and watched the others express their sentiments that if we are truly a worldwide Fellowship, the responsibility for carrying the message should be a worldwide one and not rest solely on the shoulders of the U.S. and Canada. After much discussion one of the delegates suggested the creation of an international fund for this purpose. With Webb and I abstaining, the other delegates in the room voted unanimously that this be brought to the entire meeting for a vote.



On Wednesday afternoon after all the other committee reports were heard and voted upon, a Floor Action was made, the result of this was the following letter sent on November 8, 1990, to all General Service Boards from Sarah Price, G.S.O.'s staff coordinator of the Eleventh World Service Meeting.

At the recent Eleventh World Service Meeting held in Munich, there was considerable discussion about the work being done throughout the world in carrying the message to those in countries that do not have a general service structure or the financial means to provide their own literature.

The 36 delegates to the World Service Meeting unanimously agreed that: (the coordinator) of the (World Service) meeting write to all participating country's General Service Boards for the specific purpose of seeking cooperation in the task of raising funds for the current problem of providing start-up literature for those countries unable to finance their own translations and acquisitions.

In accordance with the above motion, will you please let us know your thoughts on how the fund might be administered. Most delegates felt that the funds initially be administered by the General Service Board of the U.S. and Canada.

In order to ascertain the initial size of this fund, all General Service Boards are requested to indicate any proposed plans for foreign literature assistance that are presently contemplated and an estimated cost of such projects.

Several delegates stressed that the creation of this fund should in no way alter any General Service Board's plans to implement projects of this nature.

We look forward to your reply and will report all findings to all Eleventh World Service delegates and boards.

After this vote had been taken, one of the delegates said to me, "Tonight is a milestone in the history of A.A."

Just as we had done on the previous evenings, we adjourned at 10 p.m. and went to the local ice-cream parlor. We all felt good about the work we had done during the week and spoke about the closing of the meeting the next day and about going back home to our countries.

We opened Thursday's session at 9 a.m. and spent the rest of the morning and afternoon listening to some presentations, workshop reports and general sharing. Emotions began to run higher in the afternoon as the second-term delegates made their closing remarks. This was followed by some emotional closing remarks by Inge.

I certainly wasn't prepared for what was to happen next. The chairman called out the names of 14 delegates and asked them to come to the front of the room. He told us that each of them represented the different languages spoken by the delegates and that they were going to recite the Serenity Prayer in their native tongues. Everyone in the room held hands while each delegate, one after the other, said the Serenity Prayer in Flemish, Spanish, Finnish, French, German, English, Icelandic, Gaelic, Italian, Japanese, Norwegian, Polish, Afrikaans and Swedish. When it was over I just stood there as tears fell from my eyes. I looked at the person next to me and he had the same tears. We put our arms around each other and in almost total silence everyone went around the room and embraced each other. Words are not necessary! The room was filled with the language of the heart.

That evening the General Service Board of Germany invited all of us to a traditional Bavarian dinner (without the beer, of course). They even arranged to have an "umpah" band. I flew home the next day grateful for having participated in the World Service Meeting and for what we accomplished, grateful for the new friends I had made during those few days, and very grateful to have been given this special privilege of serving our Fellowship.

John Quinn, trustee-at-large/U.S.

COOPERATION NOT AFFILIATION: WE ARE RESPONSIBLE

Following the World Service Meeting report and prior to the Monday evening Sharing Session, Don Bruner, West Central U.S. regional trustee, moderated two presentations on cooperation, not affiliation.

Anonymity—the Soul of Cooperation Not Affiliation

I am going to speak on anonymity as the soul of cooperation, not affiliation. From earliest times the principle of anonymity has been associated with our spirit of cooperation and nonaffiliation. In 1945 Bill wrote in the A.A. Grapevine about the incident when Yale University hired an A.A. member to do some professional educational work. One of the conditions that Bill agreed to was that the individual could drop anonymity. Before long people were confusing A.A. with the educational program. It is no mistake that the P.I. Committee, which is specifically charged with disseminating the message of recovery while protecting our anonymity was called, until 1966, Committee on Relations With Other Agencies.

As Bill tells us in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 2), the “Traditions were beaten out on the anvils of . . . experience.” Anonymity, indeed, is the soul of our Traditions. So important is it that in Bill’s last message, he stated, “If I were asked which of these blessings I felt was most responsible for our growth as a fellowship and most vital to our continuity, I would say, the ‘Concept of Anonymity.’” It is our collective experience that the practice of anonymity leads to humility, self-sacrifice, and above all, freedom. Affiliation leads to dependency and to ties that bind.

A few weeks ago I almost had an “affiliation slip.” I was tempted to suggest the name of our chairman of the board to be an honoree at a dinner sponsored by a national organization on substance abuse. Upon reflection, it seemed to me that suggest-

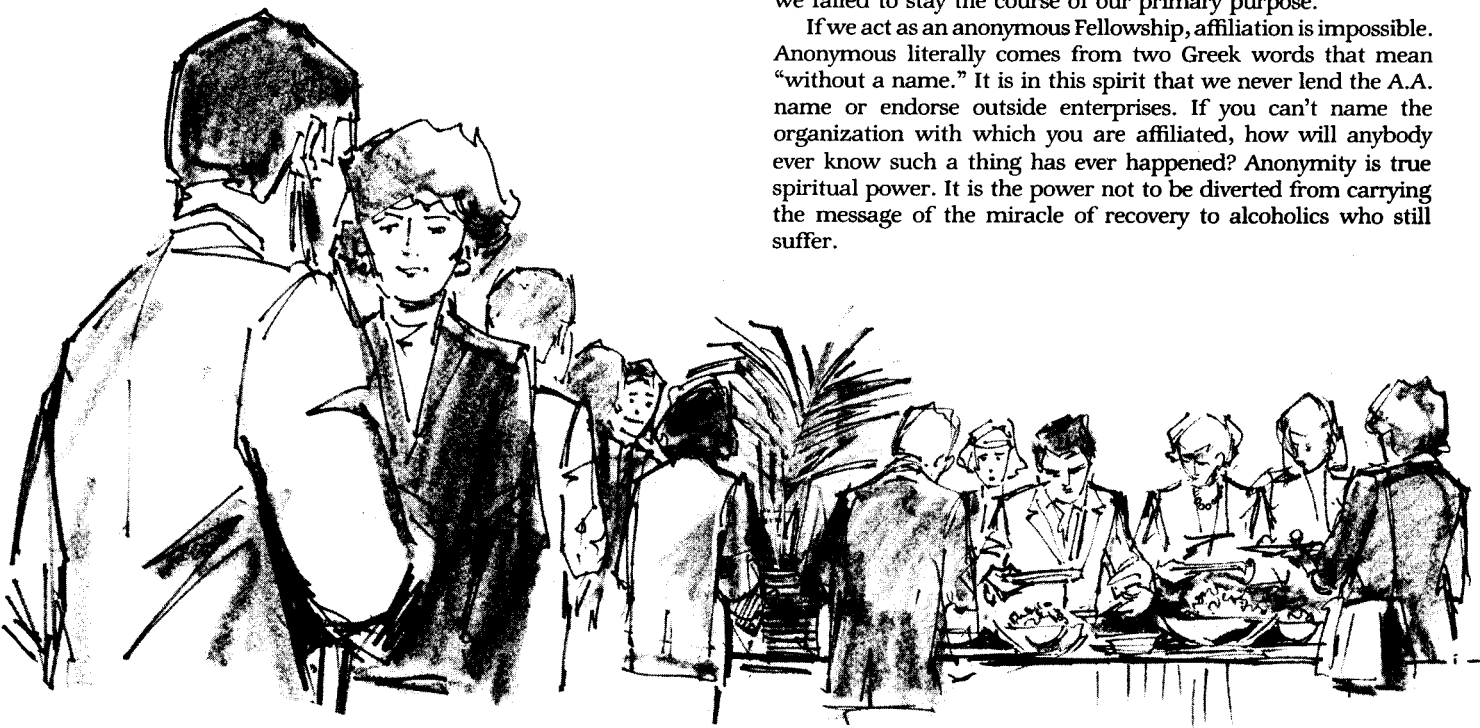
ing that somebody from A.A. be the honoree for such a dinner was contrary to our Traditions. The purpose of the dinner was to raise funds to allow this organization to continue its good work. The honoree would be a key drawing card for people who would be attending the function to use as a standard bearer for the organization. This seemed to me to be something that was trading on the A.A. name.

The more our true friends understand who we are as an anonymous Fellowship with only one primary purpose, the more they will help us maintain our freedom from the bonds of affiliation. This is one of the by-products, for example, of our triennial Membership Survey. Think about it for a moment; this survey is done by alcoholics about alcoholics. It preempts any other survey. It takes it out of their hands and leaves it in ours. It allows us to share with other institutions, hospitals, etc., treatment information about our Fellowship that helps them understand us better and therefore be a better instrument in the recovery process. On another level, one of the principles with which anonymity infuses “cooperation by not affiliation” is that of being a team-player—“service not the spotlight.” Though it’s a subtle point, these surveys allow us to interpret our own personal A.A. recovery process in the light of that same process in the lives of thousands of other A.A.s as a group. Whenever I interpret my own personal or my group’s experience as the only way A.A. works or should work, I have too closely affiliated that unique experience with our wonderfully free, reckless, random, anonymous and unpredictably salutary program. As it says in the long form of Tradition Three: “. . . we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership depend upon money or conformity.”

In another example, our true friends in the early days of A.A. would not allow us to become a heavily endowed institution. They know that “he who pays the piper calls the tune.” They saw the incipient danger of affiliation through the acceptance of money from outside sources.

Power, “money, property and prestige,” as listed in the Sixth Tradition, are all extremely valuable tools. The trick for A.A. is not to allow the siren song of these values to shipwreck us because we failed to stay the course of our primary purpose.

If we act as an anonymous Fellowship, affiliation is impossible. Anonymous literally comes from two Greek words that mean “without a name.” It is in this spirit that we never lend the A.A. name or endorse outside enterprises. If you can’t name the organization with which you are affiliated, how will anybody ever know such a thing has ever happened? Anonymity is true spiritual power. It is the power not to be diverted from carrying the message of the miracle of recovery to alcoholics who still suffer.



As an anonymous Fellowship, A.A. realizes that we are pilgrims on a journey. We are mendicants on the road with no place to build a lasting city. By affiliating with any other organization we begin to build a prison of institutionalization, bureaucracy and other people's purposes. The spiritual power made manifest by this attitude of reckless abandon to the principle of recovery with reward, is the nuclear capability of Alcoholics Anonymous. This is the same power that propels alcoholic after alcoholic out of the gutters, out of the hospitals, out of the institutions, and into the arms of a loving human race and the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

It is not a rational attitude. But neither is recovery a rational process. It is a total reversal of negative attitudes—an impossibility prior to the functioning of a High Power in the life of an alcoholic. Nonaffiliation leads to freedom just as non-drinking leads to life.

All well and good. But how does this wonderful spirituality apply in my daily life? Let me challenge you here, today, to try it on for size. Over the next day, over the next week, experience the freedom of anonymity. Do something good for somebody and make sure they don't find out who is responsible. In other words, don't affiliate with the good of others. Think about it. Tell your best friend about it if you want. But make sure that the person for whom you did the good thing doesn't know that you've done it. If you really want to experience the power, do it for someone you don't like, or for someone against whom you have a resentment.

The anonymity of nonaffiliation certainly applies to people who take A.A. meetings into hospitals or institutions. I've had the experience of opening up one of New York City's major hospitals to the A.A. program by setting up meetings on a regular basis for that institution. In doing so I was asked to address doctors, nurses, and staff on the principles of A.A. Once understood by these professionals, A.A. was allowed to function without interference or implied or expressed affiliation. Cooperation, but not affiliation, applies to our work with treatment facilities, churches, courts, professional groups and to each of the treatment facilities committees around the country. It applies to the focus of the Public Information Committee, where the principle of anonymity and "principles before personalities" need be maintained to preserve the ideal of attraction rather than promotion. It applies to our ability to avoid controversy. We are the twentieth century "know nothings." How can somebody who refuses to give you their name because they wish to remain anonymous get up on the podium and rattle sabres about issues of politics, economics, philosophy, health care or treatment? Once I am positioned in these elements, I am affiliated with them and am no longer free to live totally, sharing only the miracle of recovery. I am like the moth that was unable to transform itself into a butterfly.

The principle of nonaffiliation is the practice of anonymity in action in our relationships with the other institutional elements of our society. It is a safeguard of our unity and the foundation stone of personal recovery.

Desmond Towey, general service trustee

From the Group to the Conference

As I began gathering my thoughts on this topic, I immediately thought of our pamphlet, "Circles of Love and Service," which graphically illustrates our service structure.

It occurred to me that the principle "cooperation not affiliation," which comes from our Sixth Tradition, carries a responsi-

bility to every level of the Fellowship, from the individual member to the General Service Conference. Thinking further I began to break it down.

The responsibility of an individual A.A. member might be how he or she handles a simple situation. For instance, if a member finds themselves in a conversation with a drug addict, who is aware of the member's being sober in A.A., the member could explain, with love and compassion, our singleness of purpose and put our addict friend in touch with Narcotics Anonymous. I've seen cases where our members have driven people to N.A. meetings and helped them walk through the doors. That is an example of "cooperation not affiliation."

At the group level, if someone with a problem other than alcoholism comes into a closed A.A. meeting, it can be handled quietly and simply. A few members can take the person outside, talk to them, find out what their specific problem is and help them find help. We can practice the principles of Love and Tolerance and maintain our anonymity without isolating ourselves within the circle of the group.

One of the responsibilities that would fall on our districts, through our C.P.C. committees, is to maintain communications with professionals and local treatment centers: explaining what Alcoholics Anonymous does and doesn't do; informing them about how we can and will cooperate with them by bringing A.A. meetings to facilities and helping people to come into Alcoholics Anonymous; by clearing up any questions they might have regarding our Traditions of anonymity and nonaffiliation.

At the area level, a great way of shouldering our responsibility is by hosting professional workshops. The area can find a large meeting room, put together several presentations explaining how our P.I., treatment and correctional facilities and C.P.C. committees operate. Invite the professionals in the area to attend and allow time on the program for questions and suggestions. Hosting these types of workshops affords the area the opportunity to reach a large number of professionals at the same time. It also serves as a great tool to promote unity with our area committees.

Now, the Conference. We know our responsibilities here. We bring the needs, conscience and suggestions for our 91 delegate areas to New York. Through the Conference Committees we study the need for and develop and approve the literature, films and tools Alcoholics Anonymous needs to let the outside world know of the goals, policies and practices under which the Fellowship operates. This is done in our spirit of cooperation with nonaffiliation.

In Chapter Seven, "Working With Others," of our Big Book it says: "Ministers and doctors are competent and you can learn much from them if you wish, but it happens that because of your own drinking experience you can be uniquely useful to other alcoholics. So cooperate; never criticize. To be helpful is our only aim." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 89)

This passage suggests to me that we are the recovered—not the experts—and we are here to help.

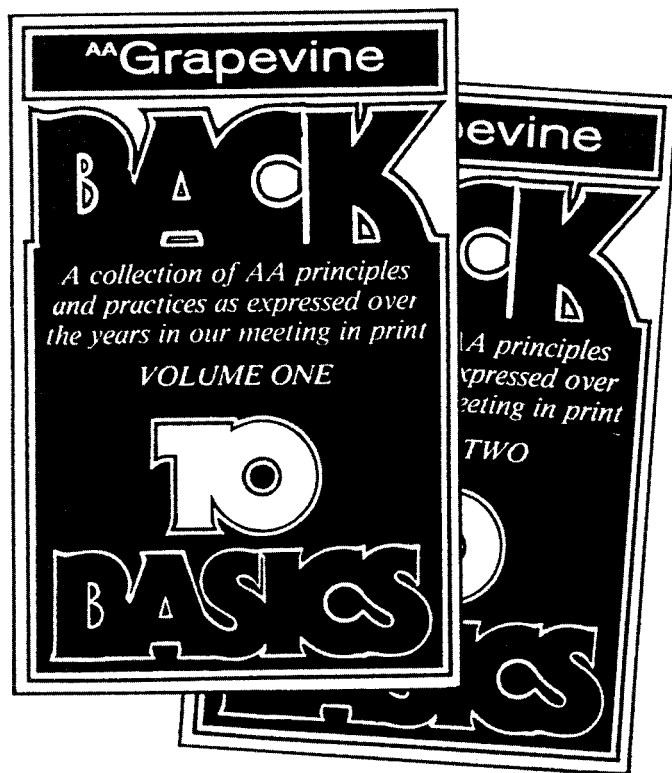
P.J. Doherty, California (Mid-Southern)

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

The Wednesday evening session got underway immediately following dinner. John King, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, moderated two presentations on the A.A. Grapevine.

The Grapevine Today

My first contact with the Grapevine as something more than an



interested reader happened early in the 1980s. A staff member who knew I was an accountant asked me if I would be willing to serve informally as a consultant and make some suggestions about how the corporation might operate more efficiently. How many of us say no to an opportunity for service in A.A.? I said yes and here I am, a little more than ten years later, standing on the podium at the Forty-first Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference, hoping to tell this knowledgeable group something you don't already know about the Grapevine.

Since you are familiar with the Concepts, you already know that the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is a separate corporation. I'm going to talk a little bit about that anyway. I believe, as Bill W. did, that the autonomy of the Grapevine is tremendously important for the future of this international monthly journal. In Concept XI, Bill W. writes that the Grapevine and A.A.W.S. need to be separate entities because they are completely dissimilar operations. Additionally, Bill wrote that the Grapevine Board, which is responsible for the Grapevine operation, must have the corresponding authority. If we try to combine the two corporations, he says, "We might save some money, but we probably could not save the magazine."

You already know that one of the dissimilarities between A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine is that the Grapevine is supported entirely by income from sales of the magazine and special items. We do not accept group contributions for operating expenses. For many years, the Grapevine operated at a loss and had to borrow from the Reserve Fund. For the past four years, however, the corporation has shown a profit and for the past two years it has donated to the Reserve Fund over and above its liability to subscribers for unfulfilled subscriptions.

As chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board I rejoice that we are in the black. But as an A.A. member who believes that the primary purpose of the Grapevine is to publish a magazine,

I might rejoice just a little bit harder if the magazine itself was self-supporting. The profits of the past few years have been derived mainly from the sale of Grapevine special items such as anthologies, audio cassettes and other materials. The magazine itself has consistently shown a loss. Since most special items simply make the magazine available in other media, the Grapevine Board is quite comfortable with allowing special-items sales to subsidize the magazine to keep the magazine price as low as possible. Yet our major product—for that matter, the corporation's reason for existence—is a magazine, and our emphasis lies always on producing a quality product every month and getting it out there for every A.A. member who needs it.

You know that in general if not in detail. You know, too, that the Grapevine is a great little magazine. But do you know that only about 6,300 out of close to 60,000 registered groups in the United States and Canada have Grapevine subscriptions? When added to the individual subscriptions, that brings us to a total current circulation of a little more than 130,000—a number that is declining right now, as it historically does after a price increase.

What does declining circulation mean? Most importantly, it means that fewer alcoholics may be using the Grapevine as a tool to enhance their personal sobriety and their A.A. service work. And for me and the nine other Grapevine directors, it means that we need to look at some alternatives for making the magazine more readily available to A.A. members and groups.

We have been doing just that over the past several years, and at a planning committee meeting in March the board decided to get in touch with every registered group in the U.S. and Canada. An all-groups mailing planned for May or June will include an introductory copy of the magazine, printed matter on Grapevine history and on how the magazine can be useful for the groups, and information on three subscription alternatives designed to meet different needs of different groups.

Two of those alternatives may be new to some of you, so I want to spend a little time talking about them. The familiar alternative is that of yearly, prepaid subscriptions and the vast majority of subscribing groups use this plan. In 1976 the Conference directed us to discontinue a group pay-as-you-go plan because of too many bad debts. The board has considered the idea of credit sales of the magazine but that never has proved feasible.

As the magazine price continues to rise we are aware that it becomes more difficult for A.A. groups to get enough cash together to enter a subscription for more than a few copies. At the current U.S. price of \$12 for a one-year subscription, a group that needs a subscription of ten copies must have \$120 in the treasury and for many groups that is tough or even downright impossible.

For that reason in the mid-1980s we established the option of prepaid bulk sales by the month. A group, district, intergroup or other entity can order issues by the month, always ordering and paying in advance so that the order can be included in the print run. Here it is necessary to pay for only one month's issues at a time. This plan also provides an opportunity to change the number of copies from month to month if the needs of the group change. Currently, we mail between 4,000 and 5,000 monthly orders and the consensus of the board is that we should make this plan known more widely.

Additionally, the board has established a six-month "starter" subscription for groups that prefer to familiarize themselves with the Grapevine before taking the plunge and subscribing for a full year. This will be a one-time option because ongoing six-month subscriptions would wreak havoc with processing and the renewal notice schedule. However, we believe that a shorter, introductory term will enable groups to decide whether they want to continue reading the magazine and will also give them time to

set aside the cost of a year's subscription.

Registered groups in all delegate areas should be receiving this mailing sometime in May or June. It is our hope that each of you will want to go back to the groups in your area and encourage them to consider using the Grapevine.

Carrying the message through the Grapevine is a Twelfth Step effort to which the board is fully committed. By putting the magazine into the hands of as many alcoholics as possible we hope to put a dent in the hopelessness and despair of alcoholism which so many of us here know so well.

Stanley Silverman, general service trustee

Highlights of Grapevine's History

The A.A. Grapevine began in 1944 as a newsletter in the New York City area, but soon became the national A.A. magazine. The masthead reads, "The International Monthly Journal of Alcoholics Anonymous." Most of Bill W.'s early writings originally appeared in the Grapevine; he used the magazine as a primary means of communication with the groups, and to explain and illuminate A.A.'s fundamental spiritual principles.

Six "ink-stained wretches," as Bill called them, formed the original editorial staff, and over 1,000 copies of the first newsletter were sent out to group secretaries. Subscriptions zoomed upward; within a year, over 3,000 copies were being printed, and Bill continued to insist that the venture remain nonprofit and that no advertising of any sort be allowed. The first newsletters were eight pages, but soon the format was changed to the multi-paged booklet we still enjoy.

An early problem cropped up with the name "Grapevine." The F.B.I. had been publishing a news booklet with this title, and to eliminate any problem, we agreed to call our new publication the A.A. *Grapevine*. To keep intact our Tradition of anonymity, we used our address, "Box 1980," as the legal name of the newsletter, a practice followed to this day.

The magazine has retained its traditional look over the years, and the basic table of contents has remained familiar: the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, the Preamble, the Serenity Prayer, personal articles on topics of sobriety, letters on a broad range of topical interests, and jokes. The magazine has remained a publication of and for its readers.

The concept of a "meeting in print" was begun in response to wartime needs in 1944, and was originally titled, "Mail Call for A.A.s at Home and Abroad." The "meeting in print" concept proved so popular that it has remained as a vital and constant definition of the publication.

Marty Mann, one of the "ink-stained wretches," was quite instrumental in establishing the National Council on Alcoholism, an effort so noted in an early Grapevine. And Grapevine in 1945 published Dr. E.M. Jellinek's questionnaire on alcoholism which later was the basis for the professional chart, "Phases of Alcohol Addiction."

Tom Y., Grapevine's first editor, wrote the A.A. Preamble, and of course it was first published in the Grapevine. Victor E., our cartoon symbol of one caught in alcoholism, first appeared in 1962 and has been welcomed each year until the present. The so-called "gray pages," a feature "About Alcoholism," began in 1966, and alternates now with A.A. short histories.

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is one of two operating entities of the General Service Board, with its own corporate board, staff, and financial operation separate from that of the General Service Office. The board of directors has ten members: five trustees (two general service trustees, two regional or at-large trustees,

and one Class A), three nontrustee directors and two A.A. staff members.

A volunteer editorial board is also an important part of the Grapevine structure. Its members, A.A.s with expertise in publishing, communications and the arts, act in an advisory capacity to the staff.

Grapevine staff, directors and trustees are voting members of the Conference, and there is a Conference Committee on the Grapevine.

Financially, going back to the original suggestions of Bill W., the Grapevine is supported entirely by revenues from sales of the magazine and special items such as books, cassettes and calendars. In contrast to G.S.O., which receives group contributions to support group services, the Grapevine accepts donations only for a fund set up to provide subscriptions for inmates or other A.A.s who cannot afford the cost.

Although there is a tradition of joint arrangements for certain routine operations between the A.A. Grapevine and A.A. World Services, Bill W. explains in the Eleventh Concept why, as he puts it, there should be no merger of A.A. World Services and the A.A. Grapevine. Bill writes that "... the General Service Board is an unsuitable vehicle for an operating corporation; ... because the Grapevine is such a dissimilar operation, and because we ought not concentrate too much money and executive authority in a single entity. ..." (A.A. *Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 54)

Bill W. felt we should keep A.A. publishing distinct and separate from the A.A. Grapevine, pointing out that the two enterprises are completely dissimilar: "The Grapevine has to produce a brand new quality product every month, on the dot. By contrast, A.A. Publishing success largely depends on what has already been written. ... We might save some money, but we probably could not save the magazine." (*ibid*, pp. 54, 55)

The magazine has enjoyed a tradition of publishing articles from persons not in the Fellowship. Among many others, Dr. William Silkworth, the Reverend Sam Shoemaker, Dr. Harry Tiebout, Fulton Oursler and Bernard Smith have written for the Grapevine.

Bill W. said that the Grapevine was for *all* A.A. members, and that "it will be the vehicle for your thoughts, your feelings, your experience, and your aspirations. ..." The continued success of the publication reflects well on these early goals. At the moment, Grapevine's budget is balanced, and average circulation remains over 130,000. The Steps, Traditions and Concepts remain the magazine's guidelines, and Grapevine articles articulate these unchanging principles through the current experiences and informed opinions of individual member/writers. In addition to personal experiences of gaining sobriety and working the program, articles deal with sensitive issues—often in topical sections grouping different points of view. Wide participation is ensured through "P.O. Box 1980" (letters from readers) and an occasional "Your Move" section, which collects brief pro and con opinions on a given subject. The section, "Is A.A. Changing," has proved of recent interest to the membership, and the new short histories have been met with enthusiasm.

The Grapevine continues to be "our meeting in print," a "getting together" in magazine form where we share our experience, strength and hope with each other. Grapevines are not thrown out; they are found on coffee tables, in doctors' waiting rooms, at A.A. group meeting places, literature displays, inter-group offices, and countless other locations—ever fulfilling their function to communicate ideas, values and personal stories of the members of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Fran Polek, Grapevine director

SELF-SUPPORT PROJECT —FIVE YEARS LATER

The Self-support Project—five years later—was the theme of the evening presentation/discussion on Wednesday. Everett Smethurst, A.A.W.S. director, moderated the session that included two speakers.

In preparation of this presentation I've tried to do my homework and gotten opinions from as many sources as I could.

Has the self-support plan been successful? I would have to say I'm not sure. How do we define success? Are we living the Seventh Tradition?

If the question is, are our bills being paid, the answer is yes. If what you're asking is, are group services being financially supported by group contributions only, the response becomes more complex and will continue to be impossible to answer until a clear, simple outline is available stating the following: These are the items covered under "group services" and this is the cost of providing these services.

An additional problem is, what definition of "self-supporting" do we use? Bill W. recalls, in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, "In 1945 we wrote Mr. John D. Rockefeller, Jr., and the 1940 dinner guests that we would no longer need their financial help."

The book royalties could now look after Dr. Bob and me; group contributions could pay the general office expenses. If these were insufficient, the reserve accumulated out of literature sales could meet the deficit. This meant that we had finally declared for self-support. Since that time A.A.'s Board of Trustees has steadfastly refused outside contributions (pp. 203-204).

Are Bill's thoughts in conflict with the statement included in the original self-support paper issued in 1986, which says self-supporting "through group contributions only?" The home groups, through the two-way flow of communication of the Conference, need to clarify the definition of "self-supporting."

During the last five years the self-support plan has been on the agenda of every General Service Conference and untold numbers of Regional Forums, assemblies, district meetings, workshops and more. Every year the dollar contributions have increased but so has the cost of group services, inflation and the number of groups in A.A.

Last year, in 1990, group contributions increased by 8.9 percent, but office and board expenses increased by 0.5 percent. The problem is that without clarifying exactly what "group services" and their costs are, it is impossible to say if this figure meets the cost.

The fear present in 1986—that by 1991, 65 percent of our literature profit would come from the sale of literature to entities other than A.A.—was considerably lowered by doing away with two-tier pricing in 1988. Last year that figure was 23.7 percent.

Where do we go from here? I offer the following, not as the solution but simply as "thought starters."

In a letter addressing this topic last March, one area chairperson shared, "With all the worry over money and self-support, I think we've lost sight of what is our greatest problem by far—apathy and lack of participation at all levels. If we solve our participation problems, we automatically solve our self-support problems. We needed a five-year participation project instead of the self-support plan."

To help communicate the fact that a need exists, condensed income statements similar to those used at Regional Forums could be issued on an ongoing basis. The message to the G.S.R.s and to the groups must be clear and simple: They must understand that a need exists.

More focus is needed on the purpose of a prudent reserve at all service levels. Is fear of financial insecurity within groups, districts, areas, central offices and intergroups having a residual effect on contributions?

During the past five years Conference delegates have voiced their concerns that they have been excluded with regard to money matters. The original self-support plan closed with the suggested first step of gathering delegates regionally to discuss self-support. I wonder what would have happened if we had followed through with this plan.

- Does A.A.'s entire Third Legacy structure, including G.S.O., need to begin a thorough inventory to ascertain that each level is fulfilling its primary purpose? Greg Muth talked about the success attained when such an inventory was taken in Hawaii back in 1987.

- Perhaps the Conference Finance Committee could better serve the Fellowship if there was a corresponding committee addressing the Seventh Tradition. The trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee does not fill this need.

We are still at the historical statistic wherein roughly 50 percent of groups contribute. How do we get more groups to contribute? I think we have to talk about spiritual principles. As Bill says in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, "It did not matter too much what our material condition was, but it did matter what our spiritual condition was. Money gradually became our servant and not our master. It became a means of exchanging love and service with those about us." (p. 122)

Past delegate Dennis F. said the following in his presentation to PRAASA (Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly) in 1987.

I think that I need to overcome any spiritual embarrassment and share with the members in my area that I need to contribute to the upkeep of the Fellowship in the same way that I need to practice rigorous honesty and maintain a conscious contact. Seeking God's will for me means trying to find the spiritual way of living that was lacking in my life when I drank. I was taught, and eventually learned, that paying my way is one of the foundations of that spiritual way of living. Having been made aware of the services performed by the General Service Office for my group and for the alcoholic who still suffers, I realize my responsibility to help pay for them. If someone hadn't told me about the spiritual principles of self-support or about the work at G.S.O., I wouldn't have been able to make that decision. I can carry the same simple message, and I'm certain that if they are informed, the members of A.A. will respond to it.

Bill covers this in the Twelfth Concept. After discussing negative attitudes toward contributing for service work, he says the following.

But in recent years these attitudes are everywhere on the decline; they quickly disappear when the real need for a given A.A. service becomes clear. To make such a need clear is simply a matter of right information and education. We see this in the continuous job now being done with good effect for our world service by Delegates, Committee Members and General Service Representatives. They are finding that money-begging by pressure exhortation is unwanted and unneeded in A.A. They simply portray what the giver's service dollar really brings in terms of steering alcoholics to A.A., and in terms of our overall unity and effectiveness. This much done, the hoped-for contributions are forthcoming. (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 64)

In conclusion, let's take the Seventh Tradition out of the limelight it has been in for the past five years and put it back with the other eleven, where it belongs. Perhaps we have to trust that the groups are doing the best they can and budget accordingly with prudence.

Jack MacManus, Rhode Island



Let me begin by asking a few questions. I'd like to take a sort of informal poll. How many of you think we are violating the Seventh Tradition if we use income from publishing to pay for services? May I see your hands? What if that income comes from "outside sources"? What if a big one of those "outside sources" is Hazelden? What if the outside source is the United States government?

Well, in 1986 we were asking ourselves those questions and we answered them about the same way you did today. In 1986 we had a two-tier pricing structure. This meant that "outsiders" paid more for our literature than members did. In 1985 about 45 percent of our net income came from sales to outsiders. That percentage was projected to go to 65 percent by the end of 1991. Thus we were in danger of violating the Seventh Tradition if outsiders were paying for services. But we might be violating the Sixth Tradition as well by establishing "de facto" affiliation with our largest "clients." Further, relying so heavily on a few large "clients" simply was not good business practice.

Let me briefly review a few of the steps we have taken since then. In 1986 the A.A.W.S. Board created a self-support committee, which issued a paper called "The Challenge of the Seventh

Tradition." Our goals included becoming fully self-supporting within five years and reducing literature prices to close to cost. At that time, about half the registered groups, or 52.1 percent, contributed to G.S.O.

In 1987 a number of mailings were done and a self-support manual was sent to delegates, trustees, D.C.M.s and central offices. A promised price reduction was implemented. The number of groups contributing went up slightly to 56.6 percent but still only just over half the registered groups made contributions to G.S.O.

In 1988 we established a single pricing structure while further reducing prices. About the same percentage of groups contributed. And in 1989 and 1990 we continued to do mailings and sent out revised manuals. We also raised prices to restore the gross margin on literature to an acceptable level. About the same percentage of groups made contributions.

So what happened? There's an old saying that if you do what you did, you'll get what you got. But we didn't. The first year—1987—contributions went up 37 percent. But in 1988, the increase was only 7 percent and in 1989, it dropped to less than a 4-percent increase. What, then, is the overall picture for the five-year period?

In terms of contributions, we went from roughly \$2.7 million (\$2,665,634) in 1986 to \$4.4 million (\$4,416,850—unaudited) in 1990. That is an increase of 65.7 percent. This percentage is far greater than the increase in the number of groups for the same period. The shortfall between contributions and cost of services went from about \$916,000 (\$915,684) in 1986 to \$537,000—unaudited—in 1990.

Does this mean our five-year effort has been successful? It depends upon how you measure success. Contributions have certainly increased faster than the number of groups registered. The shortfall has almost been cut in half. Single pricing means that outsiders are not supporting services. But only about half the registered groups contribute to G.S.O. Still. What does this tell us? That we are still failing to get our message across? Or that the Fellowship really doesn't want all the services we are offering? Or that we probably will have to continue to rely on publishing income to support services?

This last question is critically important because something new is happening. The actual number of books sold last year, for the first time, decreased. The unit sales so far this year are below last year's figures. As sales decrease, contributions become increasingly important.

These are questions that we must address as we establish our priorities for service. Our mission is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. But if the Fellowship is unwilling to financially support these efforts, how do we reach those who are just beginning to seek the hand of A.A. in prisons, and among physically different people, and among ethnic minorities, and among the very young and the very old, and around the world?

Jean Smith, general service trustee

OUR COLLECTIVE HUMILITY

Fridcy afternoon John Sharkey, Northeast U.S. regional trustee, moderated a discussion on our collective humility. Three speakers shared their thoughts on this topic of particular interest to the Fellowship.

How We Identify Ourselves

In preparation for sharing on this topic, I found that Webster's Collegiate dictionary states the meaning of "identify" as "to

establish the essential character or individuality of." I therefore asked myself, what is our essential character? What gives us our individuality? How is our Fellowship seen at every level, from one alcoholic talking with another, to how we are perceived by the general public?

One day, when I had been sober about six months in the program, I was having a particularly bad day. I really wanted to drink and my new A.A. friend let me tag along with her all day because I couldn't stand to be alone. We were starting to go into her house when we saw another A.A. member next door. This fellow is about 6 feet, 3 inches tall, has tattoos all over his huge arms, has hands the size of small shovels and reputedly used to drink two twenty-sixes of rye every day, terrorizing everyone around him. This man had received the gift of sobriety in A.A. and was now hauling landfill next door with his gravel truck. He came over and talked to us and I told him what a hard time I was having that day. He shared some of his experience with us and then my friend and I went into her house. The next evening I saw this fellow at an A.A. meeting and he said, "You know, yesterday I knelt beside my truck and prayed for you."

When we are discussing Step One in our group, this man always talks about, "We admitted we . . ." as being the cornerstone of his recovery. He also says "the only way we can keep this program is by giving it away." To me this man is an example of how we identify ourselves.

Bill, our co-founder, states that "We recovered alcoholics are not so much brothers in virtue as we are brothers in our defects, and in our common strivings to overcome them." (*As Bill Sees It*, p. 167). We are told that "The identification that one alcoholic has with another is mysterious, spiritual—almost incomprehensible. But it is there." (*Daily Reflections*, p. 118). So we identify ourselves with each other in a way that is difficult to put into words, through unconditional acceptance, the practice of the principles of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, through seeing the newcomer as the most important person in the group and by sticking to our primary purpose.

As well, we are people who have suffered the disease of alcoholism and have found a common solution through dependence on a Higher Power. When one alcoholic talks with another, identification takes place and further identification comes in our Big Book, which tells who we are and describes our illness. We also identify by listening and participating in meetings.

Because alcohol is the great leveler, there are no boundaries as to who may be A.A. members. "No one is too discredited or has sunk too low to be welcomed cordially—if he means business." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 161)

There is a oneness about Alcoholics Anonymous which is described in our description of what A.A. is—our Preamble.

Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of men and women who share their experience, strength and hope with each other that they may solve their common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism.

The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership. We are self-supporting through our own contributions. A.A. is not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization or institution; does not wish to engage in any controversy, neither endorses nor opposes any causes. Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics achieve sobriety.

We are taught that we may be the only copy of the Big Book that someone may see and through the loving grace of God, our lives are changed to become that copy of the Big Book.

Part of our identification is how we address ourselves, with the public, at treatment facilities and institutions, in our social and work lives, with one another and to newcomers. We use first

names only, at the public level, but we use our full names with newcomers so they may receive as much help as possible. In our groups we feel free to use full names at closed meetings, again, so that we may be of maximum service to our fellow alcoholics. This is the same for outside agencies.

Our identification of ourselves comes in many ways, from feelings, to what makes us alcoholics, to how we address ourselves. I pray that this identification we have and use continues to bring the suffering alcoholic back from the depths of despair to the joy of living.

Pat Morehouse, Manitoba

Anonymity, Our Spiritual Foundation

The principle of anonymity has been with us throughout the history of the Fellowship. To the best of my knowledge the first documented use of the name Alcoholics Anonymous appeared in a letter from Bill W. to the Rockefeller Foundation in July 1938. The value of anonymity in protecting alcoholics from themselves was recognized early. The stigma attached to alcoholism in A.A.'s early days made the cloak of anonymity a welcome garment.

Prior to coming to this Conference I had the opportunity to share with a past delegate on the beginnings of A.A. in Western Massachusetts. Helena S. was the delegate from Area 31 on Panel 10 in 1960. She is now 89 years young and has celebrated 46 years of sobriety. She recounted several instances of professionals in the area traveling from Springfield, Massachusetts, to Hartford, Connecticut, to attend meetings there to protect their anonymity. She told of her shock at meeting a former neighbor, then a superior court judge, at an open meeting. The zealous guarding of anonymity and the anger and anguish that was experienced when it was broken in those early days was still very clear in Helena's mind.

The same problems Helena was witnessing in our area were causing A.A. no end of grief on the national level. Although Bill had cited the lack of anonymity as one of his reasons for breaking with the Oxford movement in 1937, this view seemed to have been put on the back burner for several years. The evolution of the principle of anonymity to the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions was a painful one. Like all our Traditions it was formed by trial and error. The need to place principles before personalities, for both individual recovery and the common good, became obvious. It was a deep realization that anonymity was a protective shield that the Fellowship needed to observe absolutely in both letter and spirit.

The subject I am supposed to be addressing is our collective humility. Thank God it is not the personal type. When I received the loving invitation to share at the Conference I ballooned to gigantic size. The fact that I knew what was happening in the way of false pride in no way deterred the process.

Our *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* tells us that humility is expressed by our anonymity and that the spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice. If sacrifice is the mirror by which we can see our humility reflected then we are fortunate indeed. For 13 years I have watched this humility in action at every level of my journey of recovery and service.

As a newcomer, I watched nameless A.A.s break away from conversations and welcome me with a smile and a handshake. Anonymous men and women suggested that I get phone numbers and then followed the suggestions with their own numbers. Anonymous men and women patiently answered the same question when asked for the twentieth time. Nameless men and women went out of their way to give me encouraging words and call me by name. A man named John M. came to our group

business meeting and spoke of service. I had heard his story the previous Friday night and I knew he was like me. He spoke of being able to show gratitude with no allusions to personal gain. A sponsor and my new friends gave me help at awkward times of the day and night. Last names, a person's occupation, their mental status and where they lived, were all, in general, unknown to me. It was not a mysterious thing; I did not feel the need to know.

Time in the program changed that somewhat. I saw our Twelfth Tradition at work in a different fashion. I watched dedicated, anonymous men and women juggle job schedules and baby-sitters to help out in the P.I. committee. I saw anonymous young men and women make two-year commitments. I heard befuddled new intergroup representatives being reassured that they would really know their job when their time was up. The same assurances were given to a newly elected delegate a few years later.

We all have seen sacrifice of one kind or another at every level of service. When I and the group I'm working with are surrounded by the spiritual force and awareness of the Tradition of anonymity, principles have always prevailed. Whether it was an individual or a group, there came that certain knowledge that we were not responsible for A.A.'s success any more than we were for our own sobriety. Anonymity, our spiritual foundation, has nurtured A.A. for 56 years. To walk humbly under God is a noble goal for our Fellowship and for ourselves. May God give us the strength to do so one day at a time.

John O'Connor, Massachusetts (Western)

In All Our Affairs

In *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 79) Bill wrote, "Ours is not the usual success story; rather it is the story of how, under God's grace, an unsuspected strength has arisen out of great weakness; of how, under threats of disunity and collapse, world-wide unity and brotherhood have been forged. In the course of this experience we have evolved a set of traditional principles by which we live and work together and relate ourselves as a fellowship to the world around us."

In time, it was recognized that the Twelve Traditions were going to be just as necessary to the life of our society as the Twelve Steps were to each member. The A.A. Traditions were the key to the unity, functioning, and even the survival of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Our collective humility lies in the practice of each of the Twelve Traditions. "... each of our Twelve Traditions is really an expression of the deflation that each of us has to take, of the sacrifice that we shall all have to make in order to live and work together." (*ibid.*, p. 136) And "We are sure that humility, as expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have." (*ibid.*, p. 134)

Bill wrote that implicit in the Traditions was the confession that we have character defects as a society ... that these defects threaten us continually and that the Twelve Traditions also point straight at many of our individual defects.

In his concluding talk, following the Fifth Annual General Service Conference, Bill foresaw that in the future we would make mistakes, but that experience had taught we need have no fear, providing we always remain willing to confess our faults and correct them promptly. He reminds us that "Our growth as individuals has depended upon this healthy process of trial and error. So will our growth as a fellowship. ... that any society of men and women that cannot freely correct its own faults must surely fall into decay if not into collapse. Just as each A.A. must

continue to take his moral inventory and act upon it, so must our whole society do if we are to survive and if we are to serve usefully and well." He tells us that "This is the area in the future life of A.A. where we can never be too prudent or too vigilant." (*ibid.*, p. 231)

Bill examines some attitudes and practices that we must take: "... we must never become so vain as to suppose that we have been the authors and inventors of a new religion. We will humbly reflect that each of A.A.'s principles, *every one of them*, has been borrowed from ancient sources. We shall remember that we are laymen, holding ourselves in readiness to co-operate with all men of good will. ... it would be a product of false pride to believe Alcoholics Anonymous is a cure-all even for alcoholism. Here we must remember our debt to the men of medicine. ... we must be friendly and, above all, open-minded ... to those in the fields of alcoholic research, rehabilitation, and education. We should endorse none especially but hold ourselves in readiness to cooperate as far as we can with them all.

"Our society, therefore, will prudently cleave to its single purpose. ... Let us resist the proud assumption that since God has enabled us to do well in one area we are destined to be a channel of saving grace for everybody. On the other hand, let us never ... deny our experience ... to the world around us. Let our members heed the call to every field of human endeavor. Let them carry the experience and spirit of A.A. into all these affairs, for whatever good they may accomplish.

"Yet ... we must still realize that the more the society of Alcoholics Anonymous as such tends to its own affairs and minds its own business, the greater will be our general influence, ... the wider will be the circle in which our fellowship will be likely to enjoy the confidence and respect of men." (*ibid.*, pp. 231-33)

Bill also tells us that there are "areas where anger and contention could prove our undoing," and warns that "stronger societies than ours have been undone." These are areas "of political and religious strife" and the selfish "pursuit of wealth, fame, and personal power." He expressed confidence that "these forces of destruction will never rule among us," not because of any earned virtue of ours, but because we have suffered enough from them to forget them now and "because we have learned to love God and one another." (*ibid.*, pp. 233-34)

The Traditions ask that every individual and every group and every area in A.A. shall lay aside all desires, ambitions and untoward actions that could bring serious division among us or lose for us the confidence of the world at large.

"True ambition is not what we thought it was. True ambition is the deep desire to live usefully and walk humbly under the grace of God." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, pp. 124-25)

Bobbie Coneen, California (San Diego/Imperial)

Statistics on Delegates

The average age of a delegate is 53.4 years, with the oldest being 74 and the youngest 36 years; average sobriety 14.1 years, longest 33; shortest 7; average length of service 11.4 years, longest 25, shortest 6 years. (Compiled on responses from 78 delegates.)

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.



These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: The past year was dominated by the International Convention, held in Seattle, Washington, over the Fourth of July weekend, and attended by 48,000 A.A.s and Al-Anons. It was the largest gathering of its kind in Seattle, and we were welcomed with open arms by city officials as well as local residents. In the stirring flag ceremony on the opening night, 75 nations acknowledged their debt to Alcoholics Anonymous. One of the many highlights of the weekend was the presentation of the ten-millionth copy of the Big Book to Nell Wing, Bill W.'s long-time assistant.

After two years of deficits, the revenues of the General Service Office exceeded its expenses in 1990. This reflected the determination of the General Service Board that 1990 would not be a deficit year. The proposed budget was trimmed, but services did not suffer. The board is following a similar course for 1991.

Early next year the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine office will be moving into new quarters at Riverside Drive and 120th Street in Manhattan. The building is operated on a nonprofit basis and is occupied by tax-free organizations. As a result, the basic rent is substantially lower than would be otherwise. The General Service Office and the Grapevine should be able to operate more effectively and pleasantly in the new space, which apparently is well suited for their purposes.

Last year some Conference committee' chairpersons were invited to attend the quarterly meeting of the General Service Board in January. Their presence proved so productive and helpful that the chairpersons of all Conference committees were given the opportunity to come to the first quarterly meeting this year. This is part of the process by which the General Service Board tries to keep in touch with delegates on a year-round basis. In that respect, trustees and delegates attending A.A. Regional Forums now meet in a separate session of their own on Forum weekends.

There has been increased communication between the General Service Office and members of the Fellowship in Eastern European countries, particularly those recently liberated from one-party regimes. Within the limits of our resources, we have tried to accommodate the needs of A.A.s in those countries including, among other things, the translation of A.A. literature into other languages and the dissemination of information about the A.A. structure and how it works. The Eleventh World Service Meeting, held last year in Munich, Germany, underscored how reliant A.A.s all over the world are upon the General Service Office and the Grapevine. We shall continue to give as much help as we can to A.A.s in other countries in the coming Conference year.

Although we are responding with greater frequency to requests for help from overseas, we have not allowed ourselves to be diverted from the needs of alcoholics in the United States and Canada. It is abundantly clear to us that minorities continue to be under-represented in A.A., i.e., the elderly, blacks, Hispanics, and Native North Americans. We continue to look for ways to better serve alcoholics in correctional facilities; men and women in the military; sight- and hearing-impaired and other disabled persons. Alcoholics in all these categories have as great a need, if not greater, for the helping hand of A.A. than do the rest of us. We are redoubling our efforts to find ways and means to extend the hand of A.A. to all such alcoholics, and we can use all of the help that we can get for that purpose from everybody in A.A.

Our attention continues to be focused on alcoholics who come to A.A., but leave after an all too brief interval. An analysis of our triennial Membership Survey indicates that 50 percent of alcoholics who attend their first A.A. meeting stay only 90 days. Many explanations are advanced for this phenomenon, but the General Service Board refuses to accept it as a normal condition in our Fellowship. With willingness, imagination, and the many resources of our program, we can make A.A. and sobriety attractive enough so that more newcomers will stay with us longer, while, at the same time, not overlooking those who have been in the program for an extended time. If we make up our minds to do so, then with the grace of God and the collective determination of the entire Fellowship, we will succeed in that effort as we have in others.

Michael Alexander, chairperson

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Trustees' report: A.A. World Services, Inc. is a wholly owned subsidiary of the General Service Board with the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the General Service Office. We meet monthly; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other materials; approve or disapprove requests from outsiders and A.A. members to reprint our copyrighted literature; discuss matters of G.S.O. administration and publishing operations, and such other business as may arise from time to time. There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Four are trustees, including two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending our meetings, but not voting, are other G.S.O. staff members, the director of finance, the controller, assistant controller/business administrator, the services director, the publications director, the secretary, and the recording secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The operating departments (Publications, Finance, Data Processing and Business Administration) report to the director of finance, as does the director of human resources. The A.A. Staff, Stenographic/Clerical, Records, and Files Departments, as well as Archives, all report to the services director.

NOTE: Effective January 1991, there have been organizational changes as follows: The director of finance (who also manages the EDP and business administration functions), the director of human resources, the publications director, and the services director (who manages the A.A. staff, the archives, and the records and files departments) all report directly to the general manager.

During 1990 the A.A.W.S. Board met 12 times. The following items of significance are highlighted:

- The 1990 budget was examined and approved for recommendation to the trustees' Finance Committee. This budget reflected a net operating income of \$929,800 and a net income of \$297,800, including nonrecurring expenses for the computer project and renovation/relocation. Operating expenses reflected an increase of only 3.8% as compared to the 1989 projected actual expenses.
- 1990 midyear adjustments, totaling \$56,900, were recommended to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. These adjustments consisted of an increase to income of \$61,500 and an increase to expenses of \$118,400.
- During 1990, many computer applications were tested and are now running live. Among them are Payable, Receivable, Cash Receipts, Order Entry, Inventory and Contributions. We are currently transmitting pick-pack information to the warehouse via computer modem. As of this writing, all are working, with minor tweaking still necessary. The Grapevine, in addition to using the above mentioned module (except contributions), has been using the subscription fulfillment system since midyear.
- We accepted a recommendation by the Self-support Committee that the board consider the original concept of the five-year plan and define the role of the committee. A self-support presentation was given to the 1990 Conference. Further, the committee explored ideas for posters, a self-support packet, and a focus on birthday contributions. Meetings continue to be held, and a member of the P.I. Committee was invited to attend.
- We granted permission/did not object to 106 requests to reprint and three requests to tape/record/videotape from A.A. literature; we withheld or objected to 16 requests.
- We priced the following material: Russian *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; the Big Book in Spanish, Czechoslovakian,

Arabic, and Hungarian; Russian *Living Sober*; "This is A.A.," "A Newcomer Asks," and "44 Questions" in Cambodian; *Daily Reflections* book; C.P.C. pocket folder; "Time to Start Living" in Spanish; Washingtonian Movement article; videotape of "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" in English and Spanish; *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*. We also approved \$1,500 for closed-caption of the video "Hope."

- On the advice of legal counsel, we now require a more comprehensive attribution be included when granting permission to reprint from A.A. literature, which combines a credit line and disclaimer, to read:

The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions are reprinted and adapted with permission of A.A. World Services, Inc. Permission to reprint and adapt the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions does not mean that A.A. has reviewed or approved the content of this publication, nor that A.A. agrees with the views expressed herein. A.A. is a program of recovery from alcoholism—use of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions in connection with programs and activities which are patterned after A.A., but which address other problems, does not imply otherwise.

- We accepted an expanded service piece regarding use of A.A.'s trademarks and logos, and referred it to the Report and Charter Committee for inclusion in the *A.A. Service Manual*.

- A joint meeting of the A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine Boards was held in October to discuss whether either of the corporate entities should produce and distribute medallions and tokens. Both boards concluded that it would not be appropriate for either A.A.W.S. or the Grapevine to produce tokens and medallions, and that such items were unrelated to their primary purpose. Regarding the use of A.A. logos on tokens and medallions, A.A.W.S. reiterated the position already taken and communicated to the Fellowship; namely, that such use would be trivialization of our trademarks.

- We approved the request for \$5,160 to cover the costs of another printing of the Russian Big Book.

- With the approval of the trustees' Finance Committee, we granted financial assistance in the amount of \$12,600 to Denmark to enable them to include personal stories in the Danish Big Book. This assistance is subject to the terms under which such help is given, i.e., that the inventory is to remain the property of A.A.W.S., Inc., until this total amount is repaid.

- With the approval of the trustees' International Committee, we adopted the recommendation of the subcommittee to handle requests from various agencies and individuals to translate our literature; that these requests continue to be considered by the A.A.W.S. Board on a case-by-case basis, and the full responsibility for the review of these works remains with this board, rather than with the trustees' International Committee.

- The World Service Meeting was held in Munich, Germany, October 14–18. The theme was "The Twelve Concepts for World Service"; 36 delegates from 22 countries attended along with several representatives from G.S.O. One floor action which took place is noted here: "That (the coordinator of) the World Service Meeting write to all participating countries' General Service Boards for the specific purpose of seeking cooperation in the task of raising funds for the current problem of providing start-up literature for those countries unable to finance their own translation and acquisition."

- Countries requesting permission to translate the Big Book are to be asked to include all of the front matter in the translation,

including the Doctor's Opinion, all Forewords, the basic text (pp. 1-164), Dr. Bob's Story, and the Appendices.

- Because of the growth the Fellowship has been experiencing and the many activities and changes that are being contemplated, the board believes it should begin planning for the next ten years, establishing clear and reasonable goals and preparing to respond to all foreseeable challenges and needs that may arise in the coming decade. Without definitive policies and procedures and their organized implementation, the significant role of the U.S./Canada structure in world services might well be undermined. It is strongly felt that a policy statement formulated by the General Service Board would greatly facilitate the efforts of the Long-range Planning Committee, and enable the board to fulfill more consistently and effectively its responsibilities in carrying the message to all alcoholics, wherever in the world they may be.

- After 18 years of service, Betty Liddle retired on September 1, 1990.

- We welcomed two new directors, Jan Whitney and Everett Smethurst.

- We welcomed new staff member Valerie O'Neill, who joined us on September 4.

- Newark, New Jersey, was the site of the Fifth A.A.W.S./Inter-group Seminar in September; about 140 participants from 95 intergroups attended.

- We adopted the following Resolution:

That as a result of concerns arising from the undated letter to the trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., regarding the Reserve Fund, as of December 31, 1989, a subcommittee of the A.A.W.S. Board be appointed to: a) Study and review those portions of the letter dealing with A.A.W.S. and prepare a draft management response with any recommendations to the A.A.W.S. Board. b) Undertake a complete review of A.A.W.S.'s outside firms procedures/process, including an historical and cost review, and prepare recommendations to the A.A.W.S. Board. c) Report to the board no later than June board meeting. The subcommittee will consist of: Phil Cels, Hugh Freyer and Michael McPherson.

- In response to the resolution passed by A.A.W.S. April 26, 1990, the subcommittee is proposing we not prepare a draft management response. Rather, we included here a report to the A.A.W.S. Board:

The appointment of auditor is the responsibility of the General Service Board. Therefore, no historical and cost review was appropriate. Mike McPherson and Phil Cels met with Bud Flanagan and reviewed in detail the letter to the trustees of the General Service Board of A.A. regarding the Reserve Fund. We believe that as a result of this meeting, the treasurer of A.A.W.S. and the auditor will be in close contact during the coming year to anticipate any problems which may arise regarding any aspect of A.A.W.S.'s finances. We further recommend that Mr. Flanagan be invited to attend the A.A.W.S. Board meeting whenever the annual audit is available.

- Many hours were devoted to inspecting various sites to relocate the General Service Office. After thorough examination, the General Service Board approved the move to 475 Riverside Drive, which is an office building for nonprofit organizations. This will affect a savings of \$3,000,000 over the ten-year period of our lease.

- We presented to the owners of our present location the specifics regarding rental costs proposed by the management of 475 Riverside Drive. However, they could not offer a significantly matching proposal.

- We have signed a lease for our present location, for a one-year extension, to expire March 31, 1992, and are receiving bids from architects and designers with plans for the new space.

- Five Regional Forums were held during 1990: Western Canada in Yellowknife, Northwest Territory; Pacific Regional in San Diego, California; Western Canada in Winnipeg; Eastern Canada in Niagara Falls, Ontario; and Southeast in Shreveport, Louisiana.

- We referred to the trustees' Literature Committee the suggestion to include the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions in future printing of *Daily Reflections*, and asked for direction with regard to including the Steps and Traditions in all A.A. recovery literature.

- The 1989 Membership Survey and Survey Analysis became available in December. The analysis contains a history and a comparison with earlier surveys, and helps respond to the Conference's request that we look at what is valid and what might be eliminated in preparation of future surveys.

- The 1991 budget was examined and approved for recommendation to the trustees' Finance Committee, containing price increases to go into effect April 1. The budget reflected a net operating income of \$1,873,700, excluding extraordinary items. Included were extraordinary expenses of double rent/relocation of \$632,700 and relocation/construction of \$1,790,000 (estimated), resulting in a net loss of \$549,000; this amount is to be offset by the earnings of the Reserve Fund of approximately \$564,000 in 1991.

- With the approval of the General Service Board, notice of the new prices was sent to the entire Fellowship at the beginning of February. These increases apply to English books and booklets only. There are no price increases for the large-print edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* or *Daily Reflections*. All other items, such as pamphlets, miscellaneous items, Spanish and foreign literature, remain at 1990 levels and the 20% sales discount applies.

- The price increases were needed to produce sufficient gross profits from literature sales to enable publishing to derive adequate operating income to offset any shortfall in service expenses and other expenses of the board.

Harold Greene, chairperson

Ties Were "In"

Proving that "the greatest form of flattery is imitation," the Pacific regional delegates showed up at their regional luncheon all wearing colorful, splashy ties, like the ones Pacific regional trustee Greg Muth is noted for. Also... John Benson (Panel 40, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire) wore a foot-wide polka dot tie when presenting his candidate for regional trustee. Bert Haas (Panel 41, Northeast Ohio) sported a 6 inch red and blue polka dot tie to "avoid getting it in my soup."

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Archives Committee continued to be concerned with the best ways of gathering, preserving, making accessible, and using our past. We were ever mindful that our responsibilities included not only our central Archives, but also all the local archives which are proliferating and flourishing out in the Fellowship.

The committee planned the program of the session on Archives held at the International Convention in Seattle. The approximately 350 members who attended that session, to hear six local archivists tell of their work and their collections, testified to the Fellowship's growing interest in preserving the story of where we have been. In addition, the participants told us where we, the central Archives, could help them by sharing our experience.

In an attempt to serve local archivists beyond what we are doing in publishing *Markings*, and providing advice on the nitty-gritty of establishing an archival collection, we circulated a questionnaire among those on our mailing lists, asking that they evaluate the usefulness of our present services, as well as tell us what else they need from us. (The questionnaire also allowed us to get our directory of local archives and archivists up-to-date.) We also discussed a variety of other ways to better serve the local areas—for example, having local archivists attend our trustees' Archives Committee meetings from time to time, an idea which we were unable to implement.

Last year, members of the Fellowship had proposed that we look into the feasibility of applying the collective wisdom of past delegates/trustees to current Fellowship concerns. This idea has been discussed at great length, and past delegates/trustees were polled as to how they felt about such an undertaking. We have not reached a consensus about whether or not to proceed. However, both the pros and cons feel strongly about the suggestion, so the trustees' Archives Committee has proposed that a Sharing Session on a board weekend be devoted to more discussion. After that, the committee will decide whether this idea should be forwarded to the 1992 Conference for its evaluation.

The trustees' Archives Committee is now deeply involved in planning for the Archives over the next ten years. The goal we seem to be working toward is the central Archives as a research library, where our past can be gathered in a systematic manner, preserved by state-of-the-art techniques, and made rapidly and electronically available to members of the Fellowship in a form which suits particular needs, whether those needs be for a display or for a background paper on a current issue. We have begun this process by an evaluation of the Archives as it is now. The trustees' Archives Committee would welcome the input of the Fellowship.

The committee has recommended that the Archives photocopy all minutes of board, Conference and trustees' committees on archival paper so that, indeed, we will be able to preserve our experience for future generations.

The Archives has been enriched over the past year by many gifts from members of the Fellowship. We are particularly fortunate to have received all the papers of the late Milton Maxwell, past chairman of the General Service Board.

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., chairperson

Archivist's report: Many may feel that the "Big Event" for Archives was the coming together of a large body of like-interested folks during the 1990 International Convention in Seattle, where over 350 people attended the session entitled "The Archives." And it was! Six experienced archivists from all parts of the U.S.

and Canada presented the history of archives in their areas and shared their struggles. From the Canadian Maritime to Southern California, the participants took their listeners on a tour of archival centers in a wide range of development. What became clear in each talk was the unrelenting growth of interest in our Fellowship's early history. This interest is particularly focused on how growth sprouted from the wanderings of the earlytimers and how early difficulties led Bill toward the development of our Traditions.

Another sign of growth is interest in our newsletter, *Markings*, the local archivist-sharing forum that was born immediately after the 1980 International in New Orleans. While only budgeted for two mailings per year, from the beginning, it's been well received. Our audience now numbers more than 1,700. A recent pilot questionnaire, sent to ask how this mailing is perceived by recipients, found that virtually all respondents felt that it was useful.

Some other indicators of a high degree of awareness of the relevancy of our history and Traditions is the distribution of other items by G.S.O./Archives: over 300 copies of the Washingtonian Analysis by Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., former chairman of the General Service Board; 285 copies of the Prepublication Manuscript of *Alcoholics Anonymous*; and 143 sets of Archival Photos. During 1990, 1,249 visitors signed our guestbook, each leaving a little of themselves behind for our collection.

Frank Mauser, archivist

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1991

	Groups	Members
United States	46,450	1,012,623
Canada	5,046	87,532
Overseas	40,755 ¹	894,260 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,663 ²	52,534 ²
Internationalists		303
Lone members		217
	<u>93,914</u>	<u>2,047,469</u>

1. At the end of 1990, we had reported members from 71 of the 131 overseas countries with A.A. groups. These totaled 34,082 groups and 762,796 members. To establish an estimate for the 60 countries not yet responding, we excluded the ten largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 60 and the overall estimate emerged.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1990 General Service Conference. Over that period we reviewed the 1990 Advisory Actions pertaining to the General Service Conference, and approved that the theme for the 41st General Service Conference be "Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action." It was also recommended that the Conference Workshop be on the Conference theme. The committee reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire, the G.S.O. Post-Conference Sharing Session, and other suggestions, and recommended the following:

- That for the 1991 Conference more time be allocated for "What's on Your Mind?" sharing.
- That for the 1991 Conference, there also be presentations on "The A.A. Grapevine" and "Cooperation not Affiliation: We are Responsible."
- That a brief report of the Eleventh World Service Meeting be part of the 41st General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed all items submitted for 1991 Conference consideration, and referred each item, as appropriate, to a standing Conference committee, Sharing Session, Workshop, or trustees' committee. All items were addressed and responded to, including those not placed on the Agenda because of recent Conference discussion, and matters referred to local autonomy.
- The committee reviewed and finalized the Conference Agenda, assigning participants for the various presentations.

Jacqueline Martin, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the contact for all General Service Conference members, as well as those serving on the general service committees in the 91 areas throughout the United States and Canada. The General Service Conference is responsible for the leadership once held by the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous and, through its structure, carries the A.A. message, and expresses the group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Among the responsibilities of this assignment is coordinating and following through on a year-long basis the arrangements necessary for the annual General Service Conference. A.A. members are encouraged to submit items for the Conference to address, most of the items through the various area assemblies. All suggestions are brought to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for consideration and referral, either to appropriate Conference committees or back to local autonomy. The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics, that are then reviewed for selection by the Conference Agenda Committee and recommended to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for approval.
- Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Corresponding regularly with delegates and other area officers throughout the year.
- Working with the general manager and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and all material for the

Conference Manual, Early Bird Edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Conference Final Report*.

- Reviewing communications, including minutes and reports received from area and district committees.

Eileen Gatz

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community has met three times since the last General Service Conference. At the July 28 meeting, the recommendations and suggestions of the 1990 Conference C.P.C. Committee were reviewed. It was noted that the revised pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A." was being prepared for printing as soon as the current supply had been exhausted.

A subcommittee was appointed to review professional conferences, discuss new material for the C.P.C. Workbook and review current C.P.C. literature. The subcommittee met October 26, 1990 and made the following suggestions: 1. That the trustees' C.P.C. Committee continue to select national conferences to which the professional exhibit will be sent, with cooperation from local C.P.C. committee members. 2. That we continue to energize more area and district C.P.C. committees to participate in state and local conferences. 3. That the trustees' C.P.C. Committee members and other trustees make themselves available to make presentations about A.A. at national conferences. 4. That we go back to core organizations in our exhibit schedule to emphasize our message about what A.A. is and is not, and what A.A. can and cannot do. 5. That we continue to search for national conferences in appropriate professional areas with an eye to reaching minority populations more effectively.

It was also noted that the C.P.C. Workbook needed an additional chapter on providing A.A. exhibits at local professional conferences and meetings, and that we continue to explore options for smaller, more mobile exhibits for local and regional use. This section for the C.P.C. Workbook was forwarded to the Conference C.P.C. Committee.

A recommendation was made to the General Service Board that when the pamphlets "If You Are a Professional," "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" and "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" are reprinted, the Preamble and the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be included. This was accepted by the General Service Board and forwarded to the Conference C.P.C. Committee.

It was suggested that we solicit sharing from area C.P.C. committees on ways local A.A. committees have found success in cooperating with medical schools and universities. As a result of this discussion, the committee suggested the C.P.C. staff member write to the 91 area C.P.C. committees, soliciting sharing on how they cooperate with local universities/schools, medical schools, and engineering schools. The letter was to also encourage C.P.C. committees to use the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" in making presentations to professionals. The C.P.C. staff member wrote this letter and responses will be reviewed at the July meeting.

Professional Exhibit Schedule 1991: In 1990, the C.P.C. staff member and her assistant began a system of grading and evaluating the professional conferences where A.A. had an exhibit, based on local C.P.C.s filling out an Evaluation Form. Included in the evaluation were cost factors, number of responses, size of meeting. This helped in evaluating our C.P.C. efforts. We reviewed the Professional Exhibit schedule for 20 national conferences in

1991 and made appropriate suggestions. The committee approved two special requests from C.P.C. chairpersons to exhibit at the Association for Supervision and Curriculum Development, San Francisco, and the American Society of Addiction Medicine, Boston.

The Professional Exhibit was discussed at length, and it was decided that the staff should work on letting the planners of national professional conferences know that the Fellowship would be willing to participate in conference programs in 1991. Additionally, it was suggested that efforts be made to use Class A trustees or C.P.C. committee members for presentations. This has been acted upon and most of our committee members will make one or two C.P.C. presentations this year.

Presentations Requested in 1991 (a partial list): Fourth Learning Community Conference; Troubled Adolescent Conference; National Council For Aging; National Association of Alcoholism & Drug Abuse Counselors (NAADAC); University of California, San Diego, Annual Summer School of Alcohol & Other Drug Studies; and International Symposium on Substance Abuse and Dependence. Open A.A. meetings have been requested for American Orthopsychiatric Association and National Council for Aging.

Projects completed and in progress:

- The revised pamphlet "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" was published in October 1990 and is currently being distributed.
- As of March 1991, there remains a 12-month supply (64,300) of the old pamphlet "The Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous."

mous." Therefore, the newly revised pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" will not be published until 1992 because of the 1990 Conference C.P.C. recommendation to use up old inventory.

- The pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" is being updated by a subcommittee.

- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Workbook and referred their suggestions to the subcommittee that is working with the Conference C.P.C. Committee to update its contents. There is new material on exhibiting at state and local professional conferences and suggestions for volunteers on how to exhibit literature at such conferences.

- The committee discussed subjects for the *About A.A.* bulletin. Topics suggested for 1991 were: a) reaching special populations through A.A. literature; b) information on A.A.'s videos, a visual description of the videos, specific languages, format, whether "signed," how to order, and prices; c) reaching correctional administrators/probation officers about the effectiveness of A.A. groups in prisons.

- The committee recommended that two new large Professional Exhibits and two tabletop portable exhibits be purchased from Exhibit Corporation for C.P.C. commitments. The estimated price is \$10,000. This would include an initial set of overlays, top header graphics and shipping cases. It was further recommended that portable tabletop units (4' x 7') be made available to area C.P.C. committees for purchase or loan.

Alcoholics Anonymous

About A.A.

Alcoholics Anonymous is a voluntary, worldwide fellowship of men and women from all walks of life who meet together to attain and maintain sobriety. The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership.

Where is it?

A.A. Can be found almost everywhere, almost all the time—in over 90,000 groups in 134 countries throughout the world.

Look for A.A. in your phone book or write:
General Service Office, P.O. Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163

Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of men and women who share their experience, strength and hope with each other that they may solve their common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism.

The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no dues or fees for AA membership; we are self-supporting through our own contributions. AA is not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization or institution; does not wish to engage in any controversy; neither endorses nor opposes any causes. Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety.



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1 Length of History 1935-1940: 10 years 1940-1945: 15 years 1945-1950: 20 years 1950-1955: 25 years 1955-1960: 30 years 1960-1965: 35 years 1965-1970: 40 years 1970-1975: 45 years 1975-1980: 50 years 1980-1985: 55 years 1985-1990: 60 years 1990-1995: 65 years 1995-2000: 70 years 2000-2005: 75 years 2005-2010: 80 years 2010-2015: 85 years 2015-2020: 90 years 2020-2025: 95 years 2025-2030: 100 years	2 Age of Members Under 30: 10% 30-39: 20% 40-49: 30% 50-59: 25% 60-69: 15% 70-79: 10% 80-89: 5% 90-99: 5%	3 Gender Male: 90% Female: 10%
4 Membership in A.A. Total membership: 90,000 Active membership: 80,000 Inactive membership: 10,000 New members: 1,000 Lost members: 500 Total loss: 500	5 Number of Meetings Total meetings: 100,000 Active meetings: 90,000 Inactive meetings: 10,000 New meetings: 1,000 Lost meetings: 500 Total loss: 500	6 Number of Meetings Total meetings: 100,000 Active meetings: 90,000 Inactive meetings: 10,000 New meetings: 1,000 Lost meetings: 500 Total loss: 500
7 Group Membership Total groups: 10,000 Active groups: 9,000 Inactive groups: 1,000 New groups: 100 Lost groups: 50 Total loss: 50	8 Membership Total membership: 90,000 Active membership: 80,000 Inactive membership: 10,000 New members: 1,000 Lost members: 500 Total loss: 500	9 Membership Total membership: 90,000 Active membership: 80,000 Inactive membership: 10,000 New members: 1,000 Lost members: 500 Total loss: 500
10 Membership Total membership: 90,000 Active membership: 80,000 Inactive membership: 10,000 New members: 1,000 Lost members: 500 Total loss: 500	11 Membership Total membership: 90,000 Active membership: 80,000 Inactive membership: 10,000 New members: 1,000 Lost members: 500 Total loss: 500	12 Membership Total membership: 90,000 Active membership: 80,000 Inactive membership: 10,000 New members: 1,000 Lost members: 500 Total loss: 500

- The "Information on A.A." service piece is in need of updating and has been returned to the trustees' C.P.C. subcommittee.
- The "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet and 1989 Membership Survey analysis has been shared with professional organizations, upon request.

At every trustees' C.P.C. Committee meeting we discuss ways to provide better services to area, district and local C.P.C. committees. Suggestions have been made to add more C.P.C. workshops at Regional Forums, as well as include more related articles in *Box 4-5-9*. We are here to serve the Fellowship and welcome your input and suggestions.

John Hartley Smith, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The C.P.C. staff person responds to all mail and telephone inquiries from professionals outside the Fellowship. In 1990 there were many mail inquiries from health professionals, treatment facilities administrators, nurses and social workers. We also heard from school personnel. Whereas ten years ago A.A. meetings were starting on college campuses, now inquiries come in to start A.A. meetings in high schools. Serving as a liaison representative of A.A., on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, the C.P.C. coordinator attended three NIAAA meetings and reported regularly to the G.S.O. and GV staff, the A.A.W.S. Board and trustees' C.P.C. Committee about what is going on in the field of alcoholism.

Communication with area, district and central office C.P.C. committees is an on-going part of this staff assignment. There are approximately 75 area C.P.C. chairpersons listed out of 91 areas, and over 2,380 area, district and central/intergroup office C.P.C. chairpersons and committee members. We read minutes of C.P.C. committee meetings and share them with others, and through the bimonthly newsletter *Box 4-5-9*.

In 1990, the C.P.C. staff assistant forwarded information about 100 different professional conferences, at which A.A. was invited to exhibit, to area C.P.C. chairpersons and area delegates. Some state and local professional meetings that requested A.A. to exhibit were also forwarded to area C.P.C. committees. We provided complimentary literature for these events as we do for the national exhibits. A.A. has five professional exhibits, which are sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1990, A.A.'s exhibits were shown at 26 meetings, resulting in more than 1,092 requests for more information about Alcoholics Anonymous, and 1,469 requests to receive the *About A.A.* bulletin. These 26 conferences are only about 10% of the total professional conferences at which A.A. is invited to exhibit.

About A.A., the triannual newsletter for professionals, will address the subject of A.A. literature for special populations in the spring issue. The mailing list for *About A.A.* increased to over 28,000 through C.P.C. efforts. There is also a plan to purge the mailing list in 1991 to save costs.

Professional conferences that trustees' C.P.C. committee members and staff have attended since the last Conference are: The Exhibition of the President's Committee on Employment of Disabled People; American Psychiatric Association; Drug Free Workplace and Exposition; National Association of Social Workers; S.E. Conference on Alcohol & Drug Abuse. They have also participated in various local, district and area C.P.C. workshops.

C.P.C. literature and guidelines have been updated by Conference and trustees' C.P.C. Committee's action. The C.P.C. Workbook is in the process of being updated by the Conference C.P.C. Committee and a subcommittee of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee. There is new material on making presentations and exhibiting at local conferences that will be included in the next printing. New pocket folders for A.A. literature were priced at A.A.W.S.

at \$10.00 for twenty folders for C.P.C. committees to order for presentations and conferences.

Efforts are being made to produce smaller C.P.C. tabletop exhibits to sell to C.P.C. committees or borrow from G.S.O. Plans continue to set aside some money from the trustees' C.P.C. Committee's 1991 budget to help area C.P.C.s exhibit at various national, regional and state professional conferences. The staff member, serving as secretary of both trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees, is working on ways to provide more A.A. services to those who come in contact with professionals who work with still-suffering alcoholics and, at the same time, keep the budget balanced.

In January/February 1991, the C.P.C. staff member and her assistant: Wrote 20 professional journals/newsletters about A.A.'s 1989 Membership Survey, enclosing the pamphlet and complete Analysis, at the request of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee; wrote 25 professional organizations/conferences, in response to a request to exhibit A.A. literature, offering to make a presentation on A.A. or organize an open A.A. meeting at the request of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee; prepared a list of 20 national conferences where A.A. material might be exhibited in 1991, and an additional list to be considered; worked with Exhibit Corporation on a new design for A.A.'s Professional Exhibits, large units, as well as table-top units; wrote area C.P.C. committees about new pocket folders for sale; met with 12 Cornell medical students at G.S.O.

Susan Ulseth

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to communicate the message and the fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous to the "nation within a nation" in correctional facilities.

The new booklet, *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, approved by the 1990 General Service Conference, became available to the Fellowship mid-February 1991. It contains 32 correctional facilities stories from previous Grapevines, which were selected by a subcommittee. The committee has researched the expense of producing a 60-minute audio tape based on *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* including culturally varied voices. The Conference Committee will discuss the feasibility of this tape.

A revised Correctional Facilities Workbook became available in January 1991. This revision includes all Conference recommendations and a completed 1990 "state of the nation" survey. The committee continues to study the Workbook for possible updating to reflect suggestions and experience from areas, districts, intergroups and correctional facilities committees.

The committee wishes to emphasize the importance of A.A. prerelease contact work at all levels of the service structure. A prerelease contact list, to be distributed by G.S.O., is being forwarded to the Conference Committee for consideration. The committee has also discussed, at length, the problem and solutions for integrating long-term correctional facility/H & I committees with local area service structures. This concern is being forwarded to the 1991 Conference Committee for direction.

The trustees' C.F. Committee is concerned with improving the distribution of all correctional facilities material, including the video tape "It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell." There is particular concern about reaching inmates with literacy problems through audiovisual material. This committee welcomes all suggestions to help our search for ways to communicate our A.A. message to those on the "inside."

Amos E. Reed, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities desk extends the hand of Alcoholics Anonymous to those who are unable to walk to a meeting, call a sponsor or are free to participate in the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous which we on the "outside" take for granted. At the present time there are 1,645 correctional facilities groups and 1,000 correctional facilities committee chairpeople, members, group sponsors and contacts.

In addition to serving as secretary to the Conference and trustees' Correctional Facilities Committees, the staff member on this assignment writes over 6,000 letters a year. Basically, correspondence with inmates falls into three main categories: Providing information about the Fellowship through complimentary literature: the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, pamphlets selected for inmates, back issues of the Grapevine and the Correctional Facilities Directory of prison meetings and local correctional facilities committees; providing information about the Corrections Correspondence Service; answering requests to set up an A.A. support network prior to an inmate's release.

Other correspondence responds to all aspects of correctional facilities service. The Correctional Facilities desk writes directly to local correctional facilities committees when an inmate has contacted G.S.O. with release dates and information. The intent is for correspondence to begin with A.A.s in the inmate's home community so he or she leaves the facility with personal experience of the "outside" Fellowship prior to and immediately upon release. This correspondence is in addition to the Corrections Correspondence Service in which an "outside" A.A. member shares the message of recovery during the inmate's term of confinement. Large literature requests are referred to local correctional facilities committees to establish direct contact between correctional facilities' groups and local committees. We are encouraging prison groups to use the New Correctional Facilities Group Information Form to update our records and provide accurate information for the Correctional Facilities Directory. The C.F. desk has collected a current list of correctional facilities committee chairpeople and local contacts to refer inmates' requests for prerelease support to local committees. We are also in contact with many area correctional facilities committees who are developing service material and information for exchange to provide inmates with a strong support system in their transitions from "inside" to "outside."

The new booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* will be used in carrying the message of A.A. into correctional facilities. The waiting time for an inmate to be connected with an "outside" A.A. member through the Corrections Correspondence Service has been reduced from months to weeks. The article in *Box 4-5-9* about the Corrections Correspondence Service will, hopefully, create more interest in the ongoing need for correspondents to carry the message of recovery. The Correctional Facilities desk contributes articles to *Box 4-5-9* to assist communication of correctional facilities service work to the widest possible A.A. membership.

The Correctional Facilities Workbook continues to be reviewed and updated to serve as a resource to local correctional facilities committees. We continue to research how to use video cassettes and audio tapes to carry the message to those in correctional facilities who have difficulty reading. The C.F. Workbook contains a revised guide for use of Conference-approved pamphlets and a guide for registering new correctional facilities groups with the General Service Office. Each new group is sent a Group Handbook, pamphlets directed to those who are confined, a copy of the Big Book and a copy of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*.

As the prison population is expanding rapidly and the rate of alcohol-related crimes is increasing, the work of the trustees' and Conference Correctional Facilities Committees, as well as local committees, truly is on the front line of carrying the A.A. message.

Valerie O'Neill

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: The results for 1990 of the General Service Office and the Grapevine reflect a lot of positives. First, there is the bottom line for the General Service Office, an operating income of \$1,061,000 for 1990 versus an operating loss of \$697,400 for 1989. After adjusting for extraordinary income from the International Convention of \$190,000, and extraordinary expenses for the computer implementation project of \$311,400, the net income for 1990 was \$939,600 compared to a net loss of \$1,204,800 in 1989. Contributions which were originally projected for 1990 at \$4,100,000, and revised upward at mid-year to \$4,350,000, came in at \$4,416,900, 8.9% over 1989 actual.

Net sales for 1990, originally budgeted to be \$10,624,300, were revised downward at mid-year to \$9,713,500, including the anticipated income from the new book, *Daily Reflections*. This was done to reflect a downward trend in all unit sales. The actual net sales for 1990 were \$10,114,000, 4.1% greater than projected, mainly due to greater than anticipated sales of the new item. *It must be noted, with concern, that 1990 book volumes, for the first time in anyone's memory, exclusive of the new item, decreased by 6.3% from 1989.* Gross profits from sales rose to almost acceptable levels, due to some price increases January 1, 1990, and stable printing costs.

Total operating expenses for the year were \$8,827,200; \$202,300 (2.2%) less than budgeted and \$310,800 (3.6%) over 1989. The net income from the International Convention was \$190,000. This was originally budgeted at \$47,400 and later, over-optimistically revised upward to \$347,400. All in all, as the event is not intended to be a fund-raiser, it made a modest income. It did not lose money, which is our mandate in budgeting the event. A.A. threw a birthday party, and everybody came.

The income generated by publishing was able to cover the shortfall of Office Expenses to be paid for by contributions. This deficit was only \$4,600 in 1990, as compared to a projected shortfall of Office Expenses against contributions of \$53,900.

A.A.
in
Prison
INMATE
to
INMATE

Publishing income was then used to offset Other Expenses of the board of \$532,500 and computer project expenses of \$311,400.

The budget for 1991, reflecting mostly literature price revisions to obtain adequate gross margins, indicates an operating income of \$1,873,700. The bottom line for 1991 reflects a loss of \$549,000, which is less than the anticipated earnings from the General Service Board Reserve Fund in 1991. The net loss of \$549,000 results from duplicate rent, incurred related to the move to our new facilities in early 1992, and that portion of relocation and construction costs estimated to occur in 1991. In 1990, the Reserve Fund earned \$550,400; there were no draw downs, and a contribution from the Grapevine of \$82,800 was made to the Reserve Fund. Our look into 1992 reflects additional costs from this move, with savings beginning to inure as a result of lower rent at the new location, thereby reducing annual operating expenses.

The Grapevine, as initially noted, also had a good year. Revenue amounted to \$2,054,700 while expenses totaled \$1,908,100, thus resulting in a net income from operations of \$86,600 compared to an earlier expected net loss from operations of \$67,200. In addition, interest earned from operations, and unfulfilled subscription monies held in the Reserve Fund, totaled \$107,300, bringing the total income for the year to \$193,900. The large variance is accounted for by revenue being \$30,700 over budget, and expenses \$123,000 under budget. The 1991 Grapevine budget forecasts an operating loss of \$41,400, offset by interest income of \$100,000, leaving a net income of \$65,600. This is comprised of revenue estimated to be \$58,100 over 1990 actual, resulting from their price increase, which will offset slightly lower estimated circulation. Expenses will increase 9.4% over 1990 actual.

The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance of \$7,095,400 yielding approximately 7.8% on book value and representing 8.4 months of combined operating expenses (G.S.O. and Grapevine). This is up \$633,200 from the end of 1989 which represented about 7.8 months of coverage. There were no draw downs in 1990; the Grapevine contributed \$82,800 to the fund, and the fund earned \$550,400.

As we look ahead to 1991 and beyond, we are concerned about decreasing literature unit sales. We are confident though, that the 1991 price increase re-establishes prudent gross margins for almost all of our major products. We anticipate no general price increases for at least three years. With the upcoming relocation and the reduced rent and operating costs, we hope that we have righted the financial ship and the boards can concentrate on the policies and future of A.A.

Robert P. Morse, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The three General Sharing Sessions since the last Conference discussed issues of specific interest to the board and the Fellowship. The topic of the "Reserve Fund" was presented at the July meeting, focusing on its history and sources of funding and the significant role it plays in the overall finances of the Fellowship. The presentations emphasized the need to keep our ever-changing groups informed of the importance of the Reserve Fund and to foster among the membership a fuller appreciation of the fact that, were we unable to rely on the Reserve Fund and the latitude and security it affords us, we would surely be obliged to make major cutbacks in services. No one disputed the need for the Reserve Fund; however, there were varied opinions on what constitutes an appropriate cap.

In October presentations were given on the "Responsibility and Relationship of A.A. in the U.S. and Canada to A.A. Worldwide." According to one presentation there has existed, among some people in overseas service structures, a perception that the U.S./Canada structure has unlimited funds. This perception was corrected at the 1990 World Service Meeting and it was the sense of that body that an International Monetary Fund should be established to develop start-up literature for countries unable to do this for themselves.

Much of the discussion focused on how and by whom this fund would be administered and where our responsibilities in carrying the A.A. message to other countries lie in relationship to other service structures. It was felt that it is our responsibility to carry the message to others, and it is gratifying to know others have shared and will continue to share the obligation to translate literature. It became clear however, that guidelines and policies need to be established. There are many details to work out and much sharing is still needed.

The topic for the February 1991 sharing session was "Reaching the Alcoholics in Prisons." The two presentations emphasized the need to encourage more outside A.A.s to go and share their experience, strength and hope. In view of the fact that many have poor reading skills, there is a need for illustrated and simplified A.A. reading material and audiovisuals.

It was felt that A.A. not only needs to reach inmates, but also wardens, deputy wardens, probation officers and other administrative personnel. It was suggested that C.P.C. might approach correctional facility professionals and make presentations on A.A. which might in turn stimulate their interest in having an A.A. meeting in their facility. Another suggestion was to have presentations and/or workshops at Regional Forums to help stimulate



enthusiasm among A.A.s to become involved in this type of service and Twelve Step work.

It was shared that some difficulties in getting A.A.s involved with this type of service work was the "fear factor" and the question was raised on how to eliminate this. Suggestions included workshops, sponsorship, more information, but it all boils down to perhaps just one thing, "just go, visit and see what happens." We were reminded that this is a "nation within a nation" and that we need patience and perseverance.

Don Bruner, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole. This includes overseeing the production of service material, the 15 A.A. Guidelines, the Group Handbook, self-support material, and G.S.R. kits. Most of this material is available in English, Spanish and French.

The General Service Office continues to work toward providing services to all A.A. groups within the U.S./Canada Conference structure in the three major languages of North America. G.S.O. now lists approximately 1,409 French-speaking groups and 844 Spanish-speaking groups.

There is a variety of service material available to A.A.s upon request. Service material is different from Conference-approved literature in that it has not come about through the Conference process and is not the result of an Advisory Action. Service material reflects A.A. experience and information that is shared through the General Service Office; it is subject to change.

The group services coordinator also has oversight responsibility for the production of the five A.A. directories; Eastern U.S.; Western U.S.; Canadian; International; and Correctional Facilities. He or she serves on the A.A.W.S. Self-Support Committee; acts as a liaison for central offices/intergroups and participates in the Central Office/Intergroup Seminars, as well as coordinating the annual meeting of the French Literature Committee. Part of the assignment of Group Services and Regional Forums coordinator is to act as secretary for the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, which meets annually at the General Service Conference.

Pat Rosenstiel

INTERNATIONAL / WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: This committee serves as a link between the World Service Meeting and the General Service Board, is a focal point for information about A.A. around the world, and develops ways to foster A.A. growth in countries where our Fellowship is just getting started.

World Service Meeting—The Eleventh World Service Meeting was held in Munich, Germany, October 14—18, 1990. There were 36 delegates representing 25 countries. John Quinn and I served as the delegates for U.S./Canada. The theme was "Twelve Concepts for World Service." There was a great deal of interest shown in the Concepts and it was recommended that they also be a topic at the Twelfth World Service Meeting. In addition to the Concepts, there was considerable discussion about the work being done throughout the world in carrying the message to those in countries which do not have a general service structure or the financial means to provide their own literature.

The 36 delegates to the World Service Meeting unanimously

agreed that:

[The coordinator] of this (World Service) meeting write to all participating country's General Service Boards for the specific purpose of seeking cooperation in the task of raising funds for the current problem of providing start-up literature for those countries unable to finance their own translations and acquisitions.

The letter was sent and we have heard from a few countries since then, reporting that this matter would be presented to their respective general service conferences for reply.

Overseas Literature—This past year we have been asked for literature assistance from Nepal to Egypt. After reviewing the proposed literature assistance budget for 1991, the committee requested that the spiritual and financial implications of the budget be addressed further by A.A. World Services and the General Service Board; this was subsequently done. Following that, the literature assistance budget for \$295,000 was approved for 1991.

Overseas Information—In order to gain a clearer picture of what is going on around the world, the committee instructed the secretary to contact other general service offices to learn what they are doing to help other countries in the way of Twelfth Step work, i.e., fostering visitations and literature assistance. The purpose of this communication is to better coordinate our efforts to help others and to avoid duplication of work.

W.F. (Webb) Johnson, chairperson

Staff report: Correspondence from groups and individual A.A.s in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. When correspondence comes to us in a foreign language, it is translated and a response sent in the same language. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 37 G.S.O.s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Denmark, Ecuador, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, India, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland (French-speaking), Switzerland (German-speaking), Trinidad/Tobago, Uruguay, Venezuela and West Germany. When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.s. If an overseas G.S.O. needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O., U.S./Canada.

World Service Meeting—A major highlight of this assignment is planning and coordinating the World Service Meeting which meets biennially in the United States and overseas. The Eleventh World Service Meeting was held October 14—18, 1990, in Munich, Germany. The theme was "Twelve Concepts for World Service." The final report will be ready this spring.

Interim Zonal Meetings—The European and Ibero-American service meetings are also held biennially, alternating with World Service Meetings. Their primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. They sponsor countries without service structures into service and contribute to the growth of A.A. worldwide.

A.A. Literature Overseas—To protect A.A.'s message, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards, centers, and literature committees permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature in the language of the country. A request to print would come from the board or representative A.A. committee and before any printing begins G.S.O. first explores how material will be financed and distributed. The request for permis-

sion to print or reprint is then presented to the A.A.W.S. Board.

A.A. World Services Board also translates and prints foreign language literature needed overseas. This applies to countries where there is no G.S.O., or no G.S.O. that publishes in the country's language. Each proposal for translation is considered on an individual basis by A.A. World Services as the budget permits. Since the first of the year, we have published the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in Arabic, Turkish and Lithuanian.

International A.A. Directory—The staff member also oversees the updating of the International A.A. Directory used by traveling members and for Twelfth Step purposes.

Sarah Price

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION / A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—We now know that the vast majority of the 48,000 attendees at the 55th U.S./Canada International Convention, in Seattle, Washington, last July had a wonderful experience. Lois Fisher, the Convention coordinator, other G.S.O. personnel, the convention consultant and the incredibly well-organized and welcoming Seattle host committee did a tremendous job.

The International Convention Committee received a report from its subcommittee evaluating the 1990 International Convention. Its suggestions and recommendations have been forwarded to the Joint International Convention Committee. With regard to Convention management for 1995, the committee requested G.S.O. to solicit bids from four meeting management firms and/or convention consultants. This was done, and Talley Management, who worked with us on the 1990 International Convention, was selected. Since Al-Anon will not be holding an International Convention in San Diego in 1995 and has indicated an interest in participating by holding meetings and workshops, as they have at other of our International Conventions, the committee recommended inviting Al-Anon to participate in our 1995 Convention.

The committee considered an invitation from Australia to hold the International Convention for the year 2000 in that country. It was agreed that the International Convention is hosted by the General Service Board for the United States and Canada. A.A.s in Australia and any other country interested in holding an International Convention will be advised that, in the spirit of autonomy, any General Service Board may host an International Convention. It was also pointed out that at some point in the future, International Conventions might be held simultaneously in the different parts of the world, linked by satellite or some other form of telecommunications.

The committee recommended that the General Service Office retain Talley Management for site selection for the International Convention in the year 2000, on the terms and conditions that are deemed suitable by the General Service Office.

In September 1990, invitations to submit bid proposals for the site of the 65th Anniversary International Convention (2000) were sent to the delegates in the U.S. and Canada. Bids proposals were received from Akron, Atlanta, Baltimore, Cincinnati, Detroit, Houston, Indianapolis, Miami, Minneapolis, New Orleans, St. Louis, St. Petersburg, San Antonio, Toronto, and Vancouver. Of these, the following cities met the basic requirements established for bidding on the Convention: Atlanta, Detroit, Houston, Indianapolis, Minneapolis, New Orleans, St. Louis, San Antonio, Toronto.

At the joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Committees on International Convention, during this Conference week, three potential sites will be recommended to this Conference from these eight eligible cities. Final selection of the site of the year 2000 International Convention will be made by the General Service Board in late 1991, following site-inspection trips.

A.A. Regional Forums—From the Pacific Region's huge gathering in San Diego to the wonderful friends in Western Canada's Winnipeg, and Eastern Canada's Niagara Falls, Ontario, to Yellowknife in the vast Northwest Territory of the Western Canada Region, to the Southeast Region's Shreveport, Louisiana, the Regional Forums held in 1990 were weekends of incredibly energetic and dedicated A.A. sharing. Each Forum had its own special flavor, and reports are available from each Forum for any member who would like to take a peek at the Forum in this brief encapsulated version.

Dr. Jack Norris, late chairman of the board emeritus (Class A), in his recognition of the need for continuing dialogue between the General Service Board and A.A. members in all regions, had the vision to describe and initiate the Forum adventure in *Alcoholics Anonymous*. This vision is being fulfilled as A.A. service people in the U.S. and Canada regions share directly with trustees of the General Service Board; the directors of the two service corporations, A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine; as well as G.S.O. and GV staff members and employees. There have been 64 Regional Forums since they began in 1975, with five of those in the last year.

Each Regional Forum has an Agenda which includes workshops and presentations, sharing sessions, reports, and Ask-It-Baskets. Topics for presentations and workshops are all suggested by the regions' delegates and other A.A. service people. The schedule for 1991 and 1992 Forums is as follows:

1991		
May 31, June 1-2	Northeast	Bethesda, MD
August 2-4	West Central	Omaha, NE
October 11-13	East Central	Columbus, OH
December 6-8	Southwest	Tulsa, OK
1992		
September 25-27	Eastern Canada	Hull, PQ
June	Pacific	San Francisco, CA
	Western Canada	British Columbia
	Southeast	Virginia Beach, VA

Jan Whitney, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention—The International Convention assignment involves coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make up our International Conventions. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, Host and G.S.O. Planning—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a celebration of A.A. sharing and thanksgiving.

Very preliminary plans are already underway for the 1995 International Convention in San Diego, which will pave the way to preparing the big meetings, celebratory dances, approximately 250 sessions of workshops, panels, regional alkathons, topic meetings and marathons, with about 1,000 speakers and moderators. The beautiful San Diego Convention Center will be one of the main hubs of activity, and, of course, the Jack Murphy Stadium will be the site of the Big Meetings. San Diego A.A.s will

be recruiting a volunteer Host Committee, and everyone is already excited about working on this complex but so worthwhile event.

Eileen Gatz

Regional Forums—The responsibilities of this assignment involve the coordination and follow through for all arrangements necessary for holding the Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These weekends of sharing help to foster better communication and deeper understanding between A.A. service workers, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards, and the General Service Office with A.A.s in all of the regions. Regional Forums are held at the region's invitation every two years and there are usually four Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator requests topics for presentations and ideas for workshop themes from the area delegates. Invitations are mailed to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, central offices and intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The staff member prepares the agenda for the Forum weekend, using the ideas for presentation and workshop topics that have come in from the areas within the region for which this Forum is being planned. The Forum coordinator works hand-in-hand with the hotel to make sure that all of the requirements for the meetings, workshops, sharing sessions, as well as coffee and other details, are covered. She or he is also responsible for seeing that there are displays of A.A. Conference-approved literature and other service literature, as well as Archives material, at each Forum. Interpreters and simultaneous translations, when needed, are also arranged by the Forum coordinator. The work for a Regional Forum often begins three or four years in advance. Every effort is made to ensure that a climate of open sharing and communication can take place in a comfortable setting.

The chairman of the board, other Class A and Class B trustees, general service trustees, and trustees-at-large, as well as directors of the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards and staff members from G.S.O. and the Grapevine, usually attend and participate in each Regional Forum. When the weekend of sharing is finished, all of the presentations and report-backs, Ask-In-Basket questions and sharing sessions are condensed into a report by the coordinator and sent to all A.A. members who registered for the Forum.

Pat Rosenstiel

LITERATURE

Trustees report: Projects completed—As the result of General Service Conference approval, the following items have become available: "The A.A. Group" pamphlet—major revision; *Daily Reflections*.

Project in progress—A.A. History Book: A detailed status report was given to the Conference Literature Committee (the 1990 Conference expanded the dates covered to include 1955 to the present).

Projects completed and manuscripts or reports forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee (suggested by previous Conference Actions): (1) The deletion of the six-point definition of an A.A. group in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet (1990 revision) and the addition of some minor revisions. (2) A further simplification of the text for the proposed Twelve Steps Illustrated (easy-to-read) pamphlet. (3) A report on the feasibility study of the filmstrip and video of "Circles of Love and Service" revealed no need to update this material. (4) The decision to add a story of a young person who found A.A. while in prison to the "Young People and A.A." pamphlet, with the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee gathering some stories for return to the trustees' Literature Committee.

Other matters sent to the Conference Literature Committee: (1) A report and background on the possibility of developing a pamphlet on "unity," with a request for guidance on focus and direction. (2) Consider adding the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions to *Daily Reflections*. (3) Consider the need to produce *Daily Reflections* on audiocassette. (4) Consider the best possible ways to carry our message to black people and other minorities through literature. (5) Consider deleting the line in the opening statement of "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" pamphlet that says: "It is significant that the 'Twelve Concepts for World Service' is the only piece of Conference-approved literature that carries a personal by-line: 'by Bill W.'"

Phil J. Cels,
chairperson



Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroup and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and material to assist them in this vital responsibility.

Additionally, the literature coordinator serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, our bimonthly newsletter. Total current circulation of *Box 4-5-9* is: English—61,327; French—4,230; Spanish—23,372. Every A.A. group listed with G.S.O. receives a complimentary subscription to the newsletter, as do overseas general service offices, intergroups/central offices, and literature distribution centers. In the interest of self-support, annual subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* are available for \$3.50 (single copies) and \$6.00 (10 copies).

Joanie Moncrief

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: As the name implies, Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are now about 250 Loners in 90 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists. There are now about 300 Internationalists and 35 Port Contacts. Sixty Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 150 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group.

Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes. A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer, or Internationalist. Each receives a directory of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists. Additionally, they receive complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*, which is a bimonthly discussion meeting in print, sharing excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members.

About 800 A.A.s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experience with Loners, Homers and Internationalists. With approximately 1,700 A.A.s (including Loner Sponsors) participating in the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting* by mail, we might call it the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s phenomenal worldwide growth can be attributed largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the Seven Seas who carry the A.A. message wherever they may be.

This past year G.S.O. conducted a "sweep" of the Loners service mailing list and reduced the list by approximately 2,700. An updated Loners Directory, reflecting these changes, will be printed this year.

Due to the military activity in the Middle East, we have received numerous requests for correspondence from G.I.s serving in that area. The following are excerpts from some of the letters received at G.S.O.:

A few days ago an A.A. friend here showed me a LIM and, after reading it, I decided I would like to become a member of the Loners service, at least until I go back home. The way things are developing over here, we never know how much contact we will be able to keep with other A.A.s, so the LIM would then become very important. I received one letter, one single, simple letter from an A.A. friend and it meant more than a thousand pen pal letters. The letter enclosed a lot of love and made my Christmas a little better. My second birthday is January 1st. I've had two years of magic, blessings, craziness, love, etc. Life keeps getting deeper and deeper and I'm learning to love it.

Thanks for your letter and well wishes. I didn't have a pleasant Christmas and I doubt if the New Year will be any better. Now for the good part, I'm receiving letters from A.A.s everywhere and I'm trying to answer them all. I enjoy each one, I've received 'care' packages, books, literature, letters, cards, pictures and all the love, care and kindness a man could want. If anyone asks, this Fellowship is great. It's nice to know I'm still loved.

I am a sober member of A.A. for eight years and recently have been deployed to Saudi Arabia. As you might have guessed, my meetings of A.A. have been cut to zero. I have my Big Book with me, but that is all I have. If you have any extra A.A. info I would be most appreciative if you would kindly forward any such material to me. I can tell you that a sober life in the desert is a most unique lifestyle. I can offer you these few personal thoughts. A.A. has shown me that, even without meetings or another A.A. contact, one can stay sober. The program has changed my life. Even in these trying days of the Gulf crisis, I find that living the sober life is most rewarding. Even with the threat of armed conflict, I can have a good day. Operation Desert Shield has shown me a new meaning of living 'one day at a time.' Meditation and prayer with God continue on a daily basis. I owe my life to A.A.

John Grant

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed a letter regarding the appointment of appointed committee members and suggested that past delegates be rotated a minimum of one year before applying for this position. The committee also recommended the removal of all geographical restrictions regarding candidates for appointed committee member positions, per the 1990 General Service Conference Action pertaining to general service trustees.

The committee reviewed its guidelines for selecting G.S.O.'s general manager, as well as "emergency procedures" for hiring a general manager, and accepted both, with minor revisions. We also reviewed the "Procedures and Areas of Responsibility" chart, attachment to its Composition, Scope and Procedure, and accepted it, as presented, with minor changes. In reviewing the chart the following was recommended:

- that the corporate boards, in nominating nontrustee directors and general service trustees, send their conclusions to the Nominating Committee before its October meeting, so that the committee will have some latitude in fulfilling its responsibility to the General Service Board.

- that, based on letters from members of the Fellowship, the General Service Board guidelines for the selection process for nontrustee directors of the corporate boards be detailed and then

included in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- that the guidelines for selection of appointed committee members of the trustees' committees be published in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The committee reviewed and approved for mailing the letter, procedures and resume forms for election of candidates for regional trustees from the Northeast and Southwest U.S. regions and trustee-at-large/Canada and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for these impending vacancies.

The committee recommended that Greg Muth serve on the A.A. World Services Corporate Board as a regional trustee, replacing Phil J. Cels, and also recommended that Marc Pineau serve on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, as a regional trustee, replacing Donald J. Bruner.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1991 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Robert P. Morse
John N. Chappel, M.D.	Amos E. Reed
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.	John Hartley Smith, M.D.
John E. King	

Class B

Donald J. Bruner	John J. Quinn
Phil J. Cels	Stanley N. Silverman
Harold Greene	Jean Smith
Jacqueline Martin	Desmond Towey
Greg Muth	Jan Whitney
Marc Pineau	

(Two regional trustees and one trustee-at-large to be selected April 17, 1991)

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Michael Alexander
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	John E. King
<i>Secretary</i>	John J. Quinn
<i>Treasurer</i>	Robert P. Morse
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Edward H. Gordon
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Helen Turnquest (to be replaced at rotation, September 1991)

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1991 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Hugh Freyer	Everett Smethurst
Harold Greene	Jean Smith
Michael J. McPherson	Jan Whitney
Greg Muth	Helen Turnquest (to be replaced at rotation, September 1991)
Wayne Parks	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1991 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Bernard C. Benziger	Jane Murphy Schulberg
John E. King	Stanley N. Silverman
Jacqueline Martin	Ames Sweet
Marc Pineau	Desmond Towey
Fran Polek	Ann Warner

John King, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We try to do that by creating a better understanding about what A.A. does and does not do, and by trying to prevent misinformation. We also try to maintain some awareness of the composition and growth of A.A. as a whole through our triennial Membership Survey, which plays an important role in helping us formulate public information communications.

Among the tasks assigned to the trustees' committee are those of producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films or videos about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; preparing health fair and other community exhibits; conducting A.A. membership and other surveys; contributing to the *Box 4-5-9* newsletter; preparing various P.I./P.R. packages and extending the hand of A.A. to anyone, anywhere, who reaches out for help. The trustees' committee provides guidance to the public information staff person at the General Service Office and acts as a resource to public information committees who are doing work in the schools, with the public media and with health fairs at the area, district and local levels. In the past year, the committee:

- Responded to several Advisory Actions in connection with the triennial Membership Survey. The 1989 "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet has been completed and distributed as has the survey analysis. A report has been prepared for this Conference which responds to the request for information about the history of the survey and which makes recommendation for future membership surveys for discussion by this public information committee.
- Prepared and approved a three-minute pilot video to present to the Conference to indicate the feasibility of continued production of a 15-minute video using younger A.A. members and minorities to target urban minority schools in response to a request from public information committees from New York, Los Angeles and Philadelphia.
- Conducted a feasibility study on the possible production of a Traditions video with focus on anonymity. A report on that project was in response to a 1990 Conference Advisory Action and was prepared for this Conference.
- Approved press releases and media kits for the 1990 International Convention in Seattle.
- Approved the press release in connection with the World Service Meeting, October 1990, in Munich, Germany.
- Approved sending the anonymity letter to the media, including all daily newspapers, in 1991.
- Approved a change in the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the trustees' Public Information Committee to reflect recent actions by the General Service Board in allowing for appointed committee members to be sought and appointed without regard to geographical considerations, so that members from all over the United States and Canada may be considered for work on the committee.
- Approved the appointment of three new appointed committee members, which brought the committee up to 11 members, a full complement approved by a change in the Composition, Scope and Procedure in the past year to raise the number of members of the committee from 10 to 11.



The committee hears reports of P.I. activities in the area, district and local levels through staff reports and the input of regional trustees. We applaud the work the areas are doing and we will continue to assist that work with what we hope are effective media materials and resources for describing Alcoholics Anonymous to the public.

Desmond Towey, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message of recovery from alcoholism to alcoholics through the general public, the media, health fairs and schools. It is also a crucial part of public information work here at the Genral Service Office to be a resource and a central collector of sharing for public information committees throughout the United States and Canada at the area, district, and local levels. The staff member and staff assistant respond to an average of 100 written and telephone inquiries that come into the office weekly from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff person is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what it can and cannot do, and providing accurate information to the media, researchers, the public and to A.A. members about Alcoholics Anonymous.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of health and community fairs. In many cases, local public information committees requested literature to support their participation in fairs and in many cases we receive requests directly from community leaders who were responsible for these fairs. When possible, we try to connect the community resource with local A.A. public information committees so that they can become involved with the decision about how A.A. can best participate in the event. A large amount of literature, especially the pamphlets and flyers "A Message to Teenagers," "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" and "A.A. at a Glance," was sent to community resources and to public information committees.

It has also been our responsibility to read and process about 5,000 newspaper, magazine and television feature stories since the last Conference. We wrote approximately five letters of gratitude each month to publications printing accurate information about our Fellowship and handled an average of 20 anonymity breaks per month by trying to contact, through area delegates and public information committees, the A.A. member whose anonymity had been broken. New public information chairpersons are automatically sent the Public Information Workbook, and all P.I. committee members and contacts receive Box

4-5-9, as well as any new public service material. Discount packages and one-way displays about the Membership Survey are also made available to P.I. committees. During the past year, many public information committees have been reporting an increasing use of our videos in their work, including the new video, "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous."

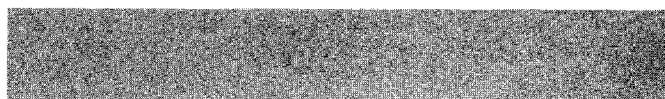
The trustees' Public Information Committee recently held a joint meeting with the trustees' Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees to discuss how we might better raise the consciousness of the Fellowship about the four most recent videos. Also discussed was getting more accurate information about our public service announcements to public information committees through our literature order catalog. Many requests for help in planning radio, cable and television programs about Alcoholics Anonymous or about airing A.A. meetings were handled in the past year. Work continues through the trustees' P.I. Committee on addressing these matters and heightening the awareness of the importance of anonymity in the media.

The Anonymity subcommittee is presenting to this Conference a draft for review on an anonymity section to be placed in the Public Information Workbook. The Minorities subcommittee has been working on a three-minute pilot video using younger people and minorities in developing a 15-minute video to be used in urban schools. Another project, a video on the Traditions with focus on anonymity, is in the feasibility stages of development and will be presented at this Conference.

Substantial work has taken place during the past year in connection with the A.A. Membership Survey. The 1989 "Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey" pamphlet is now completed and printed as well as the analysis of the triennial survey. The subcommittee also has done a great deal of work in responding to last year's Conference Advisory Actions and in preparing recommendations for future membership surveys.

Our G.S.O. services in the area of public information are in a large measure designed to back up the tremendous local work being done by more than 800 local public information committees and about 1,400 public information contacts, as all of us strive to communicate and reach out to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Richard Bush



SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Since the late 1930s, when our co-founder Bill W. had a small office in Newark, N.J., one of his concerns was "... if A.A. could ever communicate so it could transcend the barriers of the languages." With the passing of the years G.S.O. has been providing services in several languages. One of these has been Spanish, but it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated.

In our general service structure there are more than 27,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members who don't speak English. They meet in 775 Hispanic groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services coordinator, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other ten staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Hispanic community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish has a section entitled Spanish Services that gives information on general service activities. All Hispanic groups receive *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving; the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our publishing department. Spanish services helps answer the correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments and especially by the Overseas assignment.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature. In addition, the Spanish Services coordinator attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, and Regional Forums, the World Service Meeting and the International Convention. The Spanish Services coordinator greets Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Vicente Mejía

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services provided by G.S.O. to A.A. groups and members are divided at present into 11 staff assignments. In addition to assuming a functional responsibility such as Public Information, Regional Forums, or Literature, most staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, or with A.A.s in overseas countries where there is no national G.S.O. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. Staff assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator. Currently, the work is apportioned as follows:

Conference: Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; *Early Bird Box 4-5-9; Final Conference Report;* coordinator for 1995 International Convention in San Diego.

Cooperation With the Professional Community: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; *About A.A.;* *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant to C.P.C. page).

Correctional Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page).

Group Services Coordinator/Regional Forums: Supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. directories; secretary, trus-

tees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; coordinator, Self-support Committee; liaison with Intergroups/Central Offices.

Literature Coordinator: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, and audiovisual material; updating of recovery pamphlets and books; editor, *Box 4-5-9*.

Loners, Internationalists: *Loners-Internationalists Meeting;* secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees.

Overseas, World Service Meeting: Secretary, trustees' International Committee; coordinator of World Service Meeting; *World Service Meeting Report.*

Public Information: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for P.I. page).

Spanish Services: Consultant on any committee providing services to the Hispanic community; Spanish language correspondence; editor, *Spanish Box 4-5-9*.

Treatment Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page); editor, *Treatment Facilities Newsletter.*

The staff work is divided into three units so that G.S.O. mail is processed and responded to expeditiously. Unit A consists of P.I., C.P.C., C.F., and T.F. Unit B includes coordinators of staff, Conference, Literature and Group Services. Unit C includes Overseas, World Service Meeting, Loners/Internationalists and Spanish Services.

During 1990, the G.S.O. staff handled over 18,000 pieces of mail. The staff coordinator ensures that mail is answered during vacations, sickness, or a staff member's involvement with a special project. Training new staff members is another segment of the staff coordinator's service assignment. In 1990, two new staff members joined the General Service Office; however, one became ill and died very suddenly. When there is a staff opening, a letter is sent out to the trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information is also posted in *Box 4-5-9*. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Business experience, good communication skills, A.A. service experience and geographic considerations are some of the criteria used in the selection process.

Weekly staff meetings are scheduled to provide a forum for discussion of problems that require direction from the group conscience. From time to time, a service meeting is scheduled to give the staff an opportunity to become better informed about a particular assignment. The purpose of all staff meetings is to seek more and better ways of providing the most useful services to A.A. groups and members.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff vacations and scheduled trips in order to ensure that the office is covered at all times. She also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments as a member of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee.

In 1990, staff attended over 70 conventions, assemblies, round-ups and forums in the U.S. and Canada. This provides the staff with opportunities to become acquainted with A.A.s all over the U.S. and Canada, to communicate about G.S.O. services and, most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

During the past year, approximately 1,250 visitors from all over the world visited G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the various G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. These visits create

an opportunity to explain services to the Fellowship and learn about A.A. activities in each visitor's hometown or country. Often members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays, for A.A. visitors and staff.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, and preparing and distributing the minutes of the General Service Board meeting; she also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the newsletter account of the board's activities.

As secretary of the General Sharing Session during board weekends, trustees, members of all board committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. staff members are encouraged to discuss a wide range of topics at a two-hour General Sharing Session.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference and serves as secretary of the trustees' Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is a director and vice-president of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Helen Turnquest

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: In accordance with a recommendation from the 1990 General Service Conference, the committee has forwarded to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities a draft of a proposed pamphlet on bridging the gap from treatment to A.A. The material emphasizes temporary contact programs.

Following a suggestion from the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, the committee reviewed a service piece used in one area to assist A.A. members making presentations about A.A. and/or introducing A.A. films in treatment facilities. The committee agreed that such a service piece could be a valuable tool and suggested twelve points to be included.

The committee considered a request to prepare a directory of international contacts for treatment facilities committees to help "bridge the gap" for newcomers from other countries who have been treated in the U.S./Canada and are returning home. It was the consensus that this information would be extremely difficult to gather and keep current. It was suggested that the list of general service offices and central offices overseas be used.

A letter for the directors of treatment facilities was developed to provide information about our Fellowship's primary purpose, nonaffiliation, and anonymity. The letter was mailed in November 1990 to members of the National Association of Addiction Treatment Providers. In addition, the letter was mailed to area delegates, chairpersons of area treatment facilities committees and central/intergroup offices.

A suggestion to prepare a directory of treatment facilities committee chairpersons was considered and it was agreed that it would not be feasible at this time. (Lists of chairpersons of area treatment facilities committees are available upon request.)

The Treatment Facilities Workbook was reviewed by the committee, and it was recommended that an editor be hired to correlate the contents of the workbook with Conference-approved literature, streamline the book, and implement comments and suggestions from the trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities.

Noting a lack of A.A. material in most treatment facilities, the committee recommended a letter be sent to area delegates encouraging the use of the A.A. Grapevine as a tool for bridging the gap between treatment and A.A.

There have been two issues of the *Treatment Facilities Newsletter* since the last Conference. The committee held lengthy discussions regarding ways to obtain material and asks the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee to reflect seriously on developing means of getting information from areas if they wish the newsletter to continue.

John A. Sharkey, chairperson

Staff report: As the number of active committees carrying the message into treatment facilities increases, the staff tries to assist by providing information and serving as a resource. Each committee chairperson receives a complimentary Treatment Facilities Workbook, and all who are serving on treatment facilities committees receive *Box 4-5-9, Treatment Facilities Newsletter* and *About A.A.* The staff member also answers correspondence from people in treatment interested in receiving information about A.A. or in establishing contact with the Fellowship in their home communities. Administrators of treatment facilities as well as counselors frequently contact us for information about A.A., so this assignment provides many opportunities to explain what A.A. can and cannot do in fulfilling our primary purpose.

Our International Convention in Seattle last July provided wonderful opportunities to share information about carrying the message into treatment facilities. Two workshops were scheduled—"A.A. in Treatment Facilities" and "Bridging the Gap"—in addition to several meetings with invited non-A.A. speakers from the treatment field.

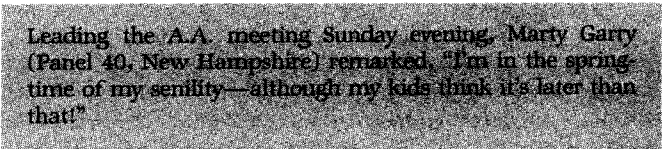
A major highlight since the 1990 General Service Conference has been completion and distribution of the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous," which is close-captioned for hearing-impaired viewers and also available in Spanish.

In order to have a current computer list of A.A.s serving on treatment facilities committees, a sweep was made of our mailing list in January. Old information was deleted and we are now able to provide chairpersons of treatment facilities committees with up-to-date listings.

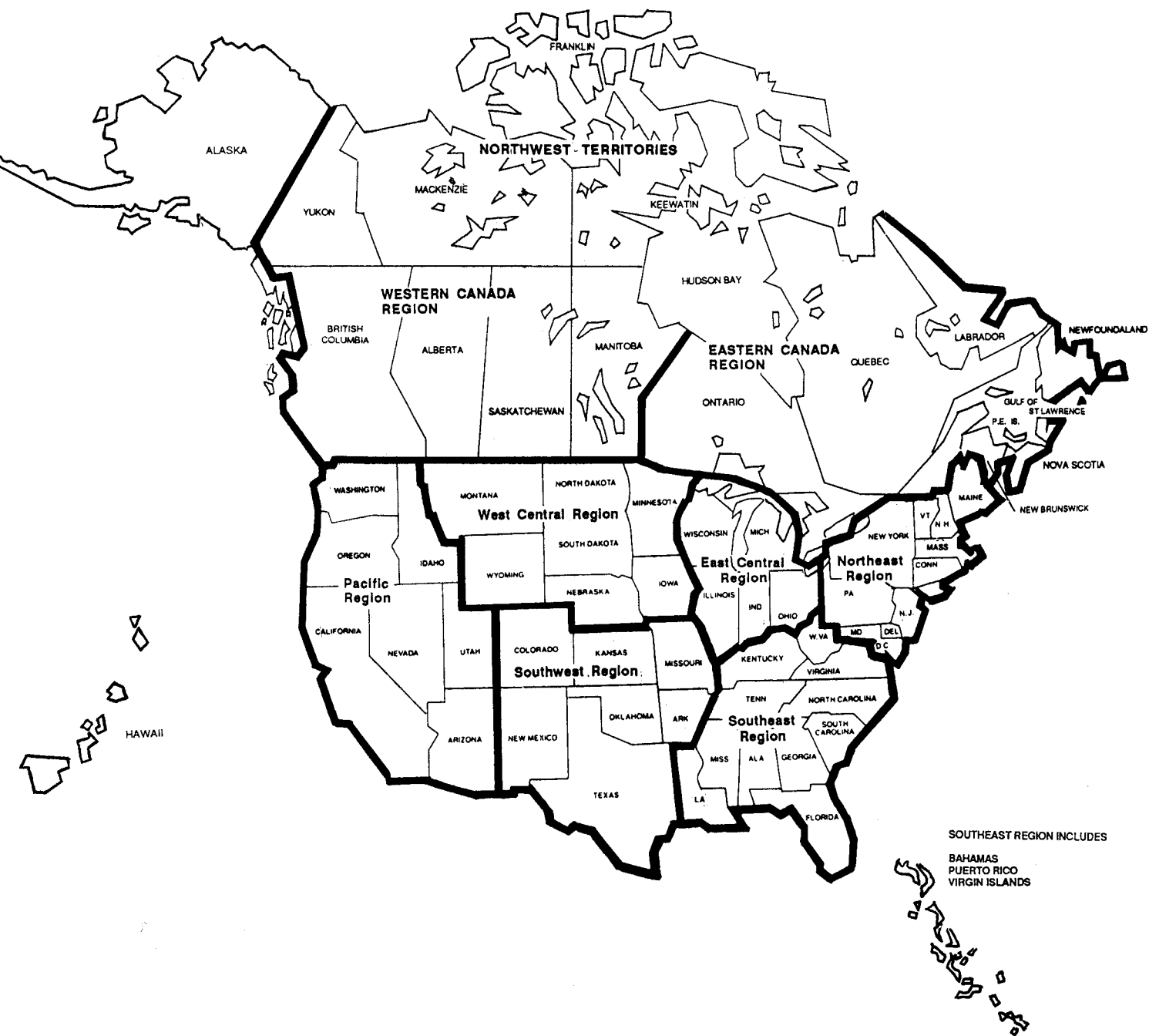
Obtaining material for the *Treatment Facilities Newsletter*, in addition to the Treatment Facilities section of *Box 4-5-9*, continues to be a challenge. Since the last General Service Conference there have been two issues of the newsletter—Summer 1990 and Spring 1991.

Serving as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Treatment Facilities Committees is an important part of this assignment. Responsibilities include helping maintain communication between the two committees, working with the chairpersons to set the agendas, preparing background information and material for agenda topics, and preparing reports and minutes of committee meetings. The goal of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to help A.A. members carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic in treatment. It is hoped that the activities described in this report helped fulfill that goal.

Lois Fisher



Leading the A.A. meeting Sunday evening, Marty Garry (Panel 40, New Hampshire) remarked, "I'm in the springtime of my senility—although my kids think it's later than that!"



REGIONAL MAP OF U. S. & CANADA

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: It is my pleasure to report that once again, the Grapevine has had a very good year. Year-end financial statements for 1990 showed a profit of \$193,900 compared to a budgeted \$19,850, and these results reflected a combination of higher-than-budgeted circulation and special items sales, holding the line on some key expenditures such as printing and postage, and keeping overall expenses down. The corporate board held four quarterly meetings and a special meeting to elect officers, and also met four times as the planning committee and once jointly with the directors of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Circulation: Magazine circulation for 1990 as a whole averaged 134,200 compared to a budgeted average of 133,000. That sounds good on the face of it, but when we look at month-to-month circulation, we see considerable swings. 1990 started out in the 133,000-plus range, and rose to an all-time high of 136,163 with the May issue—the issue before the price increase. Historically, there has usually been a downturn in circulation after a price increase, but for a few months, we thought it was leveling off rather than declining. As we move into 1991, however, the downswing seems to be continuing, and circulation for the March 1991 issue was 133,586, the lowest since early 1990.

Right now, to coin a phrase, circulation stands at the turning point. The 1990 budget anticipated an average circulation of 133,000, and since actual circulation averaged 134,200 and income included six months at the increased price, the financial picture continues to look rosy. The budgeted circulation for 1991 is 130,000, which is currently in jeopardy since the May issue fell to 128,600. At budget time, the board as a whole believed this to be a conservative, even pessimistic, estimate, and we have faith that the upswing, with your help, will come sooner rather than later. Given an uncertain economy and the lack of a crystal ball, it is impossible to say when. We know that support from the service structure is one of the key factors in keeping enthusiasm high and circulation healthy. Additionally, we have begun a program of early acknowledgment of all new subscriptions, “bridging the gap” between receipt of payment and mailing of the first issue with a brochure that welcomes readers and supplies basic information about the subscription.

Back Issues to Delegates: We happily report, also, that paid circulation is only part of the story. In response to a suggestion from the Conference Grapevine Committee last year, we have sent more than 37,000 back issues to the delegates for the use of area service committees. This has proved to be an exceptionally rewarding opportunity to get copies of the Grapevine out where they are needed the most, and we will continue to inform delegates whenever print overruns are large enough to allow us to supply more.

Magazine Content: Letters, phone calls, and informal communications from readers remain positive about magazine content. Two special issues were published in 1990: In July, A.A. members from all over the world shared their experience in a special international issue, distributed to all who attended the Seattle Convention, and in November the annual “classic” issue was expanded to give greater room for significant articles from past years.

At the suggestion of the trustees' Literature Committee, we began publishing Big Book stories from the first and second editions that were taken out of the third edition, and so far we have published five, with good response. Along the same lines, an oldtimers issue in September was well received, and more people ordered single copies of that issue than any other.

There was less enthusiasm for the section of articles by nonalcoholic friends of the Fellowship in the May 1990 issue. While many letters and calls praised the section, the consensus seems to be that any one issue of the magazine should consist primarily

of A.A. sharing, though occasional articles by nonalcoholics are welcome to enhance the Grapevine and broaden its perspective.

The A.A. history section has taken a slightly different turn from its original purpose, which was to highlight area and local histories and archival material. We thought for a while that the first (unpublished) draft of the A.A. history book would be a rich source of material, but that has proved less productive than we hoped, and virtually no material has come in from the areas themselves. Thus, the section has been expanded to include more Fellowship-wide features.

1990 may be remembered as the year Victor E. went on vacation, to the considerable dismay and freely expressed concern of many readers. We are happy to tell you that he has not yielded to the temptation of those barroom doors, and that one of the regular magazine illustrators has volunteered to keep our little friend active and moving into the '90s. You may see some minor changes, but we all change as our sobriety moves along, and our friend Victor will be celebrating his 29th anniversary of sobriety in July.

Special Items: Sales of special items in 1990 were down from 1989, principally because sales of *The Language of the Heart* have leveled off, though nearly all items were slightly lower. No new special items were produced last year to give a boost to revenues and sales. Two new tapes on the theme “Back to Basics” became available in March.

Grapevine Representatives: Since the revitalization of the GvR network in 1977, as a result of a Conference Advisory Action, the Grapevine has gradually evolved as an integral part of the service structure. Most areas have standing committees on the Grapevine, and a number of chairpersons are immediate past delegates, as suggested in several past Conference Actions. Other areas do it differently, but whatever the specific area needs and structure, Grapevine representatives are alive and well and active throughout the U.S. and Canada.

When you as delegates and trustees go back to your areas, you go with our thanks for your generous and unstinting support. As a board and as individuals, the Grapevine directors offer any help you need from the Grapevine to carry the A.A. message most effectively wherever you may be.

Stanley Silverman, chairperson

Staff report: Over the past year, both members of the Grapevine editorial staff have had the opportunity to share information about the Grapevine at Regional Forums, area assemblies, and area district Grapevine workshops. The chance to travel to other parts of the U.S. and Canada and listen to first-hand reactions to the magazine from a variety of readers adds a valuable dimension to both the magazine and the operation as a whole. We've had a couple of unusual opportunities, also: a staff member participated in the Italian national A.A. convention and also was the guest on a talk show on the Recovery Network in New Jersey.

It often seems that the things that “show”—magazine content and appearance, total circulation, financial results—are the most important aspects of an office operation. Yet the behind-the-scenes realities are what really make it possible to present a healthy, happy face to the world. In the twelve months since the 1990 Conference, there have been some real changes at the Grapevine office, all of them in the direction of improved service to A.A. members who read the magazine and use the special items.

Subscriptions: 1990 was the year the Grapevine circulation list was converted to a new and faster computer system. Since end-of-the-month processing with the AS 400 takes a few hours rather than a few days, it is now possible to enter new subscriptions

right up to the last day of the month rather than cutting off during the third week as we have done till now. Thus, many new subscribers receive their first issue sooner.

As a footnote to the above, we now have the capability of identifying and printing out labels for all new subscriptions entered each week, and acknowledging receipt of the order. Since August, each new subscriber has received a brochure that serves as a welcome letter and also provides basic information about the subscription (what the different parts of the label mean; how to handle various problems, etc.). And when a reader does have a problem, it can be resolved faster and more easily because of expanded and more flexible search capability and the ability to store more data about the subscriber.

Accounting: The Grapevine's accounting system has been manual until now, so it is a major step forward to have a computerized accounting and order entry/inventory operation. We went on-line with the last component of the system, order entry/inventory, in January 1991, and are reaping major benefits in terms of speed, accuracy, internal controls, and availability of management information. We have better control on inventory, cash receipts, shipping records. Problems can be researched on the screen, making it possible to answer telephone inquiries immediately and accurately. There is an expanded account structure, with more detailed breakdowns of where money is being spent, and thus far more useful information for planning.

A variety of reports are available to provide comprehensive management information. For example, a sales analysis will enable us to track (daily, weekly, monthly) the quantities of special items sold, along with cost, selling price, and gross profit percentage. We can also establish a minimum quantity for all items, and the system will generate a reorder report when the quantity is low—hopefully eliminating the need for back orders.

GvR Program: With the new system, the GvR coordinator will have two new features available: She will be able to find GvR records more easily (greater search capability), and will also be able to print mailing labels herself. The Grapevine relies on the G.S.O. data processing department for all labels, and now if DP personnel are backed up, we have the alternative of printing labels ourselves.

But hardware and software and better procedures are only part of the picture—there must be people pushing the right buttons, and the Grapevine has been well served by its 20 employees, both A.A. members and nonalcoholics. This year for the first time, we held an Employee Recognition Day honoring personnel with five, ten, and fifteen years of service.

So the machinery is in place, as well as the people to run it with competence, dedication and imagination. We have come through the first year of a new decade with flying colors, and look forward with confidence to whatever may come in the '90s.

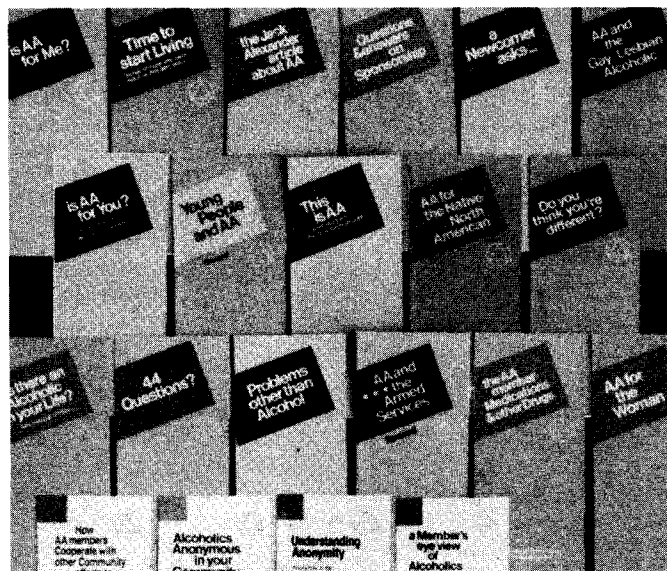
Ann Warner, executive editor

Early each morning chairman of the General Service Board Michael Alexander could be sighted slipping out of the hotel to walk his poodle, Phoebe. Mrs. Alexander was out of town and they couldn't find a dog-sitter—so Phoebe accompanied Mike to Rye.

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION – GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1991	APRIL 1990	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,410	1,527	- 117
Alaska	493	552	- 59
Arizona	1,557	1,639	- 82
Arkansas	784	825	- 41
California	13,819	14,035	- 216
Colorado	1,653	1,663	- 10
Connecticut	2,278	2,366	- 88
Delaware	403	369	34
District of Columbia	298	299	- 1
Florida	5,788	6,179	- 391
Georgia	2,830	2,927	- 97
Hawaii	441	463	- 22
Idaho	649	699	- 50
Illinois	5,808	5,889	- 81
Indiana	1,684	1,801	- 117
Iowa	1,675	1,715	- 40
Kansas	1,685	1,791	- 106
Kentucky	978	1,003	- 25
Louisiana	1,159	1,252	- 93
Maine	830	860	- 30
Maryland	2,099	2,164	- 65
Massachusetts	5,378	5,931	- 553
Michigan	3,483	3,614	- 131
Minnesota	3,492	3,789	- 297
Mississippi	704	788	- 84
Missouri	2,383	2,363	20
Montana	784	850	- 66
Nebraska	1,610	1,684	- 74
Nevada	608	670	- 62
New Hampshire	729	799	- 70
New Jersey	3,852	4,255	- 403
New Mexico	684	694	- 10
New York	8,955	9,221	- 266
North Carolina	3,315	3,406	- 91
North Dakota	586	616	- 30
Ohio	3,966	4,008	- 42
Oklahoma	1,552	1,666	- 114
Oregon	1,264	1,274	- 10
Pennsylvania	4,825	4,898	- 73
Rhode Island	633	667	- 34
South Carolina	1,613	1,646	- 33
South Dakota	548	615	- 67
Tennessee	1,484	1,689	- 205
Texas	5,664	5,617	47
Utah	539	486	53
Vermont	497	535	- 38
Virginia	2,840	2,977	- 137
Washington	3,463	3,389	74
West Virginia	550	567	- 17
Wisconsin	2,773	2,943	- 170
Wyoming	376	424	- 48
Puerto Rico	107	112	- 5
U.S. Possessions	—	—	—
Total	117,585	122,211	- 4,626
CANADA			
Alberta	1,315	1,271	44
British Columbia/Yukon	1,665	1,629	36
Manitoba	624	627	- 3
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	549	491	58
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	825	874	- 49
Ontario	5,373	5,412	- 39
Quebec	445	424	21
Saskatchewan	758	841	- 83
Total	11,554	11,569	- 15
FOREIGN			
	1,598	1,378	220
Grand Total	130,737	135,158	- 4,421

Literature Distributed – 1990



ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	691,583
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft-cover)	432,288
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	9,007
Daily Reflections (new)	194,309
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	449,485
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	83,728
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft-cover)	132,942
A.A. Comes of Age	25,058
As Bill Sees It	112,592
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	25,582
"Pass It On"	28,435
Total	2,185,009

Booklets

Living Sober	259,750
Came to Believe	124,611
Total	384,361

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Programs	68,500
A.A. and the Armed Services	22,800
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	48,000
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	34,400
A.A. for the Native North American	34,000
A.A. for the Woman	209,800
The A.A. Group	177,400
A.A. in Your Community	126,900
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	54,600
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	67,400
The A.A. Membership Survey	114,300
The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs	196,700
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	29,000
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	70,500
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	24,100
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	302,400
The Clergy Ask About A.A.	52,100
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	43,400
Do You Think You're Different?	239,800
44 Questions	422,100
G.S.R.	62,800
How A.A. Members Cooperate	39,300
How It Works	133,600

If You Are a Professional	69,700
Inside A.A.	82,900
Is A.A. For You?	508,300
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	187,700
It Happened to Alice	91,800
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	84,700
The Jack Alexander Article	66,900
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	21,600
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	134,000
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	127,100
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	78,400
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	22,400
A Newcomer Asks	442,000
Problems Other Than Alcohol	178,000
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	364,900
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	38,600
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	30,700
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	75,100
The Twelve Traditions of A.A.	14,900
This Is A.A.	489,800
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	38,200
Time to Start Living	122,500
Time to Start Living (large print)	15,400
Too Young?	188,120
Understanding Anonymity	126,400
What Happened to Joe	101,200
Young People and A.A.	235,000
Total	6,510,220

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards – two-fold	1,059,000
Wallet cards – I Am Responsible	139,300
Wallet cards – Anonymity	76,900
Parchment – scrolls	12,700
Placards	2,193
C.P.C. Workbook	1,000
Correctional Facilities Workbook	700
P.I. Workbook	1,500
Treatment Facilities Workbook	900
A.A. Guidelines	130,200
Group Handbook	6,200
Wire Racks	3,700
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	4,000
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	5,600
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	3,000
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	300
TV Spots (video cassette)	4,300
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	380
Twelve Steps Shade displays	3,500
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	3,000
Fact Files	3,700
Total	1,462,073
Grand total	10,541,663

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	27,200
Como Lo Ve Bill	6,000
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad	3,300
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos	2,500
Total	39,000

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio	10,100
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial	2,300
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones	18,300
Llegamos a Creer	6,100
Total	36,800

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	6,500
44 Preguntas	30,500
Esto es A.A.	41,600
¿Es A.A. para Usted?	62,600
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	9,300
¿Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida?	5,900
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	7,400
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	4,100
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	3,600
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	4,100
A.A. y el Empleo Alcohólico	1,000
Un Principiante Pregunta	11,800
Como Trabaja el Programa	16,200
Lo que le Sucedió a José	13,600
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	3,400
El Grupo de A.A.	13,600
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento	8,100
El Miembro de A.A. – Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas	11,400
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	7,900
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento	2,200
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	16,500
La Tradición de A.A. – Cómo se Desarrolló	3,800
Una Breve Guía a A.A.	11,500
A.A. en Prisiones	5,500
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	7,200
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda	3,200
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	3,500
Dentro de A.A.	3,800
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	2,100
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	2,400
R.S.G.	4,000
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente?	11,000
A.A. Para la Mujer	7,100
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A.	1,100
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales	1,700
Total	348,200

Miscellaneous

Guías	8,900
Parchments, Spanish	446
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera	28,200
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album)	790
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album)	850
Total	39,186
Grand total	463,186

FRENCH

Books

Gros Livre (First edition)	5,120
Gros Livre (2nd edition, pocket size)	5,762
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	6,679
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte	925
Réflexions de Bill	4,121
Réflexions Quotidiennes	9,665
Total	32,272

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus à croire	2,586
Vivre . . . sans alcool!	3,465
Total	6,051

Pamphlets

Voici les A.A.	16,254
Les A.A.: 44 Questions	4,974
Les A.A. sont-ils pour vous?	37,644

Les A.A. pour la femme	2,063
Coopération des membres A.A.	708
Les A.A. et les Programmes d'aide aux Employés	2,231
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et à la drogue	1,954
Les A.A. – Article du <i>Saturday Evening Post</i>	428
Collaborons avec nos amis	464
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage	4,813
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	1,675
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	839
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement	1,387
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?	661
Alice l'a trouvé	897
Jean face à son problème d'alcool	968
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	2,357
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	2,408
Point de vue d'un membre sur A.A.	975
Les Douze Traditions illustrées	1,385
Notre méthode	22,798
Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels	845
Ça vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	886
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.	9,293
Un ecclésiastique s'interroge	721
Biographie des cofondateurs	512
Message à l'intention des détenus	1,393
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels	548
Le groupe des A.A.	2,835
Le Manuel de services/Les Douze Concepts	1,445
Les Douze Concepts illustrés	591
Le sens de l'anonymat	1,983
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales	1,678
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	1,761
Si vous exercez des activités professionnelles	715
Le R.S.G.	1,444
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	1,681
Trop jeune?	2,470
La Structure de l'Association des A.A.	1,666
L'héritage des Services des A.A.	677
Cercles d'amour et de service	1,259
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,701
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	1,562
Sondage sur les membres des A.A.	2,521
Les Jeunes et les A.A.	3,462
Votre B.S.G.	973
Il est encore temps de vivre	2,245
Un nouveau veut savoir	12,236
Total	166,986

Guidelines

Miscellaneous

Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions	2,912
Carte des Etapes et Traditions	490
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais)	367
Cassettes	47
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A.	500
Enveloppe Assort. Nouveau Membre	3,553
Feuilles de Service	90,307
Les Alcooliques Anonymes	621
Les Meilleurs Articles de Bill	8,375
Manuel de Groupe	93
Manuel de l'Information Publique	37
Manuel des Etablissements Penitentiaires	6
Messages d'Interet Publique (Radio PSAs)	4
Prière Sérénité (Carte)	45,135
Prière Sérénité (5 × 7)	1,432
Prière Sérénité (12 × 16)	513
Prière Sérénité (23 × 34)	224
Slogans (série de 5)	299
Suggestions Réunions Débutants	380

Total	155,295
Grand total	363,110

Reports on Area Service Highlights



Alabama/N.W. Florida: We have 20 districts with active service committees. We have quarterly workshops on the home group, sponsorship, the Traditions and our Legacy of Service. One district has a Fourth-and-Fifth-Step quarterly meeting. Most districts emphasize group structure and self-support. We have G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s who accept their responsibilities for directing the goals of our area assemblies. We have a G.S.R. workshop whose chairmanship rotates among districts. We also have a D.C.M. meeting with the delegate and the alternate. Our liaison committee for intergroup/central office has lessened confusions. Most of the growth of our area committees may be attributed to active service committees. Voting members of our assembly are G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area officers, committee chairmen and all past delegates.—*Bill McCaa*

Arkansas: Attendance at our two-day quarterly assemblies has been increasing steadily. Our permanent committees are active and have representation from each district. The area archives committee sponsored a two-day celebration of "50 Years of A.A. in Arkansas" in March 1990. A presentation of "A.A. history" was given by Nell Wing and Frank M. The histories of our area and district were also presented. The correctional facilities committee reports that two years ago there were only three regularly scheduled county jail meetings in our area; there are approximately 27 today. Our first corrections conference has revised our area structure and guidelines. The final form of the modified structure has been sent to all active groups for a group consensus. Our P.I. and C.P.C. committees have been active in schools, bridging-the-gap programs, state and local hospitals, health fairs, and workshops for the clergy and have placed media spots.—*David Jimerson*

British Columbia/Yukon: Our area is the second largest geographical area in North America. We have 712 groups and 46

districts. Area committee members go anywhere we are asked for service functions when we are financially able. We are publishing an area history of A.A. in the Yukon. Our area newsletter, "Grassroots," is a first-class publication. We would like to explore the possibility of a Regional Forum to be held in Whitehorse, Y.T., depending upon the relative cost effectiveness of the Forum at Yellowknife last year. The area funds half the cost of isolated D.C.M. travel for the annual area assembly and a Regional Forum might increase awareness of G.S.O. and the area. We hold three mini-assemblies and two or three mini pre-Conference assemblies to help the delegate get a better feel of the area group conscience. This year we hosted the Western Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly. We will also continue to participate in PRAASA, if service-related. Singleness of purpose seems to be the major problem, which we think ties in well with the theme of this Conference.—*Doug Bailey*

California (Northern Coastal): Our area has more than 2,000 registered groups and 20 districts. Each district has a D.C.M. chairperson and as many D.C.M.s and subdistricts as necessary. Two districts serve Spanish-language groups. Districts hold monthly business meetings and most hold one or more service workshops per year. The delegate, alternate delegate, chairperson, treasurer, registrar, recording secretary, assembly coordinator and literature/Grapevine chair were elected at our November assembly. The officers attend monthly district meetings and service activities when the delegate is unable. D.C.M.s and D.C.M.C.s and area officers meet monthly in a central location. We hold four area assemblies each year in different districts. Area subcommittees are P.I./C.P.C.; contact service, a new committee for introducing A.A.s released from confinement to local A.A. meetings; archives and newsletter. We have long been self-supporting, so much so that it has been suggested that we abolish registration donations at area assemblies.—*Barbara Madger*

California (Southern): Our area has more than 2,000 groups divided into 52 districts. Four are Spanish-speaking. The assembly meets bimonthly and eight area standing committees are active and generally meet monthly. The districts hold monthly or bimonthly meetings and many sponsor service seminars. We have purchased translation equipment and now bilingual A.A.s translate events into Spanish. We are working with the San Diego/Imperial and Mid-Southern California areas to produce six television P.S.A.s aimed at the elderly and at young teens. We have 14 central offices and now our area committees and the local intergroup committees cooperate on P.I. and C.P.C. projects. We invited each central office/intergroup to send a representative to the assembly as a voting member. Our two largest events each year are a picnic/barbecue and an Old Timers Day. Our only problem is that they are too successful.—*Jacqueline Johnston*

Colorado: Our area has approximately 670 groups and 28 districts, out of which one is Spanish-speaking and encompasses the whole area. We hold four assemblies each year and in September we hold our convention in either Denver or Colorado Springs. The districts bid for the other assemblies. Our area has seven standing committees and we have various workshops during the year. Our corrections facilities committee collected more than \$19,000 for literature and as a result, we placed more than 15,000 pieces of literature in 43 correctional facilities. We hold more than 140 meetings each week in county, state, juvenile and federal facilities. The 4th Annual Colorado Corrections Facilities Conference was held in Canon City in April 1991, the same year in which A.A. will be 50 years old in Colorado for which our archives committee interviewed more than 300 oldtimers and compiled 25 linear feet of documents and memorabilia. The first group in this state met in Denver for the first time on August 19, 1941 and it is still called Group No. 1.—*Bob Greenfield*

Connecticut: The growth of meetings has risen to over 1,200 per week. We are printing 120,000 copies of our meeting schedules, at a cost of \$22,000, which are given to members at no cost. Our budget for 1991 is \$92,500. In 1991 Area 11 will have two conventions: one will be held in a hotel; the second, called "Connecticut Get-together," will be held at a resort. Working closely with our Spanish district, we have purchased translating equipment to be used at area assemblies, at a cost of approximately \$2,500. Our special service committees, such as C.P.C., P.I. and Grapevine, continue to grow and carry the message of hope to the suffering alcoholics.—*Hugh Cochrane*

District of Columbia: Our area encompasses 32 districts, 400 groups and 1,700 meetings in metro Washington. Our enthusiastic Hispanic district serves groups in D.C., northern Virginia and Maryland. Monthly area committee meetings and three yearly assemblies are nerve centers for service projects of our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. In addition to presenting the A.A. professional exhibit at local conventions and co-sponsoring almost 300 monthly institutions meetings, we sponsor an annual mini-conference prior to the General Service Conference, an annual gratitude breakfast, quarterly group-officer workshops and an annual convention. We produce a G.S.R. orientation kit that provides easy access to portions of *The A.A. Service Manual*. The outstanding spirit of cooperation between our intergroup and the assembly has resulted in the inclusion of a monthly two-page feature entitled "News and Views from G.S.A." in the local newsletter.—*R.L. (Dick) Patch*

Florida (North): At the 1987 Conference, our Panel 37 delegate from North Florida, Dick Pickens, mentioned that our area had

23 districts. We now have 31. At that time we had 359 groups; we now have 558. He also spoke of our position and actions reflected in the Seventh Tradition. With the explosive growth in Area 14 (thank the Higher Power), there are many cities and districts that can no longer host an event the size of our area assembly. We are in the process of trying to find a fixed location that will be affordable and will help us to take care of assembly business better. Dick also mentioned that the then chairman of the North Florida Area Assembly took time between assemblies to have a heart transplant. As events turned out, the recipient of that heart transplant is the new delegate from North Florida to Panel 41.—*Tom Duffy*

Florida (South)/Bahamas/V.I.: We now have more than 1,300 groups and 14 districts. Our quarterly conferences and assemblies have more than 500 attendees. All standing committees hold Saturday workshops with topics such as the Traditions and *The A.A. Service Manual*. The intergroup/central office committee meets to discuss topics such as state sales tax, insurance costs, administrative costs and literature pricing. A new convention steering committee formed with north Florida ensures that the state convention will operate within the Traditions. The sponsorship theme is becoming more evident in weekend meetings on the east and west coast of Florida. Two areas of Florida have submitted proposals to host the 2000 International Convention. All officers attend Regional Forums. North and south Florida will co-host the Southeast Regional Conference in Orlando in 1993. Our treatment facilities and correctional facilities committees have kept up with increased demands from a larger number of treatment centers and overcrowded correctional facilities.—*Richard LaGasse, Sr.*

Hawaii: Our area now has 14 districts; seven on O'ahu, three on the "Big Island" of Hawaii, three on Maui and one on Kauai. These districts include approximately 250 groups that hold from 350 to 400 meetings. We expect more districts to be added. A.A. has grown on the smaller islands of Moloka'i and Lana'i. Wide support has been shown for a meeting in the isolated leprosarium of Kalaupapa. Greater self-support for the inter-island travel of trusted servants at the area, district and group levels makes service work an area-wide opportunity. Our assembly and committee meetings are less frequent but last longer and have fuller agendas. Our area service committees include corrections, treatment facilities, archives, C.P.C., P.I., hospitals, Grapevine and a committee for our newsletter, "The Mynah Bird." Our goal is for each district to be represented on each area service committee. We have five intergroups that vote in our area meetings and we enjoy friendly relations with them.—*David V. Every*

Illinois (Chicago): Our area has 23 districts, 3,800 groups and more than 75,000 members. Our Chicago Area Service Committee, the equivalent of an area assembly, meets once a month. Standing committees include P.I., C.P.C. and hospital treatment facilities, which filled 43 requests last year. The correctional facilities committee carried the message to eight facilities. Our Grapevine committee had large displays at the All Chicago open meeting and at the Illinois State Conference. Attendance at our annual All Chicago open meeting now exceeds 12,000 people. In 1990 we celebrated 51 years of miracles in this area. More than 2,000 members attended the Illinois State Conference in Chicago last year. The ad hoc committee for the hearing impaired has initiated four meetings in our area and we ask groups, through a separate collection, to assist in funding interpreters at five meetings in the downtown area. Last year we handed 11,000 Twelfth Step calls.—*Frank Berls*

Illinois (Southern): Our area has 22 districts and 411 groups that serve about 7,500 members. We cover roughly the southern two-thirds of the state. We are exploring ways to encourage group participation through the L.C.M. method or by adding more districts. For the first time our area has become fully self-supporting through group contributions. Our spring conference was held separately from the quarterly assembly for the first time in 1990 and it was a huge success. We will host the 18th Annual Illinois State Conference and the 14th Annual East Central Conference in Decatur, Illinois, August 2-4, 1991. We have added an archives committee to bring the number of standing committees in the area to six. Our quarterly assembly is hosted by different districts on a bid basis so that travel time is divided among us and folks have an opportunity to see service at work.—*Elmer Chaney*

Indiana (Northern): Our area is three years young and growing. We have 18 districts and 650 groups and we are now redistricting the area. We have four assemblies each year and one combined meeting of Areas 22 and 23 so that the whole state can communicate. This meeting also serves as our convention and both areas share responsibility for it. Our P.I. committee is working on media spots. Districts are holding workshops and the area committee is beginning to get its feet on the ground. Challenges include "treatment talk" at meetings and helping newcomers. Attendance at our area meetings is gradually increasing. Our correctional facilities committee is doing a great job of carrying the message behind the walls. Our young A.A.s are busy. Our challenge is to communicate our policies and the Seventh Tradition better.—*Klaus Kroeber*

Iowa: Our area worked hard during the past two years to increase participation of G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Two years ago we strived to keep the state directories current. D.C.M.s were encouraged to visit groups and update G.S.R. lists. Three D.C.M.s were replaced and D.C.M.s were called if they were not in attendance at area meetings. Twice during the last year we had 100-percent attendance by D.C.M.s or alternates at area meetings. G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and state service chairs are invited to participate in cluster meetings wherein two or more districts hold service workshops. In January 1990 we held a service weekend where the area committee meeting expanded to two days and more than 100 G.S.R.s, 18 of 19 D.C.M.s and all state officers attended. Topics included the Traditions, the Concepts, sponsorship and more. The second service weekend was attended by more than 145 G.S.R.s. Our area newsletter is mailed to all groups listed in our state directory.—*Rod Brown*

Louisiana: We have 522 groups, 23 districts, 34 district committeemen and a membership of nearly 10,000. During the past two years we have formed the following committees: C.P.C., newsletter, P.I. and budget and finance, and we have also reactivated our Grapevine committee. The chairmen of all our committees are voting members of the Louisiana Area Assembly, which funds the committees. In August 1990 we moved our area assembly from Baton Rouge to Lafayette. Quarterly area committee meetings are conducted with area assemblies, during which we hold a service workshop. We strongly encourage our groups to participate in the self-support system. In 1990 the Louisiana Area Assembly contributed \$1,303 to the General Service Office, ten percent of our bank balance plus ten percent of our prudent reserve as of the end of third quarter 1990.—*Sidney Mayeux*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Our area comprises over 2,200 groups and/or meetings that are served by our area committee and 26 districts, as well as an Hispanic district. G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s

attend six rotating, one-day area assemblies each year. The area is now served by an area group registrar and by a literature committee, and publishes a newsletter, "The Messenger." Archives held its first birthday; P.I. sent information on anonymity to all groups; treatment facilities held a seminar for local treatment facilities and established the 'Bridge the Gap' program. Progress continues in working with the hearing impaired and Spanish groups. In continuing cooperation, area officers met for the first time with the steering committees and staff of four central offices/intergroups. The challenge for Area 30 is to inform groups of the service needs of the Fellowship and to increase the participation and support of groups for the Twelve Step work and services of all service entities. The area also has a growing concern about our primary purpose and our Second Legacy, A.A. unity.—*Ron Gauthier*

Michigan (Central): Our area committee meets each month in locations that rotate among all districts. The assembly officers, chairperson, secretary and treasurer rotate each year. Many have become delegates and trustees. Area committees meet monthly. The central Michigan assembly is incorporated due to the large amount of literature sold and to protect our trusted servants. The area committee plans to hold a workshop for all D.C.M.s and all G.S.R.s interested in becoming D.C.M.s. The area has sponsored three G.S.R. workshops conducted by past or present delegates and trustees who use *The A.A. Service Manual* as a textbook. An area handbook is given to new G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. The assembly contributes to the cost of sending service members to the East Central Regional Forum. The area is sending 20 people to the Regional Forum in Columbus, Ohio, in October 1991. Our alternate delegate holds a vital position due to our busy service schedule.—*Harland Sercombe*

Michigan (Southeast): Among our challenges is carrying the message to groups by letting them know the Who, What, Where and When of the A.A. service structure. Most of our groups are unaware of its function. We hope to work with past and alternate delegates as well as with chairpersons and committee members, to activate and support our 24 districts. We plan to obtain a permanent meeting place so that G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and future service workers will locate service meetings easily. We are also challenged in increasingly active participation in both assembly and committee meetings. We may schedule both meetings on the same day and combine these meetings with workshops. This might help answer complaints such as "too far to travel on week nights," and "meetings starting too late and lasting too long." One meeting is easier to plan for than two.—*Kenneth Kendrick*

Minnesota (Southern): We have redistricted our 911 groups and their 21,837 members so that two districts have been formed in our most densely populated county and other changes have been made. To keep track of the changes, we have a group records secretary. We have asked our alternates to serve as chairpersons of committees that require special A.A. understanding. The alternate delegate also serves as the structure chairperson and the alternate area chairperson does double duty as the finance committee chairperson. Our annual area service conference is now tied to the General Service Conference theme. Because the Conference encourages more message-carrying activities to minorities, including inmates, we held a corrections committee seminar in which a trustee participated. We were not surprised to hear the Minnesota commissioner of corrections note that with all the substances available today, alcoholism is still the greatest problem among the inmate population.—*Dennis Bauer*

Missouri (Eastern): Our area is made up of 20 districts with approximately 500 meetings. The area continues its steady growth trend. Assembly attendance averages between 125 and 200 people. A trend of further cooperation between in-state and out-of-state districts is well under way. We are in our first year of operation of the eastern area office. We held a two-day assembly in 1990 and we will hold another in 1991. The eastern area of Missouri has submitted an application to host the 2000 International Convention. Surrounding states have been advised of this action. Our special needs committee has expanded services at the meeting and convention level. We continue to participate in the Missouri State Convention, which is a joint effort with the western area of the state.—*Dick Carden*

Missouri (Western): Our area consists of 17 districts (of which one is unused) with about 200 groups and 5,000 members. Ten districts meet monthly and the remainder meet bimonthly or quarterly. We hold two-day area assemblies each quarter at which an average of 200 members attend. All meetings there are closed except for the Saturday night open meeting. We co-host our state convention with the eastern area of Missouri. Our archives, C.P.C., correctional facilities, Grapevine, literature, P.I., treatment facilities and convention committees are alive and well. Corrections and treatment committees hold an Institutions Weekend each year and this allows each committee to be fully self-supporting. The Grapevine committee has also become self-supporting. The literature committee is setting up its own guidelines. We have lost three past delegates—Ken Sperry, Panel 13; Gus Wright, Panel 21; and Marilyn “Sam” Parsons, Panel 37—whose knowledge will be greatly missed.—*Connie Wesley*

Nevada: Area 42 includes all of Nevada plus portions of California that total nearly 125,000 square miles. Our area has 4,181 members, 351 groups and 20 districts. Distance has limited area travel and necessitated formation of northern and southern general service committees, so that area officers and their alternates are elected every two years for terms that rotate between the two localities. Our area assembly is held in September at Tonopah, where we also recently initiated a spring meeting of the area committee. The northern area general service committee has developed a strong workshop and training program for service workers. In 1991 we also started an area newsletter. Guidelines for the area have been written by the northern and southern committees. Increased emphasis is being placed upon the role and importance of the G.S.R., member understanding of the Twelve Traditions, improved cooperation with intergroups, and more direct communication between the groups and the delegate prior to the General Service Conference.—*Julian Rhinehart*

New Jersey (Northern): Our area consists of 30 districts serving 1,000 groups. We hold three assemblies, six to ten area committee meetings, a mini-conference, a convention and a luncheon each year. The D.C.M.s, committee chairpersons and area officers attend a “work weekend” each December. Several districts host sharing days, service workshops, picnics and dances. We cooperate with the intergroup in our area and our P.I. and treatment and correctional facilities committees have combined with their public relations and hospitals and institutions entities. We have also formed a joint archives committee and have established a literature committee. C.P.C., treatment facilities, correctional facilities and Grapevine are active committees. We publish a quarterly newsletter and hold G.S.R. and D.C.M. workshops. Concerns include nonalcoholics attending closed meetings, groups selling non-A.A. literature, referrals of nonalcoholics to A.A. by agencies and a lack of knowledge among our groups

regarding contributions to A.A. service entities.

—*June Alfred Smith*

New York (Central): We are approaching 700 registered groups served by six districts. We have monthly committee meetings and assemblies in different locations. Many G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s became interested in service when their sponsors or G.S.R.s suggested they attend an area assembly. The monthly assemblies and preassembly workshops include discussions on the Conference theme, the Traditions and the Concepts as well as other matters. Our treatment facilities committee recently revised our bridging-the-gap contact list. Our corrections facilities, C.P.C. and P.I. committees are cooperating with the New York State Corrections Department. We will revise our “History of A.A. in Central New York” booklet. Our literature and Grapevine committees make sure the area is up-to-date on literature and that Grapevines are available. An ad-hoc committee is exploring the possibility of an area service manual. We completed a two-year review of our finances and financial policies. We are evaluating our district structure for potential adjustment.—*George Croop*

New York (Southeast): Our area is growing rapidly and has a large A.A. population. It became necessary for us to obtain an office that had a computer and space for subcommittee meetings. Due to this effort and to rotation of assemblies around our area, we have had active participation from all 13 counties. We have five assemblies and ten committee meetings each year and hope to hold our first weekend assembly in the next two years. We have a subcommittee to make sure that we address the special needs of A.A. members in our area and to ensure the right of participation in all area functions. Considering the controversial areas under discussion by the groups, service growth is necessary. We realize the importance of active subcommittees for P.I., C.P.C., treatment and correctional facilities. We bid for the 1992 Northeast Regional Convention and the 1993 Northeast Regional Forum. We hope to host these events so that our A.A. members grow in all three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service.

—*Jimmy Downes*

North Carolina: Our area now has 744 groups with a growth of more than 15 percent over the last two years. This growth was met by a redistricting of three districts and a net increase of five districts so that we now have 31 districts. One district has successfully met the growth by using local committee members. Bermuda withdrew from our area last year and although we regret seeing them go we send them our love and best wishes. We have added a budget and finance committee, a site investigation committee, a liaison to the North Carolina correctional facilities committee and an archivist to our existing roster of committees that includes C.P.C., P.I., Grapevine and literature. We have added the new office of area alternate chairperson and expanded the office of secretary/treasurer to the three offices of recording secretary, corresponding secretary and treasurer. All area officers are elected by third-legacy procedure.—*James E. Key*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Our area comprises 16 districts, 264 registered groups and approximately 3,000 members. The area spans two provinces. Six districts and 98 groups are in Newfoundland/Labrador, which means we have high travel expenses. The location of our annual October assembly rotates among our four major cities. In early May we hold two service weekends; one in Nova Scotia and another in Newfoundland. At these times we address provincial agendas and decide which items will be discussed at the assembly. D.C.M.s report on the districts and the delegate reports on the Conference.

Monthly service meetings at the district level allow all groups to contribute to the workings of the district and the area. Most districts have service committees active in P.I. but fewer are active in C.P.C. and in treatment and correctional facilities. Each province maintains archives and two districts offer intergroup service. During our monthly service meetings we hold workshops on the Traditions to keep us aware of anonymity, self-support and other important topics.—*Mike Bruce*

Ohio (Central and Southeast): Our area has 41 districts that serve approximately 700 groups. We hold quarterly assemblies in March, June, September and December. Area planning committees and D.C.M. meetings are held in January, April, July and October. We have seven central offices serving the groups. The correctional facilities and C.P.C. committees host their own A.A. Information Day each year for the personnel of all Ohio correctional facilities. Our C.P.C. committee made 90 presentations to about 2,000 professionals in 1990. The Grapevine committee sold approximately \$1,725 worth of Grapevine items plus 25 annual subscriptions to the magazine. We have reactivated the archives committee and it is now busy collecting area historical items and building display cases. We average two to three workshops per month throughout the area and have instituted a G.S.R. school that may be taken to the districts upon request. Our area also hosts an annual service convention in September. On October 11-13, 1991, our area will host the East Central Regional Forum.—*Glenn E. Wyckoff*

Ohio (Northeast): Our area consists of 20 state counties in which there are 49 A.A. districts. Our monthly mailings now go to 1,200. Five of the six persons elected at our October elections understand computers so we will be prepared when G.S.O. becomes fully electronic. Our area has included a "shut-in chairperson" on existing committees in hopes of staying in contact with members who are unable to get to regular meetings. The mini-conference we conduct in late winter helps the delegate as well as our active service-minded people. We have seven central or intergroup offices within our area, so it makes for quite a challenge to see if all groups or meetings are in the area printout. We cross-check this printout with seven office directories to help ensure accuracy. Another challenge is redistricting because some districts have grown to more than 40 groups. A chairperson now gives guidance to the D.C.M.s on how to split a district and how to get the paperwork right. We've got a lot to do but we're fresh and eager.—*Norbert S. Haase*

Oklahoma: Our eight districts each have six D.C.M.s and our 350 groups have approximately 5,500 members. In the first six months of 1990 the percentage of contributing groups rose from 60.8 percent to 66.8 percent. Each district has its own service committees and most hold monthly meetings. We are working on holding meetings for the hearing-impaired. Our state committee sponsors four service workshops annually. We look forward to the 50th Annual State Conference in May in Oklahoma City. The theme will be "A Half Century of Miracles." A.A. is going into every prison, correctional center and state hospital in Oklahoma. The challenge of singleness of purpose is being met with some success through the reading of the "blue card." Our birthday plan is keeping contributions healthy. Our 1991 agenda includes the first Oklahoma Indian Conference in Tulsa, the Tenth Annual Young People in A.A. Roundup, and the Southwest Regional Forum in Tulsa, where our goal is "1,001 in '91."—*Ottis L. Dimick*

Ontario (Eastern): In 1989 our area spent \$4,500 more than we took in through contributions. With moderate effort and great



cooperation we were able to overcome this in 1990. We have a Provincial Court Program that has been very effective in some districts for over 14 years now. This is where A.A. members cooperate with the courts on a regular basis to help anyone wanting or needing help with drinking related problems. Our Ontario Provincial Committee, representing our four areas in Ontario, has closed its office and we have replaced it with the O.D.C., Ontario Delegates Committee, that is presently meeting once yearly. In the summer of 1993 we are planning a Canadian Convention celebrating 50 years of A.A. in Canada. Last, but not least, we are hoping for a successful bid for the year 2000 International Convention, hopefully to be held in Toronto.

—*Bernie Sullivan*

Ontario (Northeast): Our area has approximately 2,223 members, eight D.C.M.s and about 186 active groups. The area is showing a strong interest in service and we have a strong area assembly structure. For the first time in many years our area has adopted operating procedures from Eastern Ontario. They were accepted after two years of workshops at the district level. We also have an agenda committee. At our next area convention we will hold the first "past delegates breakfast meeting." Our area has two-day assemblies twice each year. Our past delegate is now an ex-officio member of our assembly. We have one intergroup and all districts have an answering service. All our special service coordinators are active at the area level and in the districts.—*Scott McLarty*

Ontario (Northwest): Since March 1990 our area has become fully self-supporting. Being the smallest area in numbers, this has been quite a feat. One of our districts is polling the membership in order to split into two districts, to eliminate traveling 150 miles to a district meeting. Our membership continues to cooperate with the intergroup office in our area, although they are not part of our service structure they are the ones who man the phones for Twelve Step calls and supply literature to our area. The intergroup is solely supported by group contributions and literature sales. Area 85 is concerned about the unity of A.A. in Ontario; some changes in our provincial structure have caused this concern about unity. However, it appears to have brought our area closer together in that we are communicating with the districts and our area committee far more than in the past. The Conference theme, "Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action," was a terrific workshop for our area. We are working together in gratitude.—*Marne Crary*



Pennsylvania (Eastern): We now have approximately 1,200 registered groups and 37 districts. We also have an ad hoc committee of D.C.M.s investigating the need for a new delegate area in Eastern Pennsylvania. Our standing committees—archives, correctional facilities, treatment facilities, finance, Grapevine, P.I. and structure—are all active. Last year our annual convention was the largest ever. Attendance at the four mini-assemblies has increased. Each includes the delegate's Conference report and roundtable discussions. Last year we celebrated 50 years of A.A. in Eastern Pennsylvania with several intergroup/central offices in the area. We also jointly sponsor a share-a-day program to acquaint members with intergroup and general service activities. More groups are designating intergroup liaisons. We may start an area newsletter and plan to continue our mini-assembly program, our share-a-day program and area subcommittee workshops. We look forward to greater participation in north-east regional functions.—*Marcia Goldblatt*

Pennsylvania (Western): We have 656 groups in 42 districts. Pittsburgh celebrated 50 years of Alcoholics Anonymous with 50 hours of meetings in December. Our committees are active and we are redistricting and thus have new D.C.M.s participating in area committees. C.P.C. and P.I. have been busy and we were happy about a mention in the Fall 1990 issue of *Box 4-5-9* about our presentation at a professional seminar. We have excellent displays. We have six to eight days of sharing and two assemblies per year. We also have a weekend of sharing that includes workshops that emphasize service. This is well attended by D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. We have quarterly newsletters that go out to all G.S.R.s. Our archivist has put together a booklet on group history in the area. All other committees—Grapevine, correctional facilities, literature and treatment facilities—are strong and active. Grapevine, archives and literature committees display at all area functions.—*Maxine Miller*

Quebec (Northeast): *La Région du Nord-Est du Québec* contains 350 groups within 20 districts. We have divided our area into four sectors. Executive members meet trusted servants of the sectors on annual service days. We also arrange a "delegate day" in March in preparation for the Conference. We maintain regular general assemblies and six committee meetings. Executive members meet at least ten times per year. The area chairperson, the delegate and the alternate meet three times with their counterparts in the other three areas of Quebec. Four delegates of the province meet three times on the boards of the *Service des pub-*

lications françaises and of *La Vigne*. We have six service coordinators as well as D.C.M.s and executive members. We want to increase visits by every area officer to district meetings and to mail or hand out more material to encourage participation in service. We want to improve communication, develop a sense of belonging for all members and stress the usefulness of A.A. literature for all our trusted servants.—*Robert Paré*

Quebec (Southeast): Our area has 18 districts that cover approximately 1,000 miles end-to-end from Drummondville to the Madeleines Islands, Quebec. We have 228 groups that hold 263 meetings per week; 171 open and 93 closed. We have penal institutions, P.I. and Grapevine committees, and hold regional assemblies in a different location every month. We meet thrice yearly with the other three areas of Quebec, which we call the provincial committees. We have two gratitude dinners where the delegate gives the annual Conference report and we also host a "Day of the Delegate" in seven different locations. Our area is very active and we look forward to a very hopeful future.—*Hughes Samson*

Texas (Northeast): Our area has 441 groups, 12,000 members and 30 districts. One of our districts is Spanish-speaking. We hold four assemblies each year. We have active P.I., C.P.C., correctional facilities and treatment facilities committees. Area chairmen bring to various districts workshops on sponsorship, self-support, the home group and the General Service Conference structure. They also help districts set up standing committees. We have an intergroup liaison as well as Grapevine and archives chairmen at the area level. We produce a quarterly newsletter and we have been taking our inventory at all levels of service. As a result of last year's Conference theme, "The Home Group," many groups now take an annual inventory. The same thing is happening in the districts. The area committee holds an inventory before panel rotation and the area assembly plans to take its inventory at an assembly this year. The results are more unity, purpose and direction.—*Jude Tims*

Texas (Southeast): We held our 29th annual convention in January 1991 and 1,660 members attended. Membership in our area has increased greatly in the last two years. Fourteen of 15 districts in the area are active. One district 90 miles from Houston charters a bus to bring members to A.A. functions in that city. Several districts plan to hold workshops on sponsorship. We meet quarterly in Houston for area assemblies where workshops, committee meetings and area business are conducted during a two-day session. The Grapevine committee and the archives committee are both active again. All other standing committees are working well. Cooperating more efficiently with the three intergroups in our area is at the top of our agenda for the next two years. We are moving toward becoming fully self-supporting at all levels. Many groups reimburse their G.S.R.s for service-related travel. We have a bid committee to complete our proposal for the 2000 International Convention.—*Linda O'Brien*

Utah: We have 10 districts in our area and are currently splitting one of these so that we will have 11 districts and approximately 250 groups. Recently we decided against a split in District 10, which is the Greater Salt Lake Area and have instead gone to a "super district" with 10 D.C.M.s. We have, however, reserved the option in our district guidelines to split this district at a later date. Our area encompasses the entire state of Utah. Because of the large area (in which most of the state population is contained in the northern portion), we rotate our conferences to include all districts interested in holding them. Our young people are

active and so are our standing committees. There has been tremendous growth in correctional and treatment facilities recently. We are working on unity throughout the state.—*Don Huff*

Virginia: Although voting at the general sessions is restricted to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area officers and committee chairmen, any A.A. can join any of our ten standing committees simply by showing up and, except for the budget and finance committee, can vote in those meetings. With a land mass larger than Massachusetts, Connecticut, Vermont, New Hampshire and New Jersey combined, and with a population of 6.2 million, we wonder if, as a single delegate area, we are capable of truly reaching out, or are we, despite our best efforts, limited to classifying those who fall through our doors as "growth"? Why does Massachusetts, with the same number of people, have 404 more groups and nearly 23,000 more A.A. members? Does Virginia need a second area? Our growth committee is searching for answers. In this age of electronic and technological wizardry we wonder why G.S.O. insists on remaining in one of the most expensive cities in the world. Why not Ames, Iowa? In Virginia, we are as fiscally conservative as we are democratic and these questions will not go away.—*Joe Sullivan*

Washington: Our area includes Washington state, the southeast corner of British Columbia, the panhandle of Idaho and small portions of Oregon and Montana. We have six elected officers and 13 appointed officers. Our active standing committees include P.I., C.P.C., Grapevine, literature, correctional facilities and treatment facilities. Each have chairs for the eastern and western sides of the area. D.C.M.s and officers meet three times a year. Last year we had 29 districts and due to redistricting we now have 45 districts and all are actively participating in the area. We are currently evaluating the possibility of splitting the area. We encourage and hold many service workshops and little assemblies throughout the year with excellent support from the membership. As a result, participation is at about 60 percent in contributions and in attendance. Our treasurer and our newsletter editor now use computers.—*Susie Terrell*

West Virginia: Our area now has 14 districts and 253 groups. Our area committee meets twice a year to suggest an agenda for our two area assemblies. Our assemblies and state convention rotate among districts. The area committee has four elected chairmen: one each for Grapevine, P.I., C.P.C. and institutions. We also have a nonvoting area archivist. Reports are given by the chairmen at each assembly. Last year the assembly voted to hold service workshops throughout the area. Approximately 300 people attended these workshops. Our 800 number answering service is working well and we are seeing an increase in A.A. membership in rural counties that had been neglected for years. This year sponsorship, home groups and problems associated with growth, will have top priority.—*Patrick Hogan*

Wisconsin (Southern): Our area now has 37 districts, more than 1,225 groups and 21,500 members. We have six area assemblies each year as well as a conference in the spring and fall. All committees are active and our officers and committee chairmen visit district G.S.R. meetings as often as possible. We have four central offices and three intergroup offices that have 24-hour hot lines. We practice the Seventh Tradition by keeping \$3,000 as a prudent reserve. On June 1 of each year we send 30 percent of excess funds to G.S.O. and divide the remaining 70 percent between the central and intergroup offices in our area. Our area committee holds workshops four times a year during our assemblies. Our past delegates participate in workshops and committee meetings. One past delegate conducts G.S.R. schools on a monthly basis throughout the area.—*William E. Hellesen*

Additional Committee Considerations Which Did Not Result in Recommendations.

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." These items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee suggested that the chairperson of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1992 Conference gently remind the speakers to honor the light system.
- The committee suggested continuation of three "What's On Your Mind?" sessions, with one of the sessions on Monday of Conference week.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the service piece: "Sponsor Your Doctor" from the Southern California C.P.C. Committee, and suggested it not be published as a service piece for Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee felt there was no need for an additional service piece on this topic, and thought the use of the word "sponsor" might cause confusion within the Fellowship.
- The committee reviewed the new copy for the C.P.C. Workbook and suggested the copy be included in the next printing of the workbook with the exception of the Section on "Working With Treatment Facilities," Section 2, pages 7-9. This section will be referred to the trustees' C.P.C. and Treatment Facilities Committees to include more updated material, and forwarded to the Conference C.P.C. Committee.
- The committee discussed minority initiative and special populations based on 1989/1990 Conference C.P.C. Committee Actions and made the following suggestions of constructive courses of action: (a) provide A.A. literature through individual and area committee efforts; (b) make the newsletter, *About A.A.*, available to as many professionals as possible; (c) carry the message more effectively through publications and radio/TV programs that focus on minority interests; (d) make area public information committees aware of the need to approach schools with high minority populations; and (e) step up efforts to hold A.A. exhibits and presentations wherever minority professionals gather.

Additional suggestions were: to create more Hispanic districts and use Spanish translators at area assemblies; have C.P.C. committees contact tribal officials explaining what A.A. is and is not; have areas hire signers for area assemblies and have C.P.C. committees contact more clergy in the community.

- The committee made a list of professionals A.A. needs to reach in the 1990s. This list includes: parole officers, public defenders, judges, counselors, treatment facilities administrators, psychiatrists, clergy, health care professionals, school administrators, athletic directors, E.A.P.s in industry and professionals in outpatient programs.
- The committee discussed the new C.P.C. Exhibits and thanked the trustees' C.P.C. Committee for developing new tabletop exhibits to purchase or borrow. They suggested a letter be sent to area C.P.C. chairpersons and delegates immediately following the Conference explaining that these exhibits are now available

to purchase or borrow from G.S.O. The letter will include a photograph of the new exhibit, cost, and information on how to borrow the exhibit (two month's notice needed).

They further encouraged area C.P.C., P.I., T.F., and C.F. committees to share usage of new exhibit. The committee reemphasized the need to cooperate with one another in order to best carry the A.A. message to the professional who comes in contact with the alcoholic.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee discussed the need to publish *As Bill Sees It* in a soft-cover edition. Because of the availability of the soft-cover edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*; *The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; *Daily Reflections*, and *A.A. In Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, and the Grapevine magazines, the committee sees no need for an additional soft-cover publication at this time.
- The committee discussed and suggested that a list of area correctional facilities committee chairpersons be used as an A.A. prerelease contact list on a confidential basis to be distributed to all area correctional facilities committee chairpersons.
- The committee reviewed the Correctional Facilities Workbook and suggested that a section on some effective examples of correctional facilities programs be added to the workbook, including shared experience on Seventh Tradition support.
- The committee discussed the need for a bridging the gap pamphlet specifically for correctional facilities Twelfth Step work. Because of the existing A.A. prerelease contact programs and the availability of *Carrying the Message Into Correctional Facilities*, the committee sees no need for a Correctional Facilities bridging the gap pamphlet at this time.
- The committee discussed solutions for cooperation between Correctional Facilities/H. & I. committees and local area service structures and suggested cooperation should be resolved within the local area structure. The committee concluded this was a matter of area autonomy.
- The committee recognized the need for the trustees' C.P.C. Committee to maintain an active presence at professional meetings of correctional facilities administrators, wardens, etc., in order to inform these professionals of the benefits of A.A.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed changing the quarterly contribution printouts to delegates to include groups which have been inactivated during current year, and contributions received from them, if any, and decided not to proceed.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed singleness of purpose as reflected in the Grapevine and affirmed that the editorial policy of the Grapevine is in accordance with our singleness of purpose.
- The committee reviewed the results of the Grapevine questionnaire and determined that it should be used on a continuing basis and should be made available to all delegates by mid-July.
- The committee discussed distribution of back issues by delegates and determined that such distribution should continue whenever possible.
- The committee discussed the current format of the wall calendar and suggested that the numbers be enlarged and that the

Grapevine Corporate Board consider the feasibility of a 14 month calendar.

- The committee discussed placement of the editorial disclaimer and concluded that the page number of the "Editorial Disclaimer" be included each month in the table of contents.
- The committee discussed what could be done to support and encourage GvRs.
- The committee discussed the question "Does the Grapevine have a responsibility to the Fellowship to keep our message consistent?", and requested a change in the Grapevine writer's guidelines to reflect our singleness of purpose.
- The committee discussed information from the Grapevine Corporate Board regarding a mailing from the Grapevine to all groups on the G.S.O. mailing list.

LITERATURE

- The following recommendation did not receive the necessary two-thirds majority vote from the Conference to become an Advisory Action:

It was recommended that the trustees' Literature Committee develop for our Fellowship a simple, concise pamphlet on "unity" that focuses on our common welfare and emphasizes our primary purpose, taking into consideration existing publications on A.A. unity and service, and present a draft to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee.

- The committee considered the suggestion to produce *Daily Reflections* on audiocassette and agreed that there was not sufficient need at this time.
- It was *strongly suggested* that an ongoing advisory committee composed of trustees, delegates and G.S.O. staff be established to review in depth all current and proposed Conference-approved material to assure that:
 1. We discourage unnecessary duplication.
 2. We encourage that our singleness of purpose is foremost;
 3. We encourage simplification wherever possible; and report back to the 1993 General Service Conference.
- It was suggested that the 1992 Conference Literature Committee consider the request from Area 78 to produce an anonymity card similar to the one published by Al-Anon Family Groups.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed the 1991 Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and suggested it remain the same for 1992.
- The committee considered the suggestion that Conference committees refrain from making negative recommendations and suggested that committees phrase their recommendations in as clear and concise a manner as possible.
- The committee reviewed the present policy of election for Conference Committee chairpersons and suggested that committees continue to use the present Conference policy of election by plurality.
- The committee considered the request from the Conference Agenda Committee to stress the need that all Conference members be present at all Conference sessions and concluded it is the responsibility of us as trusted servants to be present in order to render a service to world A.A.

- The committee considered the suggestion that guidelines be developed for G.S.O. staff when questions arise regarding implementing Advisory Actions and the committee determined there are already mechanisms in place to ensure that all Conference Advisory Actions are implemented as approved by the Conference body as a whole, and that the Conference process be followed.
- The committee considered the suggestion that Conference Agenda items be shared in advance with central/intergroup offices and concluded that it is a responsibility of each delegate to serve and communicate this information to all A.A. entities in their areas.
- The committee considered the suggestion to establish an ad hoc committee to review and evaluate concerns and problems of intergroup/central offices and concluded there is no need for an ad hoc committee. The committee thought that many of the problems and concerns are local and vary from area to area and that doors of communication and participation continue to be opened at the area level. The committee would again like to stress the importance of delegates maintaining contact with offices in their areas and assuring them they do have a voice in the Fellowship through their existing service structure.
- The committee considered a request to review the guest policy at the Opening Dinner of the General Service Conference and after discussion suggests this item be referred to the trustees' Conference Committee for their consideration.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee asked the trustees Membership Survey subcommittee to consider the following:
 1. Allowing only one response instead of two on question #5 of the 1992 Membership Survey questionnaire.
 2. Changing question #10 to read "Do you belong to an A.A. Home Group?"
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review in-depth the content of the Public Information Workbook and report back any recommendations for updates or changes to the 1992 Conference Public Information Committee.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information develop a category of questions to be used within the A.A. Fellowship in any confidential, analytical document developed for the 1992 Membership Survey. These categories should address needs and concerns within the Fellowship and should include more in-depth questions on sponsorship, service and recovery. The committee also asks that all questions on the Membership Survey be studied as to whether or not they should be in a general distribution pamphlet for C.P.C. or P.I. use, or in an analytical document for use only within the Fellowship.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed a request to include more information about L.C.M.s in the *A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, and concluded that this matter is best left to local autonomy.
- The committee considered the description of an A.A. group, as found in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service 1990/91* in relation to the Sixth Warranty of Article 12, and felt that this item was adequately covered under Advisory Action #31.

- The committee reviewed the structure chart on page S-23 of *The A.A. Service Manual* and was satisfied with it.
- The committee forwarded a suggestion to the trustees' Committee on the Conference that the 1992 General Service Conference include a presentation by a member of the General Service Board, G.S.O. staff and delegate on "Percentage and Participation of Conference Membership."
- The committee reviewed the Bar Graph on page 27 of the 1990 General Service Conference *Final Report* and found it historically accurate.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook and agreed that there is a need to hire an editor to correlate the contents with Conference-approved literature, streamline, and update the book, and implement suggestions from the Conference and trustees' Committees on Treatment Facilities.
 1. Suggested D ring binders be used, if feasible.
 2. Suggested better quality printing on both sides of the pages.
- The committee unanimously agreed that a service piece is needed to assist A.A. members introducing A.A. videos/films or making informational presentations in treatment facilities and further suggested that it consist of the information in the leaflet printed by the Area and District Treatment Facilities Committees in Southern Minnesota as revised by the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee. It was further suggested that the service piece be printed on card stock the size of a video container and be inserted with the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous."
- In discussing how to accomplish improving communication with Hospitals and Institutions Committees, it was suggested that the General Service Office, in corresponding with H&I committees, encourage committees to share their experience in the *Treatment Facilities Newsletter*. At the area level, liaisons between H&I committees and general service committees have been helpful.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed and accepted (with minor editorial changes) the trustees' Nominating Committee's guidelines for hiring the general manager of the General Service Office. The committee also accepted (with minor editorial changes) the emergency hiring procedures for the general manager of the General Service Office.
- The committee reviewed guidelines for selection of nontrustee directors of the corporate boards, and agreed that the trustees' Nominating Committee's description of how A.A. chooses (non-trustee) directors for A.A. World Services and (nontrustee) directors for the A.A. Grapevine be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter for inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee also agreed that the trustees' Nominating Committee's description of how A.A. chooses appointed committee members be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter for inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee discussed rotation of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors and suggested that more background material be sent to committee members for review and future discussion at the 1992 General Service Conference.

Financial Overview

OVERALL: G.S.O. had a total net income of \$919,200 after paying extraordinary expenses for the computer implementation project of \$311,400. Operating income for the period was actually \$1,230,600. As a result of the excess of income over expenses for the year, surplus cash of \$650,000 was approved and transferred to the Reserve Fund in 1991. This operating income of \$1,230,000 is approximately \$300,000 higher than the original 1990 budget. Actual revenue for the period compared with the original budget was approximately \$315,000 greater. Gross profit from literature was approximately \$133,000 lower, contributions from A.A. members were approximately \$315,000 higher and the 55th International Convention contributed approximately \$133,000 more than originally budgeted. Expenses for the period, including the computer project, were approximately \$9,150,000, approximately \$300,000 less than the original budget.

SERVICES: Contributions for 1990 were \$4,415,400, an 8.9% increase over 1989, and approximately 7.7% ahead of budget. This follows a period of time when the 1989 contributions were 3.9% over 1988 and 1988's were 6.8% over the 1987.

The 55th International Convention contributed approximately \$181,000 in excess revenue to the General Service Board.

PUBLISHING: 1990 literature sales net of discounts were \$10,084,000, approximately 22% ahead of 1989. Gross profit from literature was \$5,442,000, an increase of \$1,690,000 from 1989. It should be remembered, however, that the increase is a result of a readjustment of literature prices, and the publication of *Daily Reflections*.

IMPACT OF WORLD EVENTS: The opening of borders of Eastern European countries has presented new challenges to G.S.O. and the board. The board's initiative to translate recovery literature for the purpose of making it available to those countries where the A.A. structure is not yet in place, will add to our cost of writers' fees and increase foreign literature assistance costs in 1990. While the category of writers fees declined by approximately \$10,000, from \$113,900 in 1989 to \$103,400 in 1990, the amount of foreign literature assistance increased by \$98,000 from 1989 to 1990. The 1991 budget reflects an even larger amount of \$295,000.

WORKING CAPITAL: The balance sheet reflects an increase in cash of approximately \$690,000; of this, cash from operations decreased by \$150,000 while cash segregated for payment of royalties increased by \$840,000. Total accounts receivable increased by approximately \$60,000, from \$197,000 to \$257,000. Total inventories for the period increased by approximately \$550,000, from \$1,390,000 to \$1,940,000. Total assets at December 31, 1990 of \$5,530,000 compared with total assets at December 31, 1989 of \$4,220,000. As at December 31, 1990 total payables were \$2,780,000, an increase of \$1,127,000 from the prior year. The major increase reflected here is in royalties payable (an increase of approximately \$820,000) to \$1,935,000. Deferred revenue, for both Convention income and orders for sales, decreased by approximately \$755,000.

GRAPEVINE: The Grapevine's results for 1990 show a reduction of revenue of approximately \$79,000; it was however, approximately \$30,000 over budget.

Grapevine's total expenses for 1990 were \$1,968,000. This compares with \$1,993,000, or approximately \$25,000 less than 1989.

Grapevine's net income for 1990, including interest earned, was \$193,900, a decrease of approximately \$40,000 from 1989.

Grapevine's budget for 1991 projects revenue of \$2,113,000. This increase is approximately \$60,000 from the 1990 actual as a result of conservative budgeting and a price increase during 1990. Total expenses are budgeted at \$2,154,000, approximately \$65,000 higher than the 1990 actuals. Net income after interest earned is anticipated to be \$65,000.

RESERVE FUND: The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance at December 31, 1990 of \$7,095,000, yielding approximately 7.8% on book value. In May of 1990 the Grapevine transferred \$83,000 in excess cash to the Reserve Fund; no similar transfers were made from A.A. World Services. The Reserve Fund after interest earned stood at a level of nine and one-third months as measured against one year's operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The General Service Board of A.A., Inc., and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

It is conceivable that some drawdowns will be necessary in financing the relocation/reconstruction of G.S.O. in 1991. These drawdowns, if required, are under the direct control of the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board, which reports and recommends such transfers to the General Service Board as a whole. It is estimated at this time that \$550,000 will be needed from the Reserve Fund for the 1991 portion of the project.

SUMMARY: As stated last year, "the continuing decline in growth of contributions in 1989, coupled with a slow down in literature sales, and the growth of services being required by G.S.O. to the Fellowship and around the world, left no choice but to restore the price of literature as of January 1, 1990." An additional price adjustment became necessary effective April 1, 1991, in order to properly restore gross profit margins.

While the 1991 budget reflects such items as relocation/construction and duplicate rent/relocation, it should be remembered that once we move to our new headquarters, we expect to enjoy significantly lower rents for the next ten years, without the effect of real estate taxes and any increases that may accrue thereto.

The General Service Office is optimistic about 1991 and looks forward to a good year for Alcoholics Anonymous.



The General Service Office INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1990

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$10,488,230			\$10,488,230
Discounts	(404,011)			(404,011)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>10,084,219</u>			<u>10,084,219</u>
Cost of products	(3,627,883)			(3,627,883)
Royalties	(1,014,202)			(1,014,202)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>5,442,134</u>			<u>5,442,134</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$4,415,395		4,415,395
International Convention			\$ 181,029	181,029
Interest income	<u>2,207</u>	<u>27,021</u>		<u>29,228</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>5,444,341</u>	<u>4,442,416</u>	<u>181,029</u>	<u>10,067,786</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,550,646	1,927,836		3,478,482
Pension/retirement expense	160,931			160,931
Rent and electric	382,155	280,705		662,860
Box 4-5-9		165,920		165,920
A.A. Directories		49,163		49,163
Other service materials		373,032		373,032
Shipping and mailing	1,196,918			1,196,918
Other office expenses	71,988	570,035		642,023
Insurance and payroll taxes		739,486		739,486
Professional services	179,904		27,500	207,404
Board, committee and staff meetings	44,726	14,081	127,854	186,661
Writers' fees	103,385			103,385
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	16,794		94,935	111,729
General Service Conference		306,108		306,108
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	78,925			78,925
Regional Forums and other			119,885	119,885
Film development			45,624	45,624
Leasehold improvements			1,268	1,268
World Service Meeting (every other year)			80,635	80,635
Self-support Project			15,022	15,022
Foreign literature assistance (net)	<u>111,742</u>			<u>111,742</u>
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	<u>3,898,114</u>	<u>4,426,366</u>	<u>512,723</u>	<u>8,837,203</u>
Net Operating Income (Loss)	1,546,227	16,050	(331,694)	1,230,583
less Extraordinary expenses:				
Computer project			(311,422)	(311,422)
GSO NET INCOME (Loss)				
Exclusive of Reserve Fund	<u>1,546,227</u>	<u>16,050</u>	<u>(643,116)</u>	<u>919,161</u>
Reserve Fund Earnings				550,386
A.A. Grapevine Net Income				<u>193,904</u>
Combined General Service Board Income per Audit Report				<u>1,663,451</u>

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund. "This allocation is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not necessarily as to the individual expense accounts comprising the total."

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1989

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$8,676,239			\$8,676,239
Discounts	(387,320)			(387,320)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>8,288,919</u>			<u>8,288,919</u>
Cost of products	(3,636,169)			(3,636,169)
Royalties	(901,084)			(901,084)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>3,751,666</u>			<u>3,751,666</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$4,054,111		4,054,111
Interest income	- 0 -	13,238		13,238
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,751,666</u>	<u>4,067,349</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>7,819,015</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,336,291	1,874,798		3,211,089
Pension/retirement expense	237,616		14,163	251,779
Rent and electric	357,985	262,970		620,955
Box 4-5-9		160,329		160,329
A.A. Directories		88,515		88,515
Other service materials		322,016		322,016
Shipping and mailing	1,263,308			1,263,308
Other office expenses	71,757	644,919		716,676
Insurance and payroll taxes		765,820		765,820
Professional services	63,967		22,654	86,621
Board, committee and staff meetings	57,636	12,516	142,037	212,189
Writers' fees	113,937			113,937
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	15,151		95,385	110,536
General Service Conference		341,760		341,760
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	70,767			70,767
Regional Forums and other			103,617	103,617
Film development			25,880	25,880
Leasehold improvements			3,436	3,436
World Service Meeting (every other year)			- 0 -	- 0 -
Self-support Project			32,905	32,905
Board Expense — Int'l. Visits			362	362
Foreign literature assistance (net)	13,950			13,950
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	<u>3,602,365</u>	<u>4,473,643</u>	<u>440,439</u>	<u>8,516,447</u>
Net Operating Income (Loss)	149,301	(406,294)	(440,439)	(697,432)
Less extraordinary expenses:				
Computer project			(507,379)	(507,379)
NET GSO INCOME EXCLUSIVE OF RESERVE FUND	<u>149,301</u>	<u>(406,294)</u>	<u>(947,818)</u>	<u>(1,204,811)</u>
Reserve Fund earnings				558,863
A.A. Grapevine net income				233,199
COMBINED GENERAL SERVICE BOARD INCOME (LOSS)				<u>(412,749)</u>
PER AUDITOR'S REPORT				

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund. "This allocation is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not necessarily as to the individual expense accounts comprising the total."

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1990

	<u>1990</u>	<u>1989</u>
INCOME — from magazine and other sales	<u>\$2,054,698</u>	<u>\$2,133,241</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$202,406	\$185,866
Printing	258,275	261,880
Mailing — service	103,086	81,933
postage	168,383	183,037
Other production costs	153,523	211,023
Occupancy costs	90,768	84,650
Magazine indexing project	25,000	10,000
Office supplies and other	<u>15,891</u>	<u>9,690</u>
<u>Total</u>	1,017,332	1,028,079
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	443,689	451,801
Data processing costs	18,182	19,800
Occupancy costs	90,768	84,650
Office expense, including agency fees	15,891	30,120
Selling expense — Regular	66,569	55,196
GvR program	18,292	17,566
Postage	<u>77,792</u>	<u>79,985</u>
<u>Total</u>	731,183	739,118
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	3,996	3,996
Insurance	92,205	102,237
Professional fees	21,433	19,053
Payroll taxes	47,502	44,904
Meetings and conferences	25,680	22,033
Furniture and equipment	7,062	12,321
Contribution to Retirement Plan	14,139	17,496
Canadian exchange and other	3,347	2,328
Compensation study	<u>4,225</u>	<u>1,505</u>
<u>Total</u>	219,589	225,873
<u>Total Costs and Expenses</u>	<u>\$1,968,104</u>	<u>\$1,993,070</u>
<u>Income from Operations</u>	86,594	140,171
<u>Interest earned</u>	<u>107,310</u>	<u>93,028</u>
<u>Net Income for Year</u>	<u><u>193,904</u></u>	<u><u>233,199</u></u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1991 BUDGET

	1991	
INCOME — from magazine and other sales		\$2,112,800
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	\$210,000	
Printing	267,500	
Mailing — service	77,500	
— postage	230,000	
Other production costs	167,400	
Occupancy costs	98,500	
Office supplies and expenses	<u>12,000</u>	
<u>Total</u>		1,062,900
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	493,300	
Computer processing costs	12,000	
Stationery and supplies	9,000	
Occupancy costs	98,500	
Office expense	16,000	
Selling expense — regular	70,000	
— GvR program	25,000	
Postage	90,000	
Subscriber services	<u>23,000</u>	
<u>Total</u>		836,800
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Indexing project	10,000	
Organization/Compensation review	3,000	
Consultant fee	4,000	
Insurance	112,000	
Professional fees	23,500	
Payroll taxes	56,000	
Meetings, conferences and travel	23,000	
Furniture and equipment — normal operations	5,000	
Contribution to Retirement Fund	15,000	
Canadian exchange	1,000	
Bad debts	<u>2,000</u>	
<u>Total</u>		254,500
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES		<u>2,154,200</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS		(41,400)
Interest earned		<u>107,000</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR		<u><u>65,600</u></u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Office

1991 BUDGET

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$12,676,800			\$12,676,800
Discounts	<u>(459,000)</u>			<u>(459,000)</u>
<u>Net Sales</u>	12,217,800			12,217,800
Cost of products	(4,167,200)			(4,167,200)
Royalties	<u>(1,232,800)</u>			<u>(1,232,800)</u>
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	6,817,800			6,817,800
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$4,567,500		4,567,500
Interest income	<u>10,000</u>	<u>5,000</u>		<u>15,000</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>6,827,800</u>	<u>4,572,500</u>		<u>11,400,300</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,683,800	2,057,900		3,741,700
Pension/retirement expense	192,300		11,000	203,300
Rent and electric	407,600	299,400		707,000
Box 4-5-9		177,200		177,200
A.A. Directories		57,800		57,800
Other service materials		357,400		357,400
Shipping and mailing	1,183,000			1,183,000
Other office expenses	69,800	615,300		685,100
Insurance and payroll taxes		797,700		797,700
Professional services	133,000		28,000	161,000
Board, committee and staff meetings	48,600	10,000	145,000	203,600
Writers' fees	145,400			145,400
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	22,000		96,100	118,100
General Service Conference		322,000		322,000
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	247,100			247,100
Regional Forums and other			86,400	86,400
Film development			30,000	30,000
Self-Support Project			7,800	7,800
Foreign literature assistance (net)	<u>295,000</u>			<u>295,000</u>
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	<u>4,427,600</u>	<u>4,694,700</u>	<u>404,300</u>	<u>9,526,600</u>
Net Operating Income (Loss)	2,400,200	(122,200)	(404,300)	1,873,700
Less extraordinary expenses:				
Duplicate Rent/Relocation			(632,700)	(632,700)
Relocation/Construction — Est.			<u>(1,790,000)</u>	<u>(1,790,000)</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS)	<u>2,400,200</u>	<u>(122,200)</u>	<u>(2,827,000)</u>	<u>(549,000)</u>
EARNINGS ON RESERVE FUND — Est.				<u>564,000</u>

1991 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: The sales income budget of \$12,676,800 is \$2,188,600 (20.9%) greater than 1990. This reflects price increases effective 4/1/91. The increase aids in restoring a sufficient gross profit on literature sales.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$4,427,600, about 13.5% higher than 1990 actual.

Net: Net publishing income is expected to be \$2,400,200, an increase of \$854,000 over 1990. The substantially higher net planned for 1991 over 1990, is required to offset the anticipated shortfall as well as a partial provision for relocation/renovation.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: The budget reflects a conservative projection of 3% increase in contributions over 1990 (1990 had an 8.9% increase over 1989, following 1989's 3.9% increase over 1988).

Expenses: Total group expenses to be directly charged against contributions are budgeted to be \$4,694,700. This results in an anticipated shortfall of these expenses charged against contributions of \$122,200.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$2,827,000. This includes extraordinary expenses of \$2,422,700 set aside for Relocation/Renovation expenses anticipated in 1991. Exclusive of this item, Other Expenses are budgeted lower than 1990. This decrease is mainly attributed to the cost of the 1990 World Service Meeting, which is held every other year. The total Other Expenses, including the extraordinary expenses, is budgeted to be offset by the excess net publishing income, as well as investment income from the Reserve Fund.

RECAP

The shortfall for 1991 "Group Services" (as defined by the 1986 General Service Conference) supported by group contributions, is budgeted to be \$531,500. It is anticipated that the net publishing income will offset the shortfall and most extraordinary expenses and that minimal drawdown from the Reserve Fund is planned for 1991.

1991 Grapevine Budget

Total revenue: The 1991 budget shows revenues of \$2,112,800. This anticipates paid circulation of 130,000, the effect of a price increase beginning with the 6/90 issue, and \$600,500 in revenue from sale of special items.

Total expenses: Editorial and printing costs are budgeted at \$1,062,900, \$45,600 (4.4%) over 1990 actual. Printing of the magazine shows a negligible increase, a result of being able to hold the line of the printing contract. Production costs of other materials is up slightly.

Total Circulation and Business expenses are budgeted at \$836,800, \$105,600 (14%) over 1990 actual.

Three areas of increase are postage, subscription services and departmental restaffing. Total General and Administrative expenses are budgeted at \$254,500, \$34,900 (15.9%) over 1990 actual. General and Administrative expenses are up due to anticipated costs for insurance and payroll taxes.

Total Costs and Expenses are budgeted at \$2,154,200, \$186,100 (9%) higher than 1990.

Net: After including interest income of \$107,000 we show a modest net income of \$65,600.

COMPARISON OF SHORTFALL OF 'GROUP SERVICES' SUPPORTED BY GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

April 1986 Conference Advisory Action 16.a:

16. The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or inter-group offices:

- a. G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

The following is a recap of these lists [detailed reports appear in delegates' Manual and *Final Conference Report*]:

1989			
Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,054,111
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$4,473,643		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
	\$947,818		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Computer Acquisition	(507,379)	440,439	4,914,082
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(859,971)</u>

1990			
Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,415,395
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$4,426,366		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
	\$824,145		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Computer Acquisition	(311,422)	512,723	4,939,089
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(523,694)</u>

1991 BUDGET			
Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,567,500
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$4,694,700		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
	\$2,827,000		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Relocation/Renovation	(2,422,700)	404,300	5,099,000
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(531,500)</u>

1990 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	397	234	58.9%	\$ 26,384.21	6,089	\$4.33	60.	West	677	391	57.8	39,297.92	10,188	3.86
2.	Alaska	211	96	45.5	9,759.92	3,027	3.22	61.	Rhode Island	222	120	54.1	17,759.92	4,570	3.89
3.	Arizona	782	398	50.9	45,196.36	13,215	3.42	62.	South Carolina	273	186	68.1	23,665.93	5,268	4.49
4.	Arkansas	242	130	53.7	12,672.60	3,729	3.40	63.	South Dakota	163	72	44.2	6,601.48	3,362	1.96
5.	California	1,820	864	47.5	118,604.80	61,570	1.93	64.	Tennessee	443	239	54.0	29,944.45	7,734	3.87
6.	N. Coastal	1,910	1,250	65.4	192,470.97	52,907	3.64	65.	Texas	427	222	52.0	46,012.91	14,005	3.29
7.	N. Interior	609	323	53.0	42,074.42	15,803	2.66	66.	Northeast	253	132	52.2	14,914.14	6,099	2.45
8.	San Diego/Imp.	709	413	58.3	51,957.94	21,014	2.47	67.	Northwest	540	259	48.0	39,163.75	15,001	2.61
9.	Mid-South.	1,520	854	56.2	96,725.75	47,657	2.03	68.	Southeast	458	240	52.4	38,159.55	9,805	3.89
10.	Colorado	630	360	57.1	48,391.01	15,535	3.11	69.	Southwest	266	179	67.3	18,748.61	4,992	3.76
11.	Connecticut	1,208	660	54.6	96,528.33	27,252	3.54	70.	Utah	224	96	42.9	14,848.02	3,861	3.85
12.	Delaware	154	112	72.7	24,218.65	2,500	9.69	71.	Vermont	1,004	609	60.7	87,264.68	19,327	4.52
13.	D.C.	401	245	61.1	50,987.91	13,686	3.73	72.	Virginia	1,200	688	57.3	94,336.25	22,656	4.16
14.	Florida	589	351	59.6	57,734.53	11,461	5.04	73.	Washington	274	140	51.1	11,865.88	3,140	3.78
15.	North	589	351	59.6	57,734.53	11,461	5.04	74.	West Virginia	274	140	51.1	11,865.88	3,140	3.78
16.	South/	1,467	795	54.2	113,427.45	26,185	4.33	75.	Wisconsin	594	305	51.3	23,887.39	9,209	2.59
17.	Bahamas/V.I.	641	493	76.9	76,964.15	14,795	5.20	76.	N. Wis./Upper	849	480	56.5	48,091.80	15,201	3.16
18.	Georgia	241	156	64.7	34,443.68	5,033	6.84	77.	Pen. Mich.	135	70	51.9	6,976.49	2,137	3.26
19.	Hawaii	184	111	60.3	10,990.78	2,754	3.99	78.	South	127	74	58.3	5,476.31	1,610	3.40
20.	Illinois	1,028	429	41.7	58,879.26	23,738	2.48	79.	Puerto Rico	562	261	46.4	32,041.53	7,294	4.39
21.	Chicago	896	429	47.9	39,325.63	17,337	2.27	80.	Alberta/N.W.T.	692	398	57.5	58,567.54	11,127	5.26
22.	North	409	218	53.3	25,648.40	7,202	3.56	81.	B.C./Yukon	164	66	40.2	8,713.27	3,980	2.19
23.	South	592	326	55.1	29,145.57	9,673	3.01	82.	Manitoba	225	117	52.0	8,198.14	3,285	2.50
24.	Indiana	410	249	60.7	26,700.10	8,669	3.08	83.	N.B./P.E.I.	274	144	52.6	12,589.08	3,140	4.01
25.	North	632	375	59.3	39,459.35	12,608	3.13	84.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	572	319	55.8	59,409.20	13,190	4.50
26.	South	398	243	61.1	26,542.50	9,512	2.79	85.	Ontario	193	74	38.3	12,664.41	2,354	5.38
27.	Iowa	534	344	64.4	56,299.79	8,618	6.53	86.	East	90	30	33.3	4,299.03	1,409	3.05
28.	Kansas	526	238	45.2	24,696.68	9,241	2.67	87.	Northwest	468	230	49.1	50,483.88	8,236	6.13
29.	Kentucky	439	198	45.1	19,113.69	7,902	2.42	88.	West	572	388	68.0	37,269.91	14,854	2.51
30.	Louisiana	775	433	55.9	61,958.23	10,857	5.71	89.	Quebec	231	186	80.0	11,000.57	3,337	3.30
31.	Maine	1,312	625	47.6	92,514.10	46,667	1.98	90.	Southwest	356	286	80.0	24,405.45	6,767	3.61
32.	Maryland	206	118	57.3	20,215.19	4,849	4.17	91.	Southeast	366	345	94.0	71,175.77	6,309	11.28
33.	Massachusetts	523	246	47.0	40,763.33	11,275	3.62	92.	Northwest	340	178	52.4	18,065.57	4,443	4.07
34.	East	552	287	52.0	54,455.59	13,121	4.15		Total U.S./	51,472	28,052	54.5%	\$3,767,346.34	1,099,951	\$3.43
35.	West	404	210	52.0	38,566.22	7,857	4.91		Canada	24	1	4.2	4,150.00	204	20.34
36.	Michigan	513	290	56.5	22,323.54	8,079	2.76		Bermuda	51,496	28,053	54.5%	\$3,771,496.34	1,100,155	\$3.43
37.	Central	951	487	51.2	46,225.21	24,659	1.87		Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				211,863.94		
38.	Southeast	226	125	55.3	9,891.66	3,109	3.18		Specials				395,218.87		
39.	West	539	315	58.4	36,016.35	8,338	4.32		Total for U.S. & Canada				\$4,378,579.15		
40.	Montana	226	147	65.0	17,790.78	5,527	3.22		FOREIGN AND OTHER						
41.	Nebraska	345	166	48.1	15,749.78	4,626	3.40		Birds of a Feather				80.50		
42.	Nevada	704	387	55.0	54,776.26	13,706	4.00		Correctional facility groups				125.40		
43.	New Hampshire	320	145	45.3	14,937.81	6,144	2.43		Foreign				30,846.27		
44.	New Jersey	494	198	40.1	22,113.10	6,980	3.17		International Doctors in A.A.				1,000.00		
45.	North	1,170	588	50.3	81,873.97	26,640	3.07		International Lawyers in A.A.				17.00		
46.	South	371	216	58.2	33,913.52	6,091	5.57		Internationalists				100.00		
47.	New Mexico	296	154	52.0	14,100.59	4,780	2.95		Loners				2,994.00		
48.	New York	636	314	49.4	48,153.90	10,290	4.68		Treatment facility meetings				1,554.52		
49.	H.M./B.	680	314	46.2	33,099.90	9,288	3.56		World Hello				98.14		
50.	Southeast	1,639	850	51.9	190,465.77	46,498	4.10		Grand Total				\$4,415,394.98		
51.	West	258	125	48.4	14,900.25	3,797	3.92								
52.	N. Carolina	707	478	67.6	74,117.56	11,799	6.28								
53.	North Dakota	178	100	56.2	7,027.42	3,068	2.29								
54.	Ohio	572	235	41.1	24,333.85	7,373	3.30								
55.	Cent. & S.E.	1,053	327	31.1	27,257.02	25,163	1.08								
56.	Northeast	256	136	53.1	16,342.75	3,699	4.42								
57.	N.W. Ohio/	462	250	54.1	26,432.33	9,290	2.85								
58.	S.E. Mich.	368	280	76.1	35,948.82	5,508	6.53								
59.	S.W. Ohio	679	388	57.1	58,066.92	11,169	5.20								
	Oklahoma														
	Oregon														
	Pennsylvania														
	East	1,244	700	56.3	101,771.36	33,102	3.07								

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists or percentages submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1990-1989

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada						
1990	51,496	28,053	54.5%	\$3,771,496.34	1,100,155	\$3.43
U.S. & Canada						
1989	47,973	26,963	56.2	3,551,500.33	978,982	3.63
Increase (Decrease)	3,523	1,090	(1.7%)	\$ 219,996.01	121,173	\$(1.20)

1990 Total Contributions — by State / Province

U.S.	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alabama	283	167	59.0%	\$ 17,262.62	4,641	\$3.72
Alaska	210	96	45.7	12,569.09	3,014	4.17
Arizona	762	382	50.1	54,805.89	13,061	4.20
Arkansas	242	131	54.1	13,798.23	3,729	3.70
California	6,655	3,735	56.1	589,522.76	201,713	2.92
Colorado	629	360	57.2	56,774.29	15,511	3.66
Connecticut	1,218	670	55.0	118,917.28	27,539	4.32
Delaware	152	111	73.0	26,313.26	2,453	10.73
District of Columbia	182	100	54.9	30,715.82	5,884	5.22
Florida	2,158	1,206	55.9	227,483.71	39,254	5.80
Georgia	637	493	77.4	79,859.84	14,772	5.41
Hawaii	240	157	65.4	40,358.26	5,006	8.06
Idaho	229	133	58.1	15,380.74	3,201	4.80
Illinois	2,329	1,076	46.2	145,013.99	48,280	3.00
Indiana	1,033	598	57.9	65,669.61	18,811	3.49
Iowa	631	375	59.4	45,231.40	12,588	3.59
Kansas	398	243	61.1	34,631.71	9,488	3.65
Kentucky	499	320	64.1	59,978.49	8,189	7.32
Louisiana	525	238	45.3	28,153.95	9,224	3.05
Maine	425	194	45.6	21,902.17	7,756	2.82
Maryland	985	573	58.2	98,479.79	18,528	5.32
Massachusetts	1,544	748	48.4	118,517.08	51,801	2.29
Michigan	1,647	824	50.0	148,885.65	34,818	4.28
Minnesota	1,457	774	53.1	77,650.01	32,331	2.40
Mississippi	226	125	55.3	10,592.66	3,110	3.41
Missouri	763	462	60.6	60,096.18	13,848	4.34
Montana	346	167	48.3	18,087.88	4,633	3.90
Nebraska	703	387	55.0	62,357.67	13,687	4.56
Nevada	279	128	45.9	14,334.35	5,153	2.78
New Hampshire	491	197	40.1	25,751.18	6,903	3.73
New Jersey	1,539	804	52.2	151,832.21	32,719	4.64
New Mexico	296	157	53.0	16,703.51	4,656	3.59
New York	3,239	1,609	49.7	371,720.61	70,157	5.30
North Carolina	730	478	65.5	78,677.26	11,987	6.56
North Dakota	177	100	56.5	9,069.42	3,051	2.97
Ohio	2,317	938	40.5	115,116.38	44,857	2.57
Oklahoma	368	280	76.1	41,224.10	5,509	7.48
Oregon	683	392	57.4	62,088.27	11,222	5.53
Pennsylvania	1,939	1,097	56.6	156,527.60	43,511	3.60
Rhode Island	221	120	54.3	18,676.67	4,539	4.11
South Carolina	272	186	68.4	25,011.93	5,250	4.76
South Dakota	162	72	44.4	11,154.27	3,342	3.34
Tennessee	440	238	54.1	35,295.01	7,700	4.58
Texas	1,673	849	50.7	171,345.01	44,769	3.83
Utah	265	180	67.9	20,092.16	4,974	4.04
Vermont	224	96	42.9	18,263.14	3,875	4.71
Virginia	1,010	613	60.7	96,164.45	19,453	4.94
Washington	1,139	657	57.7	99,550.72	21,983	4.53
West Virginia	263	135	51.3	13,308.07	3,038	4.38
Wisconsin	1,310	726	55.4	75,015.13	22,755	3.30
Wyoming	136	71	52.2	8,866.43	2,153	4.12
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	126	74	58.7	5,770.79	1,598	3.61
Bahama Islands	10	1	10.0	200.00	138	1.45
Virgin Islands of U.S.	9	6	66.7	3,070.07	257	11.95
Bermuda	24	1	4.2	4,150.00	204	.74
TOTAL for U.S.	46,450	25,050	53.9%	\$3,927,988.77	1,012,623	\$3.88

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists or percentages submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alberta	485	236	48.7%	38,723.03\$	6,451	6.00\$
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	165	89	53.9	8,777.15	2,133	4.11
Newfoundland	98	52	53.1	7,749.09	901	8.60
Nova Scotia	174	91	52.3	9,670.36	2,203	4.39
Prince Edward Island	77	34	44.2	3,583.88	1,368	2.62
Labrador	1	1	100.0	50.00	22	2.27
British Columbia	727	415	57.1	81,878.39	11,487	7.13
Manitoba	162	66	40.7	10,661.54	3,953	2.70
N.W. Territories	31	7	22.6	1,938.49	305	6.36
Ontario	1,273	626	49.2	168,573.50	24,569	6.86
Quebec	1,500	1,203	80.2 ①	171,144.10	29,520	5.80
Saskatchewan	340	178	52.4	21,972.77	4,440	4.95
Yukon Territory	13	5	38.5	655.00	180	3.64

TOTAL for CANADA (Canadian dollars) 5,046 3,003① 59.5%① 525,377.30\$ 87,532 6.00\$①

(converted to U.S. dollars \$ 450,590.38 \$5.15)

TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars) 51,496 28,053① 54.5%① \$4,378,579.15 1,100,155 \$3.98①

FOREIGN AND OTHER

Birds of a Feather	80.50
Correctional facility groups	125.40
Foreign	30,846.27
International Doctors in A.A.	1,000.00
International Lawyers in A.A.	17.00
Internationalists	100.00
Loners	2,994.00
Treatment facility meetings	1,554.52
World Hello	98.14

GRAND TOTAL \$4,415,394.98

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON 1990-1989 (IN U.S. DOLLARS)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. 1990	46,450	25,050	53.9%	\$3,928,988.77	1,012,623	\$3.88
U.S. 1989	43,107	23,973	55.6	3,614,296.42	896,033	4.03
Increase (Decrease)	3,343	1,077	(1.7%)	\$ 314,692.35	116,590	\$(.15)
Canada 1990	5,046	3,003①	59.5%①	\$ 450,590.38	87,532	\$5.15①
Canada 1989	4,866	2,990①	61.4 ①	404,462.32	82,949	4.88①
Increase (Decrease)	180	13	(1.9%)	\$ 46,128.06	4,583	.27
U.S. and Canada 1990	51,496	28,053①	54.5%①	\$4,379,579.15	1,100,155	\$3.98①
U.S. and Canada 1989	47,973	26,963①	56.2 ①	4,018,758.74	978,982	4.11①
Increase (Decrease)	3,523	1,090	(1.7%)	\$ 360,820.41	121,173	\$(.13)

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED STATEMENTS OF INCOME, EXPENSES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES

Years Ended December 31, 1990 and 1989

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1990	Combined 1989
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
INCOME FROM LITERATURE							(as restated - Note 2)
Gross Sales				\$10,488,230	\$2,114,037	\$12,602,267	\$10,905,949
Less: Discounts				404,011	59,339	463,350	470,464
Net Sales				10,084,219	2,054,698	12,138,917	10,435,485
Cost of Literature Distributed							
Printing				(3,627,883)	(411,798)	(4,039,681)	(4,122,397)
Royalties on books				(1,014,202)	-	(1,014,202)	(901,084)
Gross Profit from Literature				5,442,134	1,642,900	7,085,034	5,412,004
CONTRIBUTIONS — A.A. groups and members	\$4,415,395			-	-	4,415,395	4,054,111
55th Anniversary Convention	181,029			-	-	181,029	-
Investment Income	27,021	\$ 550,386		2,207	107,310	686,924	665,129
Total Income	<u>4,623,445</u>	<u>550,386</u>		<u>5,444,341</u>	<u>1,750,210</u>	<u>12,368,382</u>	<u>10,131,244</u>
EXPENSES							
Office Expenses (Schedule A-1)	4,120,258			3,443,958	1,377,154	8,941,370	8,884,510
Computer Acquisition Expense (includes expenditures on capital projects: 1990 - \$148,548, 1989 - \$305,221—see contra below)	311,422			-	-	311,422	507,379
Other Expenses (Schedule A-2)	818,831			454,156	179,152	1,452,139	1,152,104
Total Expenses	<u>5,250,511</u>			<u>3,898,114</u>	<u>1,556,306</u>	<u>10,704,931</u>	<u>10,543,993</u>
Excess of Income (Expense) for Year	(627,066)	550,386		1,546,227	193,904	1,663,451	(412,749)
Fund Balances							
Balance, January 1	57,013	6,462,136	\$ 923,060	1,579,469	474,673	9,496,351	8,986,040
Add: adjustment for the cumulative effect on prior years of applying retroactively the new method of accounting for capitalization and depreciation of fixed assets (Note 2)						-	1,095,846
						11,159,802	9,669,137
Increase—expenditures on capital projects (see contra above)			148,548			148,548	305,221
			1,071,608			11,308,350	9,974,358
Decrease—depreciation on capital projects			(505,608)			(505,608)	(478,007)
			566,000			10,802,742	9,496,351
Intercompany donations	627,066	82,837	-	(627,066)	(82,837)	-	-
Balance, December 31	<u>57,013</u>	<u>7,095,359</u>	<u>566,000</u>	<u>2,498,630</u>	<u>585,740</u>	<u>10,802,742</u>	<u>9,496,351</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
Years Ended December 31, 1990 and 1989
COMBINED OFFICE EXPENSES

SCHEDULE A-1

	1990	1989
Salaries	\$4,124,577	\$3,848,756
Employee benefits, including pension plan	<u>1,054,263</u>	<u>1,168,073</u>
Total Labor Costs	5,178,840	5,106,829
Postage express	1,254,521	1,276,555
Warehousing and packing	291,658	331,708
Stationery and office supplies	135,622	143,717
Rent and electricity	844,396	790,255
Telephone	81,830	77,645
<i>Box 4-5-9</i>	165,920	160,329
A.A. Directories	49,163	88,515
Other service materials	373,032	322,016
Writers' fees	103,385	113,937
Office equipment	16,527	30,173
Office services and expenses	364,124	434,621
Maintenance and repairs	23,546	28,058
Staff and committee meetings	<u>58,806</u>	<u>70,152</u>
	<u>8,941,370</u>	<u>8,884,510</u>
BY ENTITY:		
The General Service Board of A.A.—General Fund	\$4,120,258	\$4,131,883
A.A. World Services, Inc.	3,443,958	3,380,104
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	<u>1,377,154</u>	<u>1,372,523</u>
	<u>8,941,370</u>	<u>8,884,510</u>

COMBINED OTHER EXPENSES

SCHEDULE A-2

	1990		1989
Meetings, Forums and Committees			
General Service Conference	\$ 306,108		\$ 341,760
1990 World Service Meeting	80,635		—
Regional Forums	98,362		65,056
Other meetings and committees	<u>236,175</u>	\$ 721,280	<u>259,455</u>
Data processing costs		97,107	\$ 666,271
			90,567
Selling expense	136,684		126,436
Professional fees	228,837		105,674
Leasehold improvements	1,268		3,436
Foreign literature assistance	111,742		13,950
Loss on bad debts	14,968		4,752
Film projects	45,624		25,880
Travel and other	<u>94,629</u>		<u>115,138</u>
	<u>1,452,139</u>		<u>1,152,104</u>
BY ENTITY:			
The General Service Board of A.A.—General Fund	\$ 818,831		\$ 782,199
A.A. World Services, Inc.	454,156		222,261
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	<u>179,152</u>		<u>147,644</u>
	<u>1,452,139</u>		<u>1,152,104</u>

The following notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
COMBINED BALANCE SHEETS
Years Ended December 31, 1990 and 1989

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1990	Combined 1989
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				(as restated - Note 2)
ASSETS							
Cash							
On deposit	\$1,012,408	\$1,905,962		\$ 415,181	\$ 363,356	\$ 3,696,907	\$ 2,533,006
Segregated for royalties	—	—		1,711,961	—	1,711,961	869,825
Accounts and interest receivable	—	129,948		237,987	19,653	387,588	347,279
Intercompany balances	(736,328)	(1,199,604)		751,055	1,184,877	—	—
Inventories							
Books, pamphlets, etc.	—	—		1,608,265	123,161	1,731,426	1,143,308
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.	—	—		365,227	59,612	424,839	417,147
Investments							
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 1991/2000, at cost (market value: 1990 — \$6,410,015; 1989 — \$6,920,006)	—	6,259,053		—	—	6,259,053	6,804,483
Fixed Assets							
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software (net of accumulated depreciation: 1990 — \$2,384,995; 1989 — \$1,879,387)	—	—	\$566,000	—	—	566,000	923,060
Deferred charges	84,817		—	66,212	59,672	210,701	664,222
Other Assets	—	—	—	34,451	—	34,451	34,451
Total Assets	<u>360,897</u>	<u>7,095,359</u>	<u>566,000</u>	<u>5,190,339</u>	<u>1,810,331</u>	<u>15,022,926</u>	<u>13,736,781</u>
LIABILITIES							
Accounts payable	\$ 303,884	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 580,882	\$ 41,051	\$ 925,817	\$ 576,395
Accrued royalties	—	—	—	1,935,014	—	1,935,014	1,114,547
Deferred income	—	—	—	175,813	1,183,540	1,359,353	2,549,488
Total Liabilities	303,884	—	—	2,691,709	1,224,591	4,220,184	4,240,430
Fund Balances (Exhibit A)	57,013	7,095,359	566,000	2,498,630	585,740	10,802,742	9,496,351
Total Liabilities and Fund Balances	<u>360,897</u>	<u>7,095,359</u>	<u>566,000</u>	<u>5,190,339</u>	<u>1,810,331</u>	<u>15,022,926</u>	<u>13,736,781</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITOR'S OPINION

To: The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

March 15, 1991

Ladies and Gentlemen:

We have audited the accompanying combined balance sheets of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. and its wholly owned subsidiaries, ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1990 and 1989, and the related combined statements of income, expenses and changes in fund balances for the years then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the organization's management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audits.

We conducted our audits in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audits provide a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the combined financial position of the three corporations named above as of December 31, 1990 and 1989, and the combined results of their operations for the years then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO COMBINED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 1990 AND 1989

Note 1 Organization

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. is a not-for-profit corporation organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world. In furtherance of that objective, the organization also publishes books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to the A.A. program through two wholly owned not-for-profit corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in three separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND—established in 1954 for the purposes of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was redefined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. That committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved

by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers, and, therefore, they are reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

During 1989, because of a decrease in publishing net income coupled with a higher deficit incurred by the General Fund, \$1,300,000 of cash was drawn back by A.A. World Services to restore working capital which had been depleted by those factors.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND—as described in Note 2, with retroactive effect to 1989, this fund was established in 1990 to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects; and also to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The GENERAL FUND—is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies

The corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. Contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and donations have been eliminated in the combined totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Inventories

Inventories held by A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are recorded at cost under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Fixed Assets

From its inception, The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous had consistently followed an accounting policy under which all costs of leasehold improvements and equipment were charged against income in the year incurred, rather than being capitalized. That policy was responsive to A.A. Traditions of avoiding the accumulation of unnecessary wealth or property.

In August 1987, the Financial Accounting Standards Board issued a Statement of Financial Accounting Standards No. 93 which requires all not-for-profit organizations to recognize the cost of using up long lived tangible assets—depreciation—in general purpose financial statements. The original effective date for implementation was May 1988, but was later extended to years beginning in 1990.

In order to comply with that FASB Statement and be in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles, responsible officers of the General Service Board of A.A., with concurrence of the independent auditors, authorized the establishment of a separate Fund in which the cost of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions would be capitalized and depreciation provided over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equip-

ment. The costs of such expenditures continues to be recorded as an expense in the General Fund, but the effect on the overall Fund Balance is adjusted through changes in the Fund Balance of the new "Capital Projects Fund."

An extensive analysis of expenditures for improvements, furniture and computer equipment was made from 1980 through 1990. From that analysis it was determined that the costs of major projects that should be capitalized as of January 1, 1989 (the FASB requires that all years displayed must be restated) was \$2,040,359 for leasehold improvements and \$456,866 for computer hardware and software. Depreciation that would have been accumulated to January 1, 1989 was \$1,401,379, leaving an initial Fund Balance of \$1,095,846. Depreciation has been calculated on improvements over the term of the lease which expires March 1991 and on estimated useful lives of eight years and five years for furniture and computer hardware/software, respectively.

Investments

Investments held by the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board of A.A. are carried at cost. No recognition is made in the accounts for any changes in aggregate market value above or below cost because all of the investments are U.S. Treasury Notes with short or medium terms that are normally held to maturity.

Note 3 Retirement Plan

The trustees of General Service Board adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible employees of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The plan has been amended from time to time to improve benefits and to comply with current statutory requirements.

The report of the plan's actuaries stated that as of January 1, 1990, the most recent valuation date to these financial statements for which information is available, the present value of accrued benefits under the plan was \$2,931,660, of which \$2,758,783 was vested. The market value of the assets of the trust fund at the same date was \$5,177,843. The assumed rate of return used in determining the actuarial value of vested plan benefits was 7.5%.

Pension expense has been consistently reported as the contribution made to actuarially fund plan benefits, plus the actuarial, investment and custody fees paid by A.A. World Services related to the operation of the plan. That method of accounting was in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles that had been in effect since the issuance of Accounting Principles Board Statement No. 8 in 1966.

Effective as of 1987, however, Financial Accounting Standards Board (FASB) Statement No. 87 introduced a new concept of "net periodic pension cost," in which pension cost would be accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon actuarial factors which would not necessarily be the same as those presently used in calculating the annual funding requirement. In addition, FASB No. 87 would require, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the organization's balance sheet depending upon whether the plan was considered to be over or under funded. It is clear from the above actuarial data that there is no unfunded liability in the A.A. Retirement Plan. Management still believes the annual funding requirement is a more relevant measure of pension expense, and that the cost of additional actuarial calculations is not warranted. The actuaries have stated that the difference would not be a material amount.

Prior to 1990, A.A. World Service had always paid the actuarial, investment and custody fees incurred by the plan. As of January 1, 1990, however, the Company elected to utilize the discretion granted under the plan provisions to direct such expenses to be paid by the plan. Accordingly, no such expenses are

included in pension expense for 1990.

Pension expense for 1990 and 1989 was \$175,070 and \$255,112, respectively.

Note 4 Lease Commitments

At December 31, 1990, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future tax and wage escalation increases) at 470 Park Avenue South in New York City:

\$135,000 yearly office rental lease effective January 1, 1981 through March 31, 1991.

\$50,000 yearly office rental lease effective July 18, 1981 through March 31, 1991.

\$140,400 yearly office rental lease effective September 10, 1986 through March 31, 1991.

In November 1990, the terms of the three leases above were extended for an additional year to March 31, 1992 at a total rental of \$1,283,200.

The rental expense for the years ended December 31, 1990 and 1989, were as follows:

	1990	1989
Total Rent Expense	<u>\$ 730,700</u>	<u>\$ 679,600</u>
Allocated to:		
A.A. World Services	\$ 338,900	\$ 315,200
General Service Board	248,900	231,600
A.A. Grapevine	<u>142,900</u>	<u>132,800</u>
	<u>730,700</u>	<u>679,600</u>

Minimum rental commitments under the above leases at December 31, 1990 are as follows:

1991	\$1,043,800
1992	<u>320,800</u>
	<u>1,364,600</u>

In February 1991, A.A. World Services Inc. entered into leases for office space at 475 Riverside Drive in New York City. The lease term commences July 1, 1991, and is effective through September 30, 2001. The annual rent is \$481,100, subject to annual adjustments for operating costs.

In connection with the lease for 475 Riverside Drive, two real estate brokerage firms have asserted claims for commissions aggregating \$400,000. Legal counsel advises that the claims appear to be without merit, but if they are pursued further by legal action the outcome is uncertain.

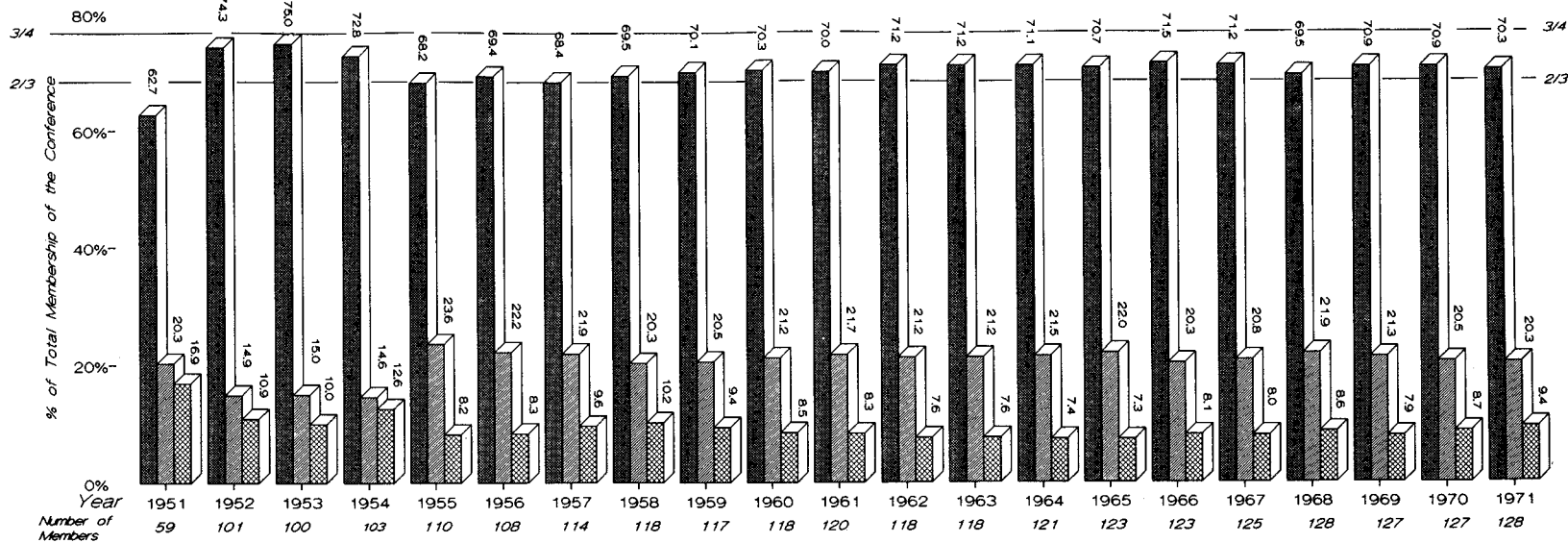
Note 5 Tax Status

The organizations are exempt from federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. They are also exempt from the New York State Franchise Tax.

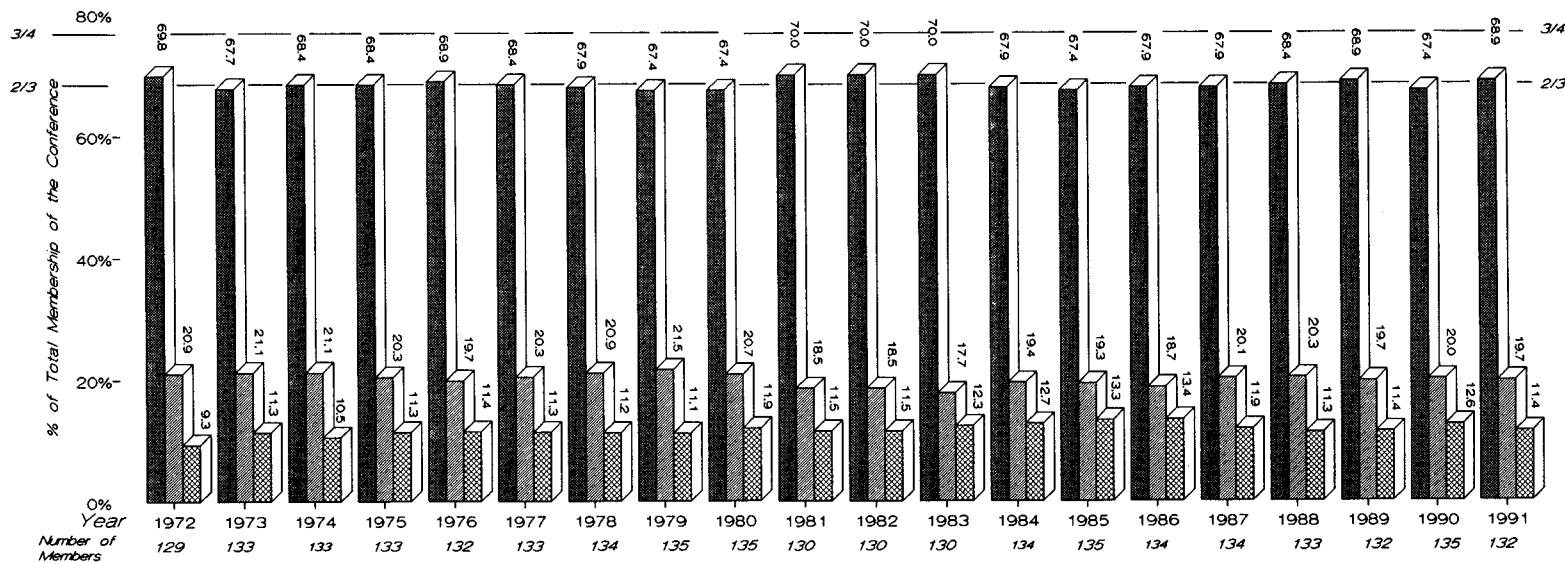
Delegate Joe Sullivan (Panel 41, Virginia) booked his hotel reservations a week early. The hotel called Joe and suggested that it might be more productive if he showed up the following week when the Conference would be in session. Joe was grateful!

CONFERENCE MEMBERSHIP

1951-1971



1972-1991



Percentage of Delegates, Boards, Staffs

Delegates Boards Staffs

1991 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Rod Brown
Elmer Chaney
Bobbie Coneen
James Downes
²Marty Garry
Jim McIntyre
¹Dan Peterson
Jude Tims

Secretary: Eileen Gatzka

Finance

²John Benson
Mike Bruce
Ottis Dimick
John Evans
Marcia Goldblatt
Jacqueline Johnston
¹Jack MacManus
Rich Sarahman

Secretary: Ed Gordon

Policy/Admissions

¹Ovila Blais
Ronald Gauthier
Patrick Hogan
Don Huff
Klaus Kroeber
²Pat Morehouse
John O'Connor
Maryann Wells

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Treatment Facilities

Doug Bailey
¹Clark Doane
Norbert Haase
²Garry McAuley
Bernard Sullivan
Connie Wesley
Berry Wild
Phyllis Wise

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Hugh Cochrane
George Croop
¹P.J. Doherty
²Lenette Dunham
Dan Gramke
Dooley Harris
Kenneth Kendrick
Jim Key

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Grapevine

Dennis Bauer
Dick Carden
²Ruthann Cluna
¹Chuck Crist
David Every
Paul Heindel
David Jimerson
Richard LaGasse
Sam Sibley

Secretary: Arnes Sweet

Public Information

²Maggie Cole
¹Tom Couzens
Bob Jokela
Bill McCaa
Billy Mattingly
Linda O'Brien
Julian Rhinehart
Hugues Samson

Secretary: Richard Bush

Trustees

²Ken Johnston
Roger Luther
Scott McLarty
Elvester McRucker
Barbara Madger
Vera Martin
Richard Patch
¹Crawford Poe
Harland Sercombe

Secretary: John Grant

Correctional Facilities

George Biggs
Tom Duffy
Bob Greenfield
²Dorothy May
¹Pete McHugh
Maxine Miller
Jean-Claude Paquette
Glenn Wyckoff

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Literature

Larry Anderson
Frank Berls
Marne Crary
Guy Frigon
²Rod Horn
Charlie Oakes
¹Susie Pigg
Susie Terrell
Al Smith

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Report and Charter

¹Fred Barnett
Juan Benet
Patricia Hagan
Bill Hellesen
²Bob McGuill
Sid Mayeux
Robert Pare
Joe Sullivan

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

1995 International Convention

George Biggs
Paul Heindel
Jacqueline Johnston
Roger Luther

Secretary: Eileen Gatzka

Bill McCaa
Scott McLarty
Pat Morehouse
Dick Patch

1992 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Jude Tims, N.E. Texas	Jimmy Downes, S.E. New York
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Kenneth Kendrick, S.E. Michigan	Hugh Cochrane, Connecticut
Correctional Facilities	Bob Greenfield, Colorado	Glenn Wyckoff, Ohio
Finance	Mike Bruce, N.S./Nfld./Lab.	Ottis Dimick, Oklahoma
Grapevine	David Every, Hawaii	Dennis Bauer, S. Minnesota
Literature	Susie Terrell, Washington	Al Smith, N. New Jersey
Policy/Admissions	Ron Gauthier, E. Massachusetts	Pat Hogan, West Virginia
Public Information	Julian Rhinehart, Nevada	Bill McCaa, Alabama/N.W. Florida
Report and Charter	Joe Sullivan, Virginia	Sidney Mayeux, Louisiana
Treatment Facilities	Doug Bailey, Brit. Col./Yukon	Connie Wesley, W. Missouri
Committee on Trustees	Scott McLarty, N.E. Ontario	Richard Patch, D.C.

1 Chairperson

2 Alternate Chairperson

1991 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Joan Jackson, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Harold Greene
John King
Greg Muth
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Jacqueline Martin, *chairperson*
Hugh Freyer
Harold Greene
Michael McPherson
Greg Muth
Marc Pineau
Jean Smith
Eileen Gatza, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

John Hartley Smith, M.D., *chairperson*
Peter Brock
Don Bruner
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Dorothy Driscoll
Webb Johnson
Marc Pineau
Fran Polek
Everett Smethurst
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

Amos Reed, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Don Bruner
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Ray McDermott
Olga Morris
Dennis Robbins
Everett Smethurst
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
Phil Cels
Hugh Freyer
Harold Greene
Michael McPherson
John Quinn
Amos Reed
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Stanley Silverman
Jean Smith
Jan Whitney
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Gary Glynn, *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Edward Gordon, *secretary*

International

Webb Johnson, *chairperson*
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Greg Muth
Marc Pineau
Fran Polek
John Quinn
Amos Reed
Stanley Silverman
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Desmond Towey
Sarah Price, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Jan Whitney, *chairperson*
Phil Cels
Webb Johnson
Jacqueline Martin
Michael McPherson
Greg Muth
Jane Murphy Schulberg
John Sharkey
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Eileen Gatza, *secretary*
— *International Convention*
Pat Rosenstiel, *secretary*
— *Regional Forums*

Literature

Phil Cels, *chairperson*
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Hugh Freyer
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
John King
Fran Polek
Everett Smethurst
Jean Smith
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

Nominating

John King, *chairperson*
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Webb Johnson
Jacqueline Martin
John Quinn
John Sharkey
Jan Whitney
John Grant, *secretary*

Public Information

Desmond Towey, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Jill Hargrave
F. Bradley Lynch
Alicia Martinez
John Quinn
Mary Ann Ryan
Jane Murphy Schulberg
John Sharkey
Richard Bush, *secretary*

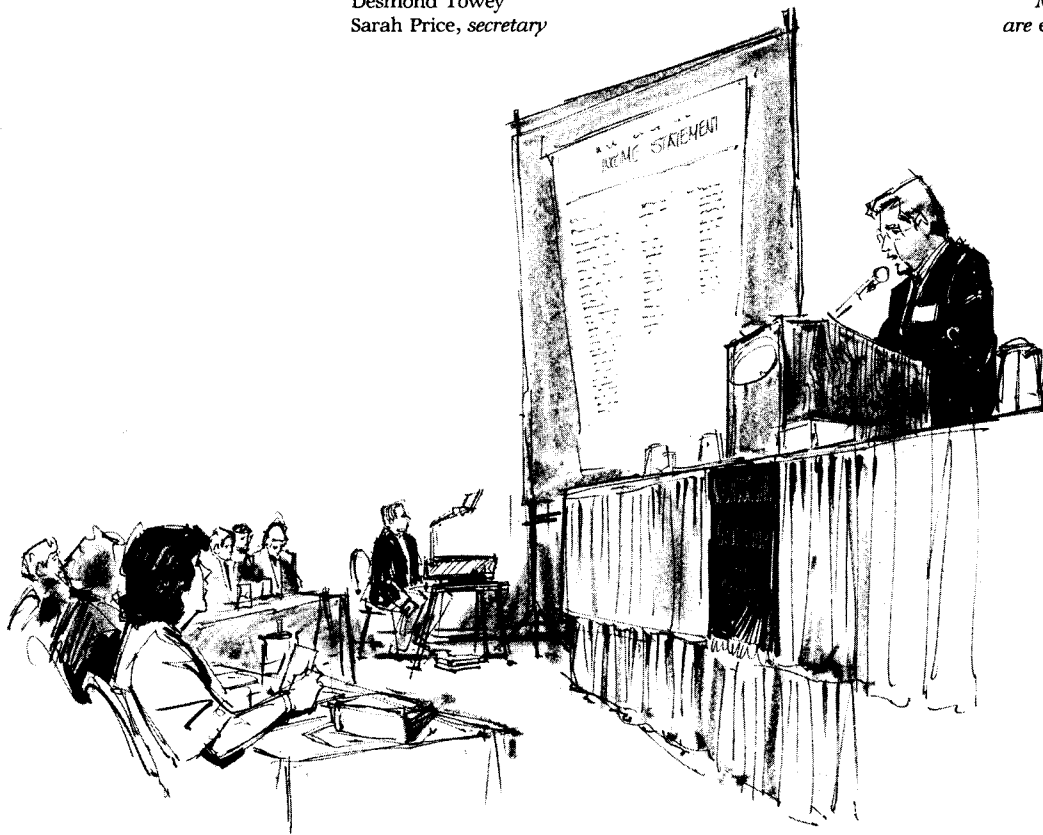
Treatment Facilities

John Sharkey, *chairperson*
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Robert Lewis
Nancy McComas
Amos Reed
Stanley Silverman
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Desmond Towey
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Don Bruner, *chairperson*
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Michael Alexander and Wayne Parks are ex officio members of all committees.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Michael Alexander
First vice-chairperson
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Second vice-chairperson
John King
Secretary
(vacant since death of Jan Williamson)
Treasurer
Robert Morse
Assistant secretary
Helen Turnquest
Assistant treasurer
Edward H. Gordon
The new slate of officers is given on page 41.

1991 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Michael Alexander (460 Park Ave., New York, NY 10022) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1988 Conference. Mike served as a trustee from 1976 to 1985, after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, director and national secretary of the Ireland-United States Council for Commerce and Industry, and trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society.

John Nelson Chappel, M.D. (University of Nevada, School of Medicine, Reno, NV 89557-0046) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism. He serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Literature, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served on many local, state and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, she was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. Joan chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the International, Literature and Nominating Committees.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. He chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Archives and Literature Committees, and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Robert P. Morse (230 Park Ave., 20th Fl., New York, NY 10169) was elected to the board in April 1984 after serving as a consultant to the Finance Committee from April 1981. A graduate of the Wharton School and the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 21 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert is president of Morse Williams & Co., Inc., investment counselors, and is chairperson of the Wall Street Fund, a public mutual fund. He is also treasurer and an executive committee trustee of the Bermuda Biological Station for Research, Inc. Robert is treasurer of the General Service Board and chairperson of the Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies, and has

received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Retired from his position as Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has also held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois. He chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on Finance and Budgetary, International and Treatment Facilities Committees.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (5060 Maple St., Vancouver, B.C. V6M 3K1, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John was also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine and part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. He has been assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health since 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to government. John chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the International, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Donald J. Bruner (6420 Bluff Dr., Bloomington, MN 55438) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1988. Don has been active in area activities from home group to intergroup board member, and served as Panel 33 Conference delegate. He was trained as a civil engineer, was an officer of an international construction company and has served on the boards of several construction and engineering companies, as well as a bank and an international food supply company. Don, who is now retired, chairs the General Sharing Session of the quarterly board meetings, and serves on the C.P.C. and Correctional Facilities Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

²**Ann Bruning** (10728 Hunters Point Rd., Fort Smith, Arkansas 72903), who was a Panel 37 delegate, was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Ann has served her area as G.S.R., area chair, and has been active in P.I. work, mostly in schools. A registered nurse, Ann now works at an in-hospital hospice, and serves on the boards of an alcohol treatment facility, the Ft. Smith Fights AIDS organization, and presents grief workshops for various organizations.

Phil J. Cels (5 Balmoral Bay, Brandon, Manitoba, R7A 6E5 Canada), who was elected Western Canada trustee in April 1988, served as a Panel 32 Conference delegate. He is involved in C.P.C. and P.I. work for Southwest Manitoba, as well as being active in local A.A. activities. Phil is in his 15th year as an account executive with a brokerage house. He chairs the Literature Committee, and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees. Phil is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Harold Greene (695 Americana Dr., Annapolis, MD 21403) was elected general service trustee in April 1989. Harold's service commitment began at the group level in Staten Island, N.Y.; he has served as a D.C.M. and as a member of the N.Y. Intergroup Steering Committee. From 1985-88 he was a director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Harold currently heads a Federal agency involved in developing and financing rehabilitation of housing for the homeless in the Maryland/Washington, D.C. area. He serves on the Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board.

²**Jacob B. "Jake" Ham** (RFD 1, Box 1400, Winthrop, ME 04364) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Jake began his service work in California as G.S.R., D.C.M., and H&I coordinator. After returning to his home state of Maine in 1980, Jake served in similar service jobs, including Maine area chair, and was a Panel 38 delegate. In his spare time, away from his job with the U.S. Post Office, he enjoys carpentry, gardening and camping.

¹**W.F. (Webb) Johnson** (112-7591 Moffatt Rd., Richmond, BC V6Y 3N2, Canada), elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1987, has served his area as G.S.R., D.C.M., area treasurer, and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A former stock broker and broker dealer, Webb is currently director of a number of companies engaged in national resource development. He chairs the International Committee, and serves on the C.P.C., International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Jacqueline (Jackie) Martin (1305 Bluff Springs Ct., Louisville, KY 40223) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 30 delegate, Jackie has been active in her area's intergroup and treatment facilities committees and is past president of the Kentucky Alcoholism Council. With a background in real estate, Jackie recently went back to school to prepare for a new career in management. She chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. She also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Greg Muth (c/o Jackson Companies, P.O. Box 30668, Honolulu, Hawaii 96820) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1990. Greg, who has been active from group coffee maker on, served as a Panel 37 delegate, when he chaired the Conference Report and Charter Committee. He is an executive of a commercial construction company. He also serves on the Archives, Conference, International and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees.

²**David O'Leary** (37 Wabush Pl., St. John's, Newfoundland, Canada A1E 5V5) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1991. A Panel 35 delegate from Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador, David has remained active in his area, serving on intergroup, convention and institutions committees. He is a maintenance technician with Cable Atlantic.

Marc Pineau (185 - 14th Ave., Iberville, Quebec J2X 1B5, Canada), who was a Panel 36 delegate, was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1990. He has served as G.S.R., D.C.M. and area secretary and chair. Marc is an engineer with Westinghouse Canada, where he has participated in employees' programs, as well as setting up other rehabilitation programs. He serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community and International Committees.

John J. Quinn (66 Brookwood Pkwy., Jackson, NJ 08527) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1989. A Panel 35 delegate, he has also served his area as D.C.M., treasurer and area committee member. With a background in accounting, taxation and personnel, John is currently vice-president of a major international bank in New York City. He serves on the Finance & Budgetary, International, Public Information and Nominating Committees.

¹**John A. Sharkey** (9 Valley Way, West Orange, NJ 07052). Elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, John is a past area chairperson and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. He currently serves on the Essex County Alcoholism Advisory Board and was

trustee of his intergroup committee. John, who owned and operated a tavern for seven years, is supply coordinator with New Jersey Bell Telephone Company. He chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the International Convention/Regional Forums, Nominating and Public Information Committees.

Stanley N. Silverman (137 E. 36th St., New York, NY 10016), who was elected a general service trustee in April 1989, served on the Grapevine editorial board and later on the Grapevine Corporate Board from 1983-87. During that time he was a member of the trustees' Finance & Budgetary, Retirement, International, Literature, and Correctional Facilities Committees, as well as serving as treasurer of the Grapevine. Active at the group level, Stanley is a member of the American Institute of C.P.A.s and the New York State Society of C.P.A.s, and is a partner in a New York certified public accounting firm. He is chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board and serves on the Finance & Budgetary, International, Retirement, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Jean Smith (100 Bank St., New York, NY 10014) was elected general service trustee in April 1990. Jean has served on the Grapevine editorial board and was an A.A.W.S. director from 1987 to 1990, when she served on several trustees' committees. She is a senior vice-president of St. Martin's Press, and director of their college division. She serves on the Conference, Finance & Budgetary and Literature Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

J. Desmond Towey (515 Madison Ave., Suite 1909, New York, NY 10022) was elected general service trustee in April 1988. Des' introduction to service work was as a consultant on the trustees' Public Information Committee. He is owner and president of a firm specializing in shareholder relations and marketing financial products. He chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the International and Nominating Committees. He also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jan Whitney (9700 Avalon Rd., Greenville, MI 48838) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 36 delegate, she has served as area secretary, chairperson for the area assembly, and program chair for area conferences. She also served as area Grapevine chairperson, and chaired the board of the local chapter of N.C.A. Now retired, Jan's professional background was in business and real estate. She chairs the International Convention/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees. She is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Jan Kelly Williamson [deceased] (3208 Laimpliter Place, El Paso, TX 79925), was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, and was active in her local intergroup, N.W. Texas Area, and in the Southwest Regional Delegate Assembly; she was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. A retired executive secretary, Jan was primarily involved with local A.A. She chaired the Nominating Committee, and served on the Archives, Conference, and Finance & Budgetary Committees. Jan, who would have rotated off the board in April 1991, died in a tragic accident, November 1990.

¹ Rotating at the close of the 1991 Conference meeting.

² New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, April 20, 1991.

A.A. World Services Directors

Harold Greene, <i>chairperson</i>	Everett Smethurst
Phil Cels	Jean Smith
Hugh Freyer	Helen Turnquest
Michael McPherson	Jan Whitney
Wayne Parks	

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Stanley Silverman, <i>chairperson</i>	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Bernard Benziger	Ames Sweet
Don Bruner	Desmond Towey
John King	Ann Warner
Fran Polek	

General Service Office Staff

Wayne Parks, <i>general manager</i>	Valerie O'Neill
Richard Bush	Sarah Price
Lois Fisher	Pat Rosenstiel
Eileen Gatza	Helen Turnquest
John Grant	Susan Ulseth
Joanie Moncrief	Tom Jasper, <i>services director</i>
Daniel Mooney	Frank Mauser, <i>archivist</i>

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet Ann Warner

Others Assisting the Conference (*nonvoting*)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
 Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
 Chris Bradley, *supervisor, data processing*
 Jenice Cameron, *Grapevine editorial secretary*
 Joseph Dennan, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *editor*
 Yee Eng, *staff assistant*
 Lynda Ernst, *staff assistant*
 Catherine Femia, *staff assistant*
 Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
 Edward Gordon, *director of finance/business administrator*
 Lee Halligan, *director, human resources*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Margie Janicek, *receptionist*
 John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
 Elizabeth Lopez, *manager, staff assistant/clerical department*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
 Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 John Nayduch, *Grapevine art director/designer, Conference Report*
 Carol Pickett, *clerical*
 Edward Reilly, *data processing manager, systems & operations*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Bob Scherer, *Grapevine controller*
 Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
 Darlene Smith, *staff assistant*
 Joan Smith, *staff assistant*
 Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine administrative assistant*
 Cynthia White, *staff assistant*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustee emeritus

Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 41st Conference includes Panel 40 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 41 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	41	Bill McCaa, 2141 Vasco Dr., Lillian, AL 36549
Alaska	2	40	Clark Doane, 2253 Jack St., Fairbanks, AK 99709
Arizona	3	40	Lenette Dunham, 4351 W. Camino Pintoresco, Tucson, AZ 85745
Arkansas	4	41	G. David Jimerson, 714 Craighead Rd., Jonesboro, AR 72401
California Southern	5	41	Jacqueline Johnston, 1169 Nottingwood Circle, Westlake Village, CA 91361
Northern Coastal	6	41	Barbara Madger, 2032 "E" St., Eureka, CA 95501
Northern Interior	7	40	Fred Barnett, 1232 Hobson Ave., W. Sacramento, CA 95605
San Diego/Imperial	8	40	Barbara Coneen, 11203 Corte Playa Madera, San Diego, CA 92124
Mid-Southern	9	40	P. J. Doherty, 603 Ninth St., Hermosa Beach, CA 90254
Colorado	10	41	Robert Greenfield, 6852 Palace Dr., Colorado Springs, CO 80918
Connecticut	11	41	Hugh Cochrane, 50 Spruce Peak Ln., West Haven, CT 06516
Delaware	12	40	Patricia Hagan, 26 Sanford Dr., Newark, DE 19713
District of Columbia	13	41	Richard Patch, 207 Hillsboro Dr., Silver Springs, MD 20902
Florida North	14	41	Thomas Duffy, Rt. 4, Box 4500, Monticello, FL 32344-9300
S. Florida/Bahamas/V.I.	15	41	Richard La Gasse, 4820 Sawyer Rd., Sarasota, FL 34233
Georgia	16	40	Sam Sibley, Box 2843, Augusta, GA 30904
Hawaii	17	41	David Every, R.R. 1, Box 391, #203, Wailuku, HI 96793

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Idaho	18	40	Berry Wild, 1427 Manitou, Boise, ID 83706	Missouri Eastern	38	41	Dick Carden, Box 250, St. James, MO 65559-0250
Illinois Chicago	19	41	Frank Berls, 7938 S. Albany Ave., Chicago, IL 60652	Western	39	41	Connie Wesley, 5110 S. Delaware, Independence, MO 64055
Northern	20	40	Phyllis Wise, 234 S. Center St., Oneida, IL 61467	Montana	40	40	Maryann Wells, 413 E. Benham, Glendive, MT 59330
Southern	21	41	Elmer Chaney, R.R.6, Box 44, Decatur, IL 62521	Nebraska	41	40	Roger Luther, Box 147, Alda, NE 68810
Indiana Northern	22	41	Klaus Kroeber, 2616 Garden Park Dr., Fort Wayne, IN 46825	Nevada	42	41	Julian Rhinehart, 1127 Seno Court, Boulder City, NV 89005
Southern	23	40	Dorothy May, 6121 N. Pershing Ave., Indianapolis, IN 46208	New Hampshire	43	40	Martin Garry, 55 Chapman St., Dracut, MA 01826
Iowa	24	41	Rodney Brown, 4100 73rd St., Urbandale, IA 50322	New Jersey Northern	44	41	June (Al) Smith, 129 Smith St., Newark, NJ 07106
Kansas	25	40	John Evans, 7406 Cedaridge Circle, Wichita, KS 67226	Southern	45	40	Ruthann Cluna, 6 Candle Court, R.R. 9, Vicentown, NJ 08088
Kentucky	26	40	Billy Mattingly, 3513 Donna Ln., Bardstown, KY 40004	New Mexico	46	40	George Biggs, 505 Oppenheimer Dr., #805, Los Alamos, NM 87544
Louisiana	27	41	Sidney Mayeux, 459 Mayfair Dr., Bossier City, LA 71111	New York Central	47	41	George Croop, 78 Maywood Ave., Rochester, NY 14618
Maine	28	40	Guy Frigon, P.O. Box A, Upper Frenchville, ME 04784	Hudson/Mohawk /Berkshire	48	40	John Benson, Jr., 13-2C Lakeshore Dr., Watervliet, NY 12189
Maryland	29	40	Thomas Couzens, 407 Prince St., Salisbury, MD 21801	Southeast	49	41	James Downes, 2584 Stedman Pl., Bronx, NY 10469
Massachusetts Eastern	30	41	Ronald Gauthier, 44 Merrill Ave., Lynn, MA 01902	Western	50	40	Elvester McRucker, 17 Hurlock Ave., Buffalo, NY 14211
Western	31	40	John O'Connor, 83 Miller St., Springfield, MA 01104	North Carolina	51	41	James Key, 4342 Witherow Rd., Winston-Salem, NC 27106
Michigan Central	32	41	Harland Sercombe, 6723 Hawkins Rd., Jackson, MI 49201	North Dakota	52	40	Maggie Cole, 2219 28th Ave. So., Fargo, ND 58103
Southeast	33	41	Kenneth Kendrick, 22601 Essex Way, Apt. 625, Southfield, MI 48034	Ohio Central & Southeast	53	41	Glenn Wyckoff, 4121 Burnell Rd., Columbus, OH 43224
Western	34	40	Charles Oakes, 9520 Silver Creek Rd., Whitehall, MI 49461	Northeast	54	41	Norbert Haase, 1937 19th St., S.W., Akron, OH 44314
Minnesota Northern	35	40	Robert Jokela, 1208 Mississippi Ave., Duluth, MN 55811	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	55	40	Richard Sarahman, 340 S. Reynolds Rd., Lot 28, Toledo, OH 43615
Southern	36	41	Dennis Bauer, 410 N. Orchard St., Northfield, MN 55057	Southwest	56	40	Vera Martin, 8705 Tudor, Cincinnati, OH 45242
Mississippi	37	40	T.L. (Dooley) Harris, Box 1114, Batesville, MS 38606	Oklahoma	57	41	Ottis Dimick, 11004 SE 28th, Midwest City, OK 73130
				Oregon	58	40	Charles Crist, 277 N. Lotus Isle Dr., Portland, OR 97217

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Pennsylvania			
<i>Eastern</i>	59	41	Marcia Goldblatt, 4719 Fowler St., Philadelphia, PA 19127
<i>Western</i>	60	41	Maxine Miller, Box 124, Polk, PA 16342
Rhode Island	61	40	John (Jack) MacManus, 7 East St., Providence, RI 02906
South Carolina	62	40	Nelson Crawford Poe, Box 8856, Greenville, SC 29604
South Dakota	63	40	Rod Horn, 509 State, Belle Fourche, SD 57717
Tennessee	64	40	Larry Anderson, Box 1971, Lewisburg, TN 37091
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	41	Jude Tims, Rt. 5, Box 134, Waxahachie, TX 75165
<i>Northwest</i>	66	40	Sue Pigg, Box 311, Sanford, TX 79078-0311
<i>Southeast</i>	67	41	Linda O'Brien, 5918 Valkeith Dr., Houston, TX 77096
<i>Southwest</i>	68	40	Bob McGill, Box 843, Refugio, TX 78377
Utah	69	41	Don Huff, 3628 S. 3325 W., West Valley City, UT 84109
Vermont	70	40	Peter McHugh, Box 1085, Stowe, VT 05672
Virginia	71	41	Joe Sullivan, 10001 Twin Valley Rd., Richmond, VA 23235-1881
Washington	72	41	Susan Terrell, 209 E. 8th St., Aberdeen, WA 98520
West Virginia	73	41	Patrick Hogan, Rt., 3, Box 11, Harpers Ferry, WV 25425
Wisconsin			
<i>N. Wisconsin/ Up. Pen. Mich.</i>	74	40	Paul Heindel, 504 N. Margaret St., Kaukauna, WI 54130
<i>Southern</i>	75	41	William Hellesen, 1233 Layard Ave., Racine, WI 53402
Wyoming	76	40	Dan Gramke, Box 43, Frontier, WY 83121-0043
Puerto Rico	77	40	Juan Benet, G.P.O. Box 3953, San Juan, PR 00936-3953

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	40	Garry McAuley, 6115-51 Avenue, Stettler, AB T0C 2L2
British Columbia/ Yukon	79	41	Doug Bailey, Box 54, Black Creek, BC V0R 1C0

Manitoba	80	40	Pat Morehouse, 3410 Van Horne St., Brandon, MB R7B 3H4
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	81	40	James MacIntyre, 1365 Golden Grove Rd., Saint John, NB E2L 3W4
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	82	41	Michael Bruce, Box 222, Port Hawkesbury, NS B0E 2V0
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	41	Bernard Sullivan, 1459 Glencairn Ave., Peterborough, ON K9J 6S2
<i>Northeast</i>	84	41	Scott McLarty, 526 Parliament St., Sault Ste. Marie, ON P6C 3M7
<i>Northwest</i>	85	41	Marne Cray, 270 Harrington Ave., Thunder Bay, ON P7A 3T3
<i>Western</i>	86	40	Dan Peterson, 5315 Queen Elizabeth Dr., Windsor, ON N8T 1N2
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	40	Ovila Blais, 8584A Cluny, St.-Leonard, PQ H1R 2X5
<i>Southeast</i>	88	41	Hugues Samson, 15, rue Theroux, Arthabaska, PQ G6P 5R8
<i>Northeast</i>	89	41	Robert Pare, 4675 boul. des Cimes, Quebec, PQ G2A 3X9
<i>Northwest</i>	90	40	Jean-Claude Paquette, 40, 43eme Ave., Montreal, PQ H1A 2Z9
Saskatchewan	91	40	Ken Johnston, Box 148, Grenfell, SK S0G 2B0

